

BALLADS OF AMERICAN BRAVERY

CLINTON SCOLLARD



SILVER, BURDETT & COMPANY

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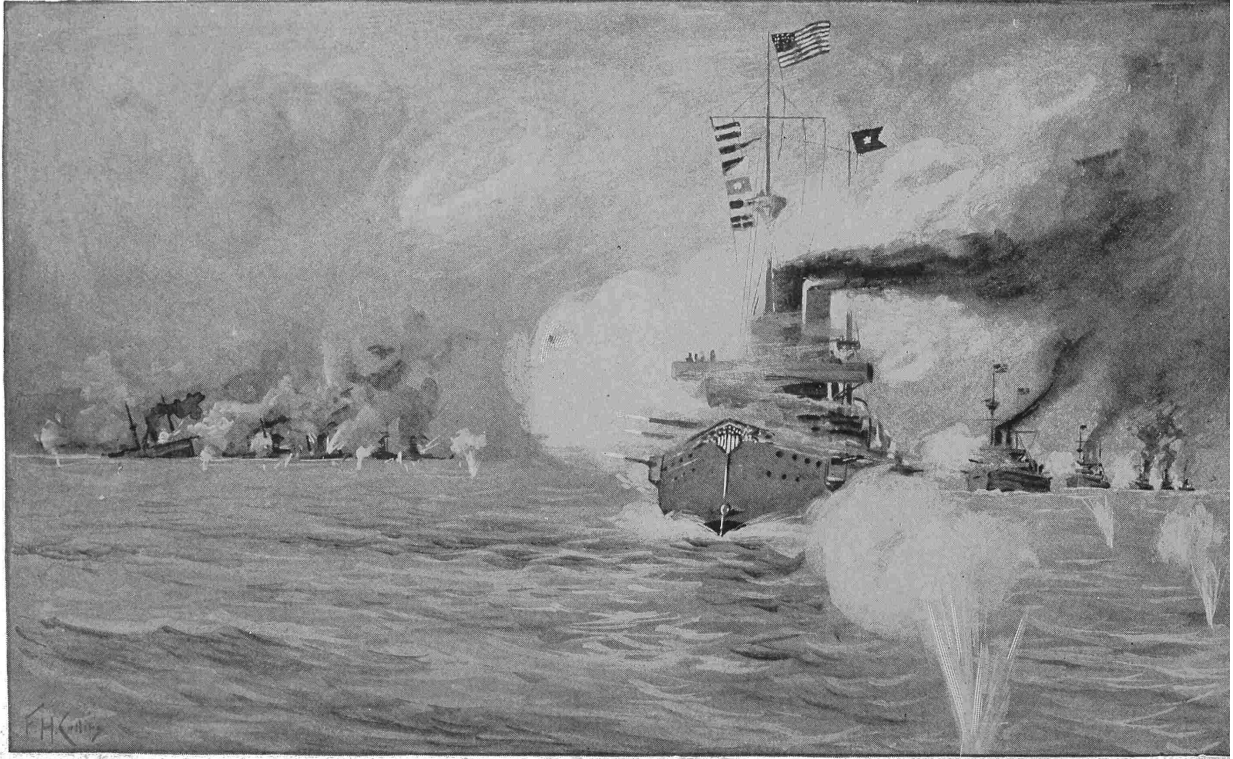
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AMERICAN BRAVERY ***

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The Battle of Manila Bay, May 1, 1898. ([See p. 141.](#))

The Silver Series of English and American Classics

BALLADS OF AMERICAN BRAVERY

EDITED, WITH NOTES

BY

CLINTON SCOLLARD

AUTHOR OF "OLD AND NEW WORLD LYRICS," "SONGS OF SUNRISE LANDS," "THE
HILLS OF SONG," ETC.



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PREFATORY WORD

WHILE it has been, in the main, the purpose of the Editor to include in the present collection only such poems as commemorate some signal act of valor historically verified, it has seemed best to widen the scope sufficiently to admit a few selections that must have been excluded were the lines rigorously drawn. To appeal to the student of American history has been the primary aim; yet, inasmuch as the chord played upon—that of heroism—finds a responsive echo in every heart, it is hoped that the book may prove of interest to the general public as well. Though there has been no attempt at an exhaustive selection, a natural desire to cover as wide a field as possible has led to the admission of some ballads of lesser literary value, though it is believed that none will be found that has not sufficient merit to warrant its presence.

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CLINTON, NEW YORK, March, 1900.

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BALLADS OF AMERICAN BRAVERY

*Great Greece hath her Thermopylæ;
Stout Switzerland her Tell;
The Scot his Wallace heart—and we
Have saints and shrines as well.
Richard Realf.*

IN TIME OF STRIFE

1

PAUL REVERE'S RIDE

LISTEN, my children, and you shall hear
Of the midnight ride of Paul Revere,
On the eighteenth of April, in Seventy-Five;
Hardly a man is now alive
Who remembers that famous day and year.

He said to his friend, "If the British march
By land or sea from the town to-night,
Hang a lantern aloft in the belfry arch
Of the North Church tower as a signal light,—
One, if by land, and two, if by sea;
And I on the opposite shore will be,
Ready to ride and spread the alarm
Through every Middlesex village and farm,
For the country folk to be up and to arm."
Then he said, "Good-night!" and with muffled oar
Silently rowed to the Charlestown shore,
Just as the moon rose over the bay,
Where swinging wide at her moorings lay
The *Somerset*, British man-of-war;
A phantom ship, with each mast and spar
Across the moon like a prison bar,
And a huge black hulk, that was magnified
By its own reflection in the tide.

Meanwhile, his friend, through alley and street
Wanders and watches with eager ears,
Till in the silence around him he hears
The muster of men at the barrack door,
The sound of arms, and the tramp of feet,
And the measured tread of the grenadiers
Marching down to their boats on the shore.

Then he climbed the tower of the Old North Church,
By the wooden stairs, with stealthy tread,
To the belfry chamber overhead,
And startled the pigeons from their perch
On the sombre rafters, that round him made

On the sombre turrets, that round him made
Masses and moving shapes of shade,—
By the trembling ladder, steep and tall,
To the highest window in the wall,
Where he paused to listen and look down
A moment on the roofs of the town,
And the moonlight flowing over all.

Beneath, in the churchyard, lay the dead,
In their night encampment on the hill,
Wrapped in silence so deep and still
That he could hear, like a sentinel's tread,
The watchful night-wind, as it went
Creeping along from tent to tent,
And seeming to whisper, "All is well!"
A moment only he feels the spell
Of the place and the hour, and the secret dread
Of the lonely belfry and the dead;
For suddenly all his thoughts are bent
On a shadowy something far away,
Where the river widens to meet the bay,—
A line of black that bends and floats
On the rising tide, like a bridge of boats.

Meanwhile, impatient to mount and ride,
Booted and spurred, with a heavy stride
On the opposite shore walked Paul Revere.
Now he patted his horse's side,
Now gazed at the landscape far and near,
Then, impetuous, stamped the earth,
And turned and tightened his saddle girth;
But mostly he watched with eager search
The belfry tower of the Old North Church,
As it rose above the graves on the hill,
Lonely and spectral and sombre and still.
And lo! as he looks, on the belfry's height,
A glimmer, and then a gleam of light!
He springs to the saddle, the bridle he turns,
But lingers and gazes, till full on his sight

A second lamp in the belfry burns!

A hurry of hoofs in the village street,
A shape in the moonlight, a bulk in the dark,
And beneath, from the pebbles, in passing, a spark
Struck out by a steed flying fearless and fleet:
That was all! And yet, through the gloom and the light,
The fate of a nation was riding that night;
And the spark struck out by that steed, in his flight,
Kindled the land into flame with its heat.
He has left the village and mounted the steep,
And beneath him, tranquil and broad and deep,
Is the Mystic, meeting the ocean tides;
And under the alders, that skirt its edge,
Now soft on the sand, now loud on the ledge,
Is heard the tramp of his steed as he rides.

It was twelve by the village clock,
When he crossed the bridge into Medford town.
He heard the crowing of the cock,
And the barking of the farmer's dog,
And felt the damp of the river fog,
That rises after the sun goes down.

It was one by the village clock,
When he galloped into Lexington.
He saw the gilded weathercock
Swim in the moonlight as he passed,
And the meeting-house windows, blank and bare,
Gaze at him with a spectral glare,
As if they already stood aghast
At the bloody work they would look upon.

It was two by the village clock,
When he came to the bridge in Concord town.
He heard the bleating of the flock,
And the twitter of birds among the trees,
And felt the breath of the morning breeze

Blowing over the meadows brown.
And one was safe and asleep in his bed
Who at the bridge would be first to fall,
Who that day would be lying dead,
Pierced by a British musket-ball.

You know the rest. In the books you have read
How the British Regulars fired and fled,—
How the farmers gave them ball for ball,
From behind each fence and farmyard wall,
Chasing the redcoats down the lane,
Then crossing the fields to emerge again
Under the trees at the turn of the road,
And only pausing to fire and load.

So through the night rode Paul Revere;
And so through the night went his cry of alarm
To every Middlesex village and farm,—
A cry of defiance and not of fear,
A voice in the darkness, a knock at the door,
And a word that shall echo forevermore!
For, borne on the night-wind of the Past,
Through all our history, to the last,
In the hour of darkness and peril and need,
The people will waken and listen to hear
The hurrying hoof-beats of that steed,
And the midnight message of Paul Revere.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

(By special permission of Houghton, Mifflin and Company.)

At least they had him buried full fifty years ago;—
The gray White Mountain granite they set above his head,
With some graven words upon it, to let the neighbors know
Precisely what it was that made the grasses grow
So wondrous rank and strong: How they rippled in the wind,
As if nobody ever died, nobody ever sinned!
To that old Bible name of his what eloquence was lent
When its owner marched to battle,—not a ration, not a tent,
Nor a promise nor a sign of a Continental cent!
Ho, Ebenezer Eastman! We'll call the roll again,—
Ho, dead and gone Lieutenant of the old-time Minute-Men!

All at a flying gallop a rider swings in sight,
Pulls up beside the fallow and gives the view-halloo,—
His horse's flanks are black, but his neck is foamy white:—
“Turn out, Lieutenant Eastman! There's something else to do!
The redcoats are a-swarmling! Your summer plowing's through!”
No other word—away! And the rattling of the hoofs
Was like the rain from traveling clouds along the cabin roofs.
The plowman turned his cattle out; he saddled up the bay,
And he rallied out the wilderness upon that summer day,
And the Minute-Men of Gilmanton to Boston marched away.
About the mother? Well, she watched beside the cabin door,
And rocked the baby's basswood boat upon the puncheon floor.

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1 ne spiders in the empty door had swung their webs at will,—
The champions had gone to Bunker's smoky Hill,
To try the quaint old-fashioned "lock" they practiced on the Green,
And such a game of tough "square hold" the world has seldom seen!
About the father? Only this;—he fought in Stark's brigade,
On Charlestown Neck, that dusty day. A splendid mark he made;
He never flinched a single inch when British cannon played,
But foddered up an old rail fence with Massachusetts hay,
Stood out the battle at the rack, and stoutly blazed away!
Lo, through the smoky glory, that human flower-deluce,
The gray-eyed Mary Butler, Lieutenant Eastman's wife!
Her pallid cheek and brow like a holy flag of truce,
Her heart as sweet and red as a rose's inner life,
No murmur on her lips, nor sign of any strife.
Four days before the fight. Has the little woman heard
From anybody Boston way? Nobody—not a word!

Then up rose Mary Butler, and set her wheel at rest;
She swept the puncheon floor, she washed the cottage pride,—
The cottage pride of three weeks old, and dressed him in his best,—
She wound the clock that told the time her mother was a bride,
And porringer and spoon she deftly laid aside;
She strung a clean white apron across the window panes,
And swung the kettle from the crane, for fear of rusting rains;
Then tossed her saddle on the bay and donned her linen gown,
And took the baby on before,—no looking round or down!
Full seventy miles to Cambridge town! Bring out your civic crown!
I think 'twill fit that brow of hers who sadly smiled and said:
"We'll *know* about your father, boy, and who is hurt or dead!"
The maple woods that round her stand so solemn in the calm,
Up and down are swaying slowly, like a singing-master's palm,
All together beating time,—not a soul to sing a psalm!
"There's been a dreadful battle!"—that's what the neighbors said,
"But when or where we cannot tell, nor who is hurt or dead."

Rugged maples broke their ranks to let the rider by,
Fell in behind her noiseless as falls the stealthy dew;
Such heavy folds of starless dark in double shadow lie,
The slender bridle path she treads can only just show through

The slender shade path she treads can only just show through,
And buried in the leafy miles was all the world she knew.
By muffled drum of partridge and jaunty jay-bird's fife,
That mother made her lonely march,—that Continental wife.
She never drew the bridle rein till forty miles were done,
And on her ended journey shone the second setting sun,
And round the Bay, like battle clock, tolled out the evening-gun.
Talk not of poms and tournaments! If only you had seen
The royal ride from Gilmanton, the halt at Cambridge Green!

Dust-bedimmed and weary, with a look as though she smiled,
She melted through the haze of the summer's smoky gold!
Some master's faded picture of Madonna and the Child,
Born full a thousand years ago, and never growing old!
She heard old Putnam's kennel growl, the bells of Charlestown tolled;
She saw the golden day turn gray within an ashen shroud,
That showed the scarlet regulars like lightning through a cloud.
Forth from the furnace and the fire Lieutenant Eastman came,—
The smell of powder in his clothes and fragrance in his fame,—
And met her bravely waiting there, who bore his boy and name!—
She from the howling wilderness—he from the hell of men,
The little woman called the roll; he called it back again!

Then lightly to the pillion the gray-eyed wife he swung,
A bundle on the saddlebow all tenderly he placed,
And, lost amid the leafy calms where cannon never rung,
Away they rode to Gilmanton, her arm around his waist,
No general's sash of crimson silk so rarely could have graced!
Ah, Mary Butler cannot die, whatever sextons say,
While yet life's azure pulses keep their old heroic play.

.
A million men have lingered long, a million men have died,
Who never saw a deed so grand as Mary Butler's ride!

BENJAMIN FRANKLIN TAYLOR.

'Twas May upon the mountains, and on the airy wing
Of every floating zephyr came pleasant sounds of spring,—
Of robins in the orchards, brooks running clear and warm,
Or chanticleer's shrill challenge from busy farm to farm.

But, ranged in serried order, attent on sterner noise,
Stood stalwart Ethan Allen and his "Green Mountain Boys,"—
Two hundred patriots listening, as with the ears of one,
To the echo of the muskets that blazed at Lexington!

"My comrades,"—thus the leader spake to his gallant band,—
"The key of all the Canadas is in King George's hand,
Yet, while his careless warders our slender armies mock,
Good Yankee swords—God willing—may pick his rusty lock!"

At every pass a sentinel was set to guard the way,
Lest the secret of their purpose some idle lip betray,
As on the rocky highway they marched with steady feet
To the rhythm of the brave hearts that in their bosoms beat.

The curtain of the darkness closed 'round them like a tent,
When, travel-worn and weary, yet not with courage spent,
They halted on the border of slumbering Champlain,
And saw the watch lights glimmer across the glassy plain.

O proud Ticonderoga, enthroned amid the hills!
O bastions of old Carillon, the "Fort of Chiming Rills!"
Well might your quiet garrison have trembled where they lay,
And, dreaming, grasped their sabres against the dawn of day!

In silence and in shadow the boats were pushed from shore,
Strong hands laid down the musket to ply the muffled oar;
The startled ripples whitened and whispered in their wake,
Then sank again, reposing, upon the peaceful lake.

Fourscore and three they landed, just as the morning gray
Gave warning on the hilltops to rest not or delay;
Behind, their comrades waited, the fortress frowned before,

And the voice of Ethan Allen was in their ears once more:

“Soldiers, so long united—dread scourge of lawless power!
Our country, torn and bleeding, calls to this desperate hour.
One choice alone is left us, who hear that high behest—
To quit our claims to valor, or put them to the test!

“I lead the storming column up yonder fateful hill,
Yet not a man shall follow save at his ready will!
There leads no pathway backward—’tis death or victory!
Poise each his trusty firelock, ye that will come with me!”

From man to man a tremor ran at their captain’s word,—
(Like the “going” in the mulberry-trees that once King David heard),—
While his eagle glances sweeping adown the triple line,
Saw, in the glowing twilight, each even barrel shine!

“Right face, my men, and forward!” Low-spoken, swift-obeyed!
They mount the slope unfaltering—they gain the esplanade!
A single drowsy sentry beside the wicket-gate,
Snapping his aimless fusil, shouts the alarm—too late!

They swarm before the barracks—the quaking guards take flight,
And such a shout exultant resounds along the height,
As rang from shore and headland scarce twenty years ago,
When brave Montcalm’s defenders charged on a British foe!

Leaps from his bed in terror the ill-starred Delaplace,
To meet across his threshold a wall he may not pass!
The bayonets’ lightning flashes athwart his dazzled eyes,
And, in tones of sudden thunder, “Surrender!” Allen cries.

“Then in whose name the summons?” the ashen lips reply.
The mountaineer’s stern visage turns proudly toward the sky,—
“In the name of great Jehovah!” he speaks with lifted sword,
“And the Continental Congress, who wait upon His word!”

Light clouds, like crimson banners, trailed bright across the east,
As the great sun rose in splendor above a conflict ceased,

Gilding the bloodless triumph for equal rights and laws,
As with the smile of heaven upon a holy cause.

Still, wave on wave of verdure, the emerald hills arise,
Where once were heroes mustered from men of common guise,
And still, on Freedom's roster, through all her glorious years,
Shine the names of Ethan Allen and his bold volunteers!

MARY ANNA PHINNEY STANSBURY.

(By special permission of the author, and of *The Youth's Companion*.)

MONTGOMERY AT QUEBEC

ROUND Quebec's embattled walls
Moodily the patriots lay;
Dread disease within its thralls
Drew them closer day by day;
Till from suffering man to man,
Mutinous, a murmur ran.

Footsore, they had wandered far,
They had fasted, they had bled;
They had slept beneath the star
With no pillow for the head;
Was it but to freeze to stone
In this cruel icy zone?

Yet their leader held his heart,
Naught discouraged, naught dismayed;
Quelled with unobtrusive art
Those that muttered; unafraid
Waited, watchful, for the hour
When his golden chance should flower.

'Twas the death-tide of the year;
Night had passed its murky noon;
Through the bitter atmosphere
Pierced nor ray of star nor moon;
But upon the bleak earth beat
Blinding arrows of the sleet.

While the trumpets of the storm
Pealed the bastioned heights around,
Did the dauntless heroes form,
Did the low, sharp order sound.
"Be the watchword *Liberty!*"
Cried the brave Montgomery.

Here, where he had won applause,
When Wolfe faced the Gallic foe,
For a nobler, grander cause

Would he strike the fearless blow,—
Smite at Wrong upon the throne,
At Injustice giant grown.

“Men, you will not fear to tread
Where your general dares to lead!
On, my valiant boys!” he said,
And his foot was first to speed;
Swiftly up the beetling steep,
Lion-hearted, did he leap.

Flashed a sudden blinding glare;
Roared a fearsome battle-peal;
Rang the gloomy vasts of air;
Seemed the earth to rock and reel;
While adown that fiery breath
Rode the hurtling bolts of death.

Woe for him, the valorous one,
Now a silent clod of clay!
Nevermore for him the sun
Would make glad the paths of day;
Yet 'twere better thus to die
Than to cringe to tyranny!—

Better thus the life to yield,
Striking for the right and God,
Upon Freedom's gory field,
Than to kiss Oppression's rod!
Honor, then, for all time be
To the brave Montgomery!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

SPRUCE Macaronis, and pretty to see,
Tidy and dapper and gallant were we;
Blooded fine gentlemen, proper and tall,
Bold in a fox-hunt and gay at a ball;
Prancing soldados so martial and bluff,
Billets for bullets, in scarlet and buff—
But our cockades were clasped with a mother's low prayer,
And the sweethearts that braided the sword-knots were fair.

There was grummer of drums humming hoarse in the hills,
And the bugles sang fanfaron down by the mills.
By Flatbush the bagpipes were droning amain,
And keen cracked the rifles in Martense's lane;
For the Hessians were flecking the hedges with red,
And the grenadiers' tramp marked the roll of the dead.

Three to one, flank and rear, flashed the files of St. George,
The fierce gleam of their steel as the glow of a forge.
The brutal boom-boom of their swart cannoneers
Was sweet music compared with the taunt of their cheers—
For the brunt of their onset, our crippled array,
And the light of God's leading gone out in the fray.

Oh, the rout on the left and the tug on the right!
The mad plunge of the charge and the wreck of the flight!
When the cohorts of Grant held stout Stirling at strain,
And the mongrels of Hesse went tearing the slain;
When at Freeke's Mill the flumes and the sluices ran red,
And the dead choked the dike and the marsh choked the dead!

“Oh, Stirling, good Stirling, how long must we wait?
Shall the shout of your trumpet unleash us too late?
Have you never a dash for brave Mordecai Gist,
With his heart in his throat, and his blade in his fist?
Are we good for no more than to prance in a ball,
When the drums beat the charge and the clarions call?”

Tralára! Tralára! Now nraise we the Lord

For the clang of His call and the flash of His sword!
Tralára! Tralára! Now forward to die;
For the banner, hurrah! and for sweethearts, good-by!
“Four hundred wild lads!” May be so. I’ll be bound
’Twill be easy to count us, face up, on the ground.
If we hold the road open, though Death take the toll,
We’ll be missed on parade when the States call the roll—
When the flags meet in peace and the guns are at rest,
And fair Freedom is singing Sweet Home in the West.

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

(By special permission of the author.)

ARNOLD AT STILLWATER

AH, you mistake me, comrades, to think that my heart is steel!
Cased in a cold endurance, nor pleasure nor pain to feel;
Cold as I am in my manner, yet over these cheeks so seared
Teardrops have fallen in torrents, thrice since my chin grew beard.

Thrice since my chin was bearded I suffered the tears to fall;
Benedict Arnold, the traitor, he was the cause of them all!
Once, when he carried Stillwater, proud of his valor, I cried;
Then, with my rage at his treason—with pity when André died.

Benedict Arnold, the traitor, sank deep in the pit of shame,
Bartered for vengeance his honor, blackened for profit his fame;
Yet never a gallanter soldier, whatever his after crime,
Fought on the red field of honor than he in his early time.

Ah, I remember Stillwater, as it were yesterday!
Then first I shouldered a firelock, and set out the foemen to slay.
The country was up all around us, racing and chasing Burgoyne,
And I had gone out with my neighbors, Gates and his forces to join.

Marched we with Poor and with Learned, ready and eager to fight;
There stood the foemen before us, cannon and men on the height;
Onward we trod with no shouting, forbidden to fire till the word;
As silent their long line of scarlet—not one of them whispered or stirred.

Suddenly, then, from among them smoke rose and spread on the breeze;
Grapeshot flew over us sharply, cutting the limbs from the trees;
But onward we pressed till the order of Cilley fell full on the ear;
Then we leveled our pieces and fired them, and rushed up the slope with a
cheer.

Fiercely we charged on their center, and beat back the stout grenadiers,
And wounded the brave Major Ackland, and grappled the swart cannoneers;
Five times we captured their cannons, and five times they took them again;
But the sixth time we had them we kept them, and with them a share of their
men.

Our colonel who led us dismounted, high on a cannon he sprang;

Over the noise of our shouting clearly his joyous words rang;
“These are our own brazen beauties! Here to America’s cause
I dedicate each, and to freedom!—foes to King George and his laws!”

Worn as we were with the struggle, wounded and bleeding and sore,
Some stood all pale and exhausted; some lay there stiff in their gore;
And round through the mass went a murmur, that grew to a whispering clear,
And then to reproaches outspoken—“If General Arnold were here!”

For Gates, in his folly and envy, had given the chief no command,
And far in the rear some had seen him horseless and moodily stand,
Knitting his forehead in anger, gnawing his red lip in pain,
Fretting himself like a bloodhound held back from his prey by a chain.

Hark, at our right there is cheering! there is the ruffle of drums!
Here is the well-known brown charger! Spurring it madly he comes!
Learned’s brigade have espied him, rending the air with a cheer;
Woe to the terrified foeman, now that our leader is here!

Piercing the tumult behind him, Armstrong is out on his track;
Gates has dispatched his lieutenant to summon the fugitive back.
Armstrong might summon the tempest, order the whirlwind to stay,
Issue commands to the earthquake—would they the mandate obey?

Wounds, they were healed in a moment! weariness instantly gone!
Forward he pointed his sabre—led us, not ordered us on.
Down on the Hessians we thundered, he, like a madman ahead;
Vainly they strove to withstand us; raging, they shivered and fled.

On to their earthworks we drove them, shaking with ire and dismay;
There they made stand with a purpose to beat back the tide of the day.
Onward we followed, then faltered; deadly their balls whistled free.
Where was our death-daring leader? Arnold, our hope, where was he?

He? He was everywhere riding! hither and thither his form,
On the brown charger careering, showed us the path of the storm;
Over the roar of the cannon, over the musketry’s crash,
Sounded his voice, while his sabre lit up the way with its flash.

Throwing quick glances around him, reining a moment his steed—
“Brooks, that redoubt!” was his order; “let the rest follow my lead!
Mark where the smoke-cloud is parting! see where the gun-barrels glance!
Livingston, forward! On, Wesson, charge them! Let Morgan advance!”

“Forward!” he shouted, and, spurring on through the sally-port then,
Fell sword in hand on the Hessians, closely behind him our men.
Back shrank the foemen in terror; off went their forces pellmell,
Firing one Parthian volley; struck by it, Arnold, he fell.

Ours was the day. Up we raised him; spurted the blood from his knee—
“Take my cravat, boys, and bind it; I am not dead yet,” said he.
“What! did you follow me, Armstrong? Pray, do you think it quite right,
Leaving your duties out yonder, to risk your dear self in the fight?”

“General Gates sent his orders”—faltering the aid-de-camp spoke—
“You’re to return, lest some rashness—” Fiercely the speech Arnold broke:
“Rashness! Why, yes, tell the general the rashness he dreaded is done!
Tell him his kinsfolk are beaten! tell him the battle is won!”

Oh, that a soldier so glorious, ever victorious in fight,
Passed from a daylight of honor into the terrible night!—
Fell as the mighty archangel, ere the earth glowed in space, fell—
Fell from the patriot’s heaven down to the loyalist’s hell!

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

(By special permission of the author, and of Harper and Brothers.)

'Tis of a gallant Yankee ship that flew the Stripes and Stars,
And the whistling wind from the west-nor'-west blew through the pitch-pine
spars,—

With her starboard tacks a-board, my boys, she hung upon the gale,
On an autumn night we raised the light on the old head of Kinsale.

It was a clear and cloudless night, and the wind blew steady and strong,
As gaily over the sparkling deep our good ship bowled along;
With the foaming seas beneath her bow the fiery waves she spread,
And bending low her bosom of snow, she buried her lee cathead.

There was no talk of shortening sail by him who walked the poop,
And under the press of her pondering jib, the boom bent like a hoop!
And the groaning waterways told the strain that held her stout main-tack,
But he only laughed as he glanced abaft at the white and silvery track.

The mid-tide meets in the channel waves that flow from shore to shore,
And the mist hung heavy upon the land from Featherstone to Dunmore;
And that sterling light on Tusker rock, where the old bell tolls the hour,
And the beacon light that shone so bright was quenched on Waterford tower.

The nightly robes our good ship wore were her three topsails set,
The spanker and her standing jib, the spanker being fast;
“Now, lay aloft, my heroes bold, let not a moment pass!”
And royals and topgallant sails were quickly on each mast.

What looms upon the starboard bow? What hangs upon the breeze?
'Tis time our good ship hauled her wind abreast the old Saltees;
For by her ponderous press of sail and by her consorts four
We saw our morning visitor was a British man-of-war.

Up spoke our noble captain then, as a shot ahead of us passed,
“Haul snug your flowing courses, lay your topsail to the mast!”
The Englishmen gave three loud hurrahs from the deck of their covered ark,
And we answered back by a solid broadside from the decks of our patriot
bark.

“Out, booms! Out, booms!” our skipper cried, “Out, booms, and give her

sheet!”

And the swiftest keel that ever was launched shot ahead of the British fleet.
And amidst a thundering shower of shot, with stunsails hoisting away,
Down the North Channel Paul Jones did steer, just at the break of day.

ANONYMOUS.

THE RIDE OF JENNIE M'NEAL

PAUL REVERE was a rider bold—
Well has his valorous deed been told;
Sheridan's ride was a glorious one—
Often has it been dwelt upon.
But why should men do all the deeds
On which the love of a patriot feeds?
Hearken to me, while I reveal
The dashing ride of Jennie M'Neal.

On a spot as pretty as might be found
In the dangerous length of the Neutral Ground,
In a cottage, cosy, and all their own,
She and her mother lived alone.
Safe were the two, with their frugal store,
From all of the many who passed their door;
For Jennie's mother was strange to fears,
And Jennie was large for fifteen years;
With vim her eyes were glistening,
Her hair was the hue of the blackbird's wing;
And while the friends who knew her well
The sweetness of her heart could tell,
A gun that hung on the kitchen wall
Looked solemnly quick to heed her call;
And they who were evil-minded knew
Her nerve was strong and her aim was true.
So all kind words and acts did deal
To generous, black-eyed Jennie M'Neal.

One night when the sun had crept to bed,
And rain clouds lingered overhead,
And sent their surly drops for proof
To drum a tune on the cottage roof,
Close after a knock at the outer door,
There entered a dozen dragoons or more.
Their red coats, stained by the muddy road,
That they were British soldiers showed;
The captain his hostess bent to greet,

saying, "Madam, please give us a bit to eat;
We will pay you well, and, if may be,
This bright-eyed girl for pouring our tea;
Then we must dash ten miles ahead,
To catch a rebel colonel abed.
He is visiting home, as doth appear;
We will make his pleasure cost him dear."
And they fell on the hasty supper with zeal,
Close-watched the while by Jennie M'Neal.

For the gray-haired colonel they hovered near
Had been her true friend, kind and dear;
And oft, in her younger days, had he
Right proudly perched her upon his knee,
And told her stories many a one
Concerning the French war lately done.
And oft together the two friends were,
And many the arts he had taught to her;
She had hunted by his fatherly side,
He had shown her how to fence and ride;
And once had said, "The time may be,
Your skill and courage may stand by me."
So sorrow for him she could but feel,
Brave, grateful-hearted Jennie M'Neal.

With never a thought or a moment more,
Bare-headed she slipped from the cottage door,
Ran out where the horses were left to feed,
Unhitched and mounted the captain's steed,
And down the hilly and rock-strewn way
She urged the fiery horse of gray.
Around her slender and cloakless form
Pattered and moaned the ceaseless storm;
Secure and tight, a gloveless hand
Grasped the reins with stern command;
And full and black her long hair streamed
Whenever the ragged lightning gleamed.
And on she rushed for the colonel's weal,
Brave, lioness-hearted Jennie M'Neal

Brave, merry-hearted Jennie M'Neal.

Hark!—From the hills, a moment mute,
Came a clatter of hoofs in hot pursuit;
And a cry from the foremost trooper said,
“Halt, or your blood be on your head!”
She heeded it not, and not in vain
She lashed the horse with the bridle rein.
So into the night the gray horse strode;
His shoes hewed fire from the rocky road;
And the highborn courage that never dies
Flashed from the rider's coal-black eyes.
The pebbles flew from that fearful race;
The raindrops grasped at her glowing face.
“On, on, brave beast!” with loud appeal,
Cried eager, resolute Jennie M'Neal.

“Halt!” once more came the voice of dread;
“Halt, or your blood be on your head!”
Then, no one answering to the calls,
Sped after her a volley of balls.
They passed her in their rapid flight,
They screamed to her left, they screamed to her right;
But, rushing o'er the slippery track,
She sent no token of answer back,
Except a silvery laughter-peal,
Brave, merry-hearted Jennie M'Neal.

So on she rushed, at her own good will,
Through wood and valley, o'er plain and hill;
The gray horse did his duty well,
Till all at once he stumbled and fell,
Himself escaping the nets of harm,
But flinging the girl with a broken arm.
Still undismayed by the numbing pain,
She clung to the horse's bridle rein,
And gently bidding him to stand,
Petted him with her able hand;
Then sprung again to the saddlebow,

And shouted, "One more trial now!"
As if ashamed of the heedless fall
He gathered his strength once more for all,
And, galloping down a hillside steep,
Gained on the troopers at every leap;
No more the high-bred steed did reel,
But ran his best for Jennie M'Neal.

They were a furlong behind, or more,
When the girl burst through the colonel's door,
Her poor arm hanging helpless with pain,
And she all drabbled and drenched with rain,
But her cheeks as red as firebrands are,
And her eyes as bright as a blazing star;
And shouted, "Quick, be quick, I say!
They come! they come!—away! away!"
Then sunk on the rude white floor of deal,
Poor, brave, exhausted Jennie M'Neal.

The startled colonel sprung, and pressed
The wife and children to his breast,
And turned away from his fireside bright,
And glided into the stormy night;
Then soon and safely made his way
To where the patriot army lay.
But first he bent, in the dim firelight,
And kissed the forehead broad and white,
And blessed the girl who had ridden so well
To keep him out of a prison cell.
The girl roused up at the martial din,
Just as the troopers came rushing in,
And laughed, e'en in the midst of a moan,
Saying, "Good sirs, your bird has flown.
'Tis I who have scared him from his nest;
So deal with me now as you think best."
But the grand young captain bowed, and said,
"Never you hold a moment's dread.
Of womankind I must crown you queen:

So brave a girl I have never seen.
Wear this gold ring as your valor's due,
And when peace comes I will come for you."
But Jennie's face an arch smile wore,
As she said, "There's a lad in Putnam's corps
Who told me the same, long time ago;
You two would never agree, I know.
I promised my love to be true as steel,"
Said good, sure-hearted Jennie M'Neal.

WILL CARLETON.

(By special permission of the author, and of Harper and Brothers.)

SONG OF MARION'S MEN

OUR band is few, but true and tried,
Our leader frank and bold;
The British soldier trembles
When Marion's name is told.
Our fortress is the good greenwood,
Our tent the cypress tree;
We know the forest round us
As seamen know the sea;
We know its walls of thorny vines,
Its glades of reedy grass,
Its safe and silent islands
Within the dark morass.

Woe to the English soldiery
That little dread us near!
On them shall light at midnight
A strange and sudden fear;
When, waking to their tents on fire,
They grasp their arms in vain,
And they who stand to face us
Are beat to earth again;
And they who fly in terror deem
A mighty host behind,
And hear the tramp of thousands
Upon the hollow wind.

Then sweet the hour that brings release
From danger and from toil;
We talk the battle over,
And share the battle's spoil.
The woodland rings with laugh and shout
As if a hunt were up,
And woodland flowers are gathered
To crown the soldier's cup.
With merry songs we mock the wind
That in the pine-top grieves,
And slumber long and sweetly

ON DECS OR OAKEN LEAVES.

Well knows the fair and friendly moon
The band that Marion leads—
The glitter of their rifles,
The scampering of their steeds.
'Tis life to guide the fiery barb
Across the moonlight plain;
'Tis life to feel the night-wind
That lifts his tossing mane.
A moment in the British camp—
A moment—and away,
Back to the pathless forest
Before the peep of day.

Grave men there are by broad Santee,
Grave men with hoary hairs;
Their hearts are all with Marion,
For Marion are their prayers.
And lovely ladies greet our band,
With kindest welcoming,
With smiles like those of summer,
And tears like those of spring.
For them we wear these trusty arms,
And lay them down no more
Till we have driven the Briton
Forever from our shore.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

HOW WE BURNED THE "PHILADELPHIA"

*By the beard of the Prophet the Bashaw swore
He would scourge us from the seas;
Yankees should trouble his soul no more—
By the Prophet's beard the Bashaw swore,
Then lighted his hookah, and took his ease,
And troubled his soul no more.*

THE moon was dim in the western sky,
And a mist fell soft on the sea,
As we slipped away from the *Siren* brig
And headed for Tripoli.

Behind us the hulk of the *Siren* lay,
Before us the empty night;
And when again we looked behind
The *Siren* was gone from our sight.

Nothing behind us, and nothing before,
Only the silence and rain,
As the jaws of the sea took hold of our bows
And cast us up again.

Through the rain and the silence we stole along,
Cautious and stealthy and slow,
For we knew the waters were full of those
Who might challenge the *Mastico*.

But nothing we saw till we saw the ghost
Of the ship we had come to see,
Her ghostly lights and her ghostly frame
Rolling uneasily.

And as we looked, the mist drew up
And the moon threw off her veil,
And we saw the ship in the pale moonlight,
Ghostly and drear and pale.

Then spoke Decatur low and said:

“To the bulwarks’ shadow all!
But the six who wear the Tripoli dress
Shall answer the sentinel’s call.”

“What ship is that?” cried the sentinel.
“No ship,” was the answer free;
“But only a Malta ketch in distress
Wanting to moor in your lee.

“We have lost our anchor, and wait for day
To sail into Tripoli town,
And the sea rolls fierce and high to-night,
So cast a cable down.”

Then close to the frigate’s side we came,
Made fast to her unforbid—
Six of us bold in the heathen dress,
The rest of us lying hid.

But one who saw us hiding there
“*Americano!*” cried.
Then straight we rose and made a rush
Pellmell up the frigate’s side.

Less than a hundred men were we,
And the heathen were twenty score;
But a Yankee sailor in those old days
Liked odds of one to four.

And first we cleaned the quarter deck,
And then from stern to stem
We charged into our enemies
And quickly slaughtered them.

All around was the dreadful sound
Of corpses striking the sea,
And the awful shrieks of dying men
In their last agony.

The heathen fought like devils all,
But one by one they fell,
Swept from the deck by our cutlasses
To the water, and so to hell.

Some we found in the black of the hold,
Some to the fo'c's'le fled,
But all in vain; we sought them out
And left them lying dead;
Till at last no soul but Christian souls
Upon that ship was found;
The twenty score were dead, and we,
The hundred, safe and sound.

And, stumbling over the tangled dead,
The deck a crimson tide,
We fired the ship from keel to shrouds
And tumbled over the side.

Then out to sea we sailed once more,
With the world as light as day,
And the flames revealed a hundred sail
Of the heathen there in the bay.

All suddenly the red light paled,
And the rain rang out on the sea;
Then—a dazzling flash, a deafening roar,
Between us and Tripoli!

Then, nothing behind us, and nothing before,
Only the silence and rain;
And the jaws of the sea took hold of our bows
And cast us up again.

*By the beard of the Prophet the Bashaw swore
He would scourge us from the seas;
Yankees should trouble his soul no more—
By the Prophet's beard the Bashaw swore.
Then lighted his hookah, and took his ease,*

And troubled his soul no more.

BARRETT EASTMAN.

(By special permission of the author.)

11

THE "SHANNON" AND THE "CHESAPEAKE"

THE captain of the *Shannon* came sailing up the bay,
A reeling wind flung out behind his pennons bright and gay;
His cannon crashed a challenge; the smoke that hid the sea
Was driven hard to windward and drifted back to lee.

The captain of the *Shannon* sent word into the town:
Was Lawrence there, and would he dare to sail his frigate down
And meet him at the harbor's mouth and fight him, gun to gun,
For honor's sake, with pride at stake, until the fight was won?

Now, long the gallant Lawrence had scoured the bitter main;
With many a scar and wound of war his ship was home again;
His crew, relieved from service, were scattered far and wide,
And scarcely one, his duty done, had lingered by his side.

But to refuse the challenge? Could he outlive the shame?
Brave men and true, but deadly few, he gathered to his fame.
Once more the great ship *Chesapeake* prepared her for the fight,—
“I'll bring the foe to town in tow,” he said, “before to-night!”

High on the hills of Hingham that overlook the shore,
To watch the fray and hope and pray, for they could do no more,
The children of the country watched the children of the sea
When the smoke drove hard to windward and drifted back to lee.

“How can he fight,” they whispered, “with only half a crew,
Though they be rare to do and dare, yet what can brave men do?”
But when the *Chesapeake* came down, the Stars and Stripes on high,
Stilled was each fear, and cheer on cheer resounded to the sky.

The captain of the *Shannon*, he swore both long and loud:
“This victory, where'er it be, shall make two nations proud!
Now onward to this victory or downward to defeat!
A sailor's life is sweet with strife, a sailor's death as sweet.”

And as when lightnings rend the sky and gloomy thunders roar,
And crashing surge plays devil's dirge upon the stricken shore,
With thunder and with sheets of flame the two ships rang with shot,

And every gun burst forth a sun of iron crimson-hot.

And twice they lashed together and twice they tore apart,
And iron balls burst wooden walls and pierced each oaken heart.
Still from the hills of Hingham men watched with hopes and fears,
While all the bay was torn that day with shot that rained like tears.

The tall masts of the *Chesapeake* went groaning by the board;
The *Shannon*'s spars were weak with scars when Broke cast down his sword:
"Now woe," he cried, "to England, and shame and woe to me!"
The smoke drove hard to windward and drifted back to lee.

"Give them one breaking broadside more," he cried, "before we strike!"
But one grim ball that ruined all for hope and home alike
Laid Lawrence low in glory, yet from his pallid lip
Rang to the land his last command: "Boys, don't give up the ship!"

The wounded wept like women when they hauled her ensign down.
Men's cheeks were pale as with the tale from Hingham to the town
They hurried swift in silence, while toward the eastern night
The victor bore away from shore and vanished out of sight.

Hail to the great ship *Chesapeake*! Hail to the hero brave
Who fought her fast, and loved her last, and shared her sudden grave!
And glory be to those that died, for all eternity;
They lie apart at the mother-heart of God's eternal sea.

THOMAS TRACY BOUVÉ.

(By special permission of the author, and of *The Youth's Companion*.)

Tell the story to your sons
Of the gallant days of yore,
When the brig of seven guns
Fought the fleet of seven score,
From the set of sun till morn, through the long September night—
Ninety men against two thousand, and the ninety won the fight
In the harbor of Fayal the Azore.

Three lofty British ships came a-sailing to Fayal:
One was a line-of-battle ship, and two were frigates tall;
Nelson's valiant men of war, brave as Britons ever are,
Manned the guns they served so well at Aboukir and Trafalgar.
Lord Dundonald and his fleet at Jamaica far away
Waited eager for their coming, fretted sore at their delay.
There was loot for British valor on the Mississippi coast
In the beauty and the booty that the Creole cities boast;
There were rebel knaves to swing, there were prisoners to bring
Home in fetters to old England for the glory of the King!

At the setting of the sun and the ebbing of the tide
Came the great ships one by one, with their portals opened wide,
And their cannon frowning down on the castle and the town
And the privateer that lay close inside;
Came the eighteen-gun *Carnation*, and the *Rota*, forty-four,
And the triple-decked *Plantagenet* an Admiral's pennon bore;
And the privateer grew smaller as their topmasts towered taller,
And she bent her springs and anchored by the castle on the shore.

Spoke the noble Portuguese to the stranger: "Have no fear;
They are neutral waters these, and your ship is sacred here
As if fifty stout armadas stood to shelter you from harm,
For the honor of the Briton will defend you from his arm."
But the privateersman said, "Well we know the Englishmen,
And their faith is written red in the Dartmoor slaughter-pen.
Come what fortune God may send, we will fight them to the end,
And the mercy of the sharks may spare us then."

"Seize the pirate where she lies!" cried the English Admiral.

Seize the prize where she lies," cried the English Admiral.
"If the Portuguese protect her, all the worse for Portugal!"
And four launches at his bidding leaped impatient for the fray,
Speeding shoreward where the *Armstrong*, grim and dark and ready, lay.
Twice she hailed and gave them warning; but the feeble menace scorning,
On they came in splendid silence, till a cable's length away.
Then the Yankee pivot spoke; Pico's thousand echoes woke;
And four baffled, beaten launches drifted helpless on the bay.

Then the wrath of Lloyd arose till the lion roared again,
And he called out all his launches and he called five hundred men;
And he gave the word "No quarter!" and he sent them forth to smite.
Heaven help the foe before him when the Briton comes in might!
Heaven helped the little *Armstrong* in her hour of bitter need;
God Almighty nerved the heart and guided well the arm of Reid.

Launches to port and starboard, launches forward and aft,
Fourteen launches together striking the little craft.
They hacked at the boarding-nettings, they swarmed above the rail;
But the Long Tom roared from his pivot and the grapeshot fell like hail;
Pike and pistol and cutlass, and hearts that knew not fear,
Bulwarks of brawn and mettle, guarded the privateer.
And ever where fight was fiercest the form of Reid was seen:
Ever where foes drew nearest, his quick sword fell between.

Once in the deadly strife
The boarder's leader pressed
Forward of all the rest
Challenging life for life;
But ere their blades had crossed
A dying sailor tossed
His pistol to Reid, and cried,
"Now riddle the lubber's hide!"

But the privateersman laughed, and flung the weapon aside,
And he drove his blade to the hilt, and the foeman gasped and died.
Then the boarders took to their launches, laden with hurt and dead,
But little with glory burdened, and out of the battle fled.

Now the tide was at flood again, and the night was almost done,
When the sloop-of-war came up with her odds of two to one,

And she opened fire; but the *Armstrong* answered her, gun for gun,
And the gay *Carnation* wilted in half an hour of sun.

Then the *Armstrong*, looking seaward, saw the mighty seventy-four,
With her triple tier of cannon, drawing slowly to the shore.
And the dauntless captain said: "Take our wounded and our dead,
Bear them tenderly to land, for the *Armstrong's* days are o'er;
But no foe shall tread her deck, and no flag above it wave—
To the ship that saved our honor we will give a shipman's grave."
So they did as he commanded, and they bore their mates to land
With the figurehead of *Armstrong* and the good sword in his hand.
Then they turned the Long Tom downward, and they pierced her oaken side,
And they cheered her, and they blessed her, and they sunk her in the tide.

Tell the story to your sons,
When the haughty stranger boasts
Of his mighty ships and guns
And the muster of his hosts,
How the word of God was witnessed in the gallant days of yore
When the twenty fled from one ere the rising of the sun,
In the harbor of Fayal the Azore!

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

(By special permission of the author, and of Houghton, Mifflin and
Company.)

To Houston at Gonzales town, ride, Ranger, for your life,
Nor stop to say good-by to-day to home, or child, or wife;
But pass the word from ranch to ranch, to every Texan sword,
That fifty hundred Mexicans have crossed the Nueces ford,
With Castrillon and perjured Cos, Sesmá and Almontê,
And Santa Anna ravenous for vengeance and for prey!
They smite the land with fire and sword; the grass shall never grow
Where northward sweeps that locust horde on San Antonio!

Now who will bar the foeman's path, to gain a breathing space,
Till Houston and his scattered men shall meet him face to face?
Who holds his life as less than naught when home and honor call,
And counts the guerdon full and fair for liberty to fall?
Oh, who but Barrett Travis, the bravest of them all!
With seven score of riflemen to play the rancher's game,
And feed a counter-fire to halt the sweeping prairie flame;
For Bowie of the broken blade is there to cheer them on,
With Evans of Concepcion, who conquered Castrillon,
And o'er their heads the Lone Star flag defiant floats on high,
And no man thinks of yielding, and no man fears to die.

But ere the siege is held a week a cry is heard without,
A clash of arms, a rifle peal, the Ranger's ringing shout,
And two-and-thirty beardless boys have bravely hewed their way
To die with Travis if they must, to conquer if they may.
Was ever valor held so cheap in Glory's mart before
In all the days of chivalry, in all the deeds of war?
But once again the foemen gaze in wonderment and fear
To see a stranger break their lines and hear the Texans cheer.
God! how they cheered to welcome him, those spent and starving men!
For Davy Crockett by their side was worth an army then.
The wounded ones forgot their wounds; the dying drew a breath
To hail the king of border men, then turned to laugh at death.
For all knew Davy Crockett, blithe and generous as bold,
And strong and rugged as the quartz that hides its heart of gold.
His simple creed for word or deed true as the bullet sped,
And rung the target straight: "Be sure you're right, then go ahead!"

And were they right who fought the fight for Texas by his side?
They questioned not; they faltered not; they only fought and died.
Who hath an enemy like these, God's mercy slay him straight!—
A thousand Mexicans lay dead outside the convent gate,
And half a thousand more must die before the fortress falls,
And still the tide of war beats high around the leaguered walls.
At last the bloody breach is won; the weakened lines give way;
The wolves are swarming in the court; the lions stand at bay.
The leader meets them at the breach, and wins the soldier's prize;
A foeman's bosom sheathes his sword when gallant Travis dies.
Now let the victor feast at will until his crest be red—
We may not know what raptures fill the vulture with the dead.

Let Santa Anna's valiant sword right bravely hew and hack
The senseless corse; its hands are cold; they will not strike him back.
Let Bowie die, but 'ware the hand that wields his deadly knife;
Four went to slay, and one comes back, so dear he sells his life.
And last of all let Crockett fall, too proud to sue for grace,
So grand in death the butcher dared not look upon his face.

But far on San Jacinto's field the Texan toils are set,
And Alamo's dread memory the Texan steel shall whet.
And Fame shall tell their deeds who fell till all the years be run.
"Thermopylæ left one alive—the Alamo left none."

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

(By special permission of the author, and of Houghton, Mifflin and
Company.)

“Now for a brisk and a cheerful fight!”
Said Harman, big and droll,
As he coaxed his flint and steel for a light,
And puffed at his cold clay bowl;
“For we are a skulking lot,” says he,
“Of land-thieves hereabout,
And the bold señores, two to one,
Have come to smoke us out.”

Santa Anna and Castrillon,
Almontê brave and gay,
Portilla red from Goliad,
And Cos with his smart array.
Dulces and cigaritos,
And the light guitar, ting-tum!
Sant’ Anna courts siesta—
And Sam Houston taps his drum.

The buck stands still in the timber—
“Is it patter of nuts that fall?”
The foal of the wild mare whinnies—
“Did he hear the Comanche call?”
In the brake by the crawling bayou
The slinking she-wolves howl,
And the mustang’s snort in the river sedge
Has startled the paddling fowl.

A soft low tap, and a muffled tap,
And a roll not loud nor long—
We would not break Sant’ Anna’s nap,
Nor spoil Almontê’s song.
Saddles and knives and rifles!
Lord! but the men were glad
When Deaf Smith muttered “Alamo!”
And Karnes hissed “Goliad!”

The drummer tucked his sticks in his belt,
And the fifer grinned his grin

And he never gripped his gun.
Oh, for one free, wild Texan yell,
And we took the slope in a run!
But never a shout nor a shot we spent,
Nor an oath nor a prayer that day,
Till we faced the bravos, eye to eye,
And then we blazed away.

Then we knew the rapture of Ben Milam,
And the glory that Travis made,
With Bowie's lunge and Crockett's shot,
And Fannin's dancing blade;
And the heart of the fighter, bounding free
In his joy so hot and mad—
When Millard charged for Alamo,
Lamar for Goliad.

Deaf Smith rode straight, with reeking spur,
Into the shock and rout:
"I've hacked and burned the bayou bridge,
There's no sneak's back-way out!"
Muzzle or butt for Goliad,
Pistol and blade and fist!
Oh, for the knife that never glanced,
And the gun that never missed!

Dulces and cigaritos,
Song and the mandolin!
That gory swamp was a gruesome grove
To dance fandangos in.
We bridged the bog with the sprawling herd
That fell in that frantic rout;
We slew and slew till the sun set red,
And the Texan star flashed out.

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

(By special permission of the author, and of Herbert S. Stone and
Company.)

WE were not many—we who stood
Before the iron sleet that day;
Yet many a gallant spirit would
Give half his years if he but could
Have been with us at Monterey.

Now here, now there, the shot it hailed
In deadly drifts of fiery spray,
Yet not a single soldier quailed
When wounded comrades round them wailed
Their dying shout at Monterey.

And on, still on, our column kept,
Through walls of flame, its withering way;
Where fell the dead the living stept,
Still charging on the guns which swept
The slippery streets of Monterey.

The foe himself recoiled aghast,
When, striking where he strongest lay,
We swooped his flanking batteries past,
And, braving full their murderous blast,
Stormed home the towers of Monterey.

Our banners on those turrets wave,
And there our evening bugles play,
Where orange boughs above their grave
Keep green the memory of the brave
Who fought and fell at Monterey.

We are not many—we who pressed
Beside the brave who fell that day;
But who of us has not confessed
He'd rather share their warrior rest
Than not have been at Monterey?

CHARLES FENNO HOFFMAN.

THE DEFENSE OF LAWRENCE

ALL night upon the guarded hill,
 Until the stars were low,
 Wrapped round as with Jehovah's will,
 We waited for the foe;
 All night the silent sentinels
 Moved by like gliding ghosts;
 All night the fancied warning bells
 Held all men to their posts.

We heard the sleeping prairies breathe,
The forest's human moans,
The hungry gnashing of the teeth
Of wolves on bleaching bones;
We marked the roar of rushing fires,
The neigh of frightened steeds,
The voices as of far-off lyres
Among the river reeds.

We were but thirty-nine who lay
Beside our rifles then;
We were but thirty-nine, and they
Were twenty hundred men.
Our lean limbs shook and reeled about,
Our feet were gashed and bare,
And all the breezes shredded out
Our garments in the air.

They came: the blessed Sabbath day,
That soothed our swollen veins,
Like God's sweet benediction, lay
On all the singing plains;
The valleys shouted to the sun,
The great woods clapped their hands,
And joy and glory seemed to run
Like rivers through the lands.

And then our daughters and our wives,
And men whose heads were white

And men whose heads were white,
Rose sudden into kingly lives
And walked forth to the fight;
And we drew aim along our guns
And calmed our quickening breath,
Then, as is meet for Freedom's sons,
Shook loving hands with Death.

And when three hundred of the foe
Rode up in scorn and pride,
Whoso had watched us then might know
That God was on our side;
For all at once a mighty thrill
Of grandeur through us swept,
And strong and swiftly down the hill
Like Gideons we leapt.

And all throughout that Sabbath day
A wall of fire we stood,
And held the baffled foe at bay,
And streaked the ground with blood.
And when the sun was very low
They wheeled their stricken flanks,
And passed on, wearily and slow,
Beyond the river banks.

Beneath the everlasting stars
We bended child-like knees,
And thanked God for the shining scars
Of His large victories.
And some, who lingered, said they heard
Such wondrous music pass
As though a seraph's voice had stirred
The pulses of the grass.

RICHARD REALF.

(From *Poems*, by Richard Realf. Copyright, Funk and Wagnalls
Company, 1898. By special permission.)

EIGHTY and nine, with their captain,
Rode on the enemy's track.
Rode in the gray of the morning—
Nine of the ninety came back.

Slow rose the mist from the river,
Lighter each moment the way;
Careless and tearless and fearless
Galloped they on to the fray.

Singing in tune, how the scabbards
Loud on the stirrup-irons rang!
Clinked as the men rose in saddle,
Fell, as they sank, with a clang.

What is it moves by the river,
Jaded, and weary, and weak?
Graybacks,—a cross on their banner,—
Yonder the foe whom they seek.

Silence! they see not, they hear not,
Tarrying there by the marge;
Forward! draw sabre! trot! gallop!
Charge! like a hurricane—*Charge!*

Ah, 'twas a man-trap infernal!—
Fire like the deep pit of hell!
Volley on volley to meet them,
Mixed with the gray rebels' yell.

Ninety had ridden to battle,
Tracing the enemy's track,—
Ninety had ridden to battle;
Nine of the ninety came back.

Honor the name of the ninety!
Honor the heroes who came
Scathless from five hundred muskets

Sealiness from five hundred muskets,
Safe from the lead-bearing flame!

Eighty and one of the troopers
Lie on the field of the slain,—
Lie on the red field of honor;
Honor the nine who remain!

Cold are the dead there, and gory,
There where their life-blood was spilt;
Back come the living, each sabre
Red from the point to the hilt.

Up with three cheers and a “tiger!”
Let the flags wave as they come!
Give them the blare of the trumpet!
Give them the roll of the drum!

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

(By special permission of the author, and of Harper and Brothers.)

'Tis of a little drummer,
The story I shall tell;
Of how he marched to battle,
Of all that there befell.
Out in the west with Lyon
(For once the name was true!)
For whom the little drummer beat
His *rat-tat-too*.

Our army rose at midnight,
Ten thousand men as one,
Each slinging off his knapsack
And snatching up his gun.
“*Forward!*” and off they started,
As all good soldiers do,
When the little drummer beats for them
The *rat-tat-too*.

Across a rolling country,
Where the mist began to rise;
Past many a blackened farmhouse,
Till the sun was in the skies;
Then we met the rebel pickets,
Who skirmished and withdrew,
While the little drummer beat, and beat
The *rat-tat-too*.

Along the wooded hollows
The line of battle ran,
Our center poured a volley,
And the fight at once began;
For the rebels answered shouting,
And a shower of bullets flew;
But still the little drummer beat
His *rat-tat-too*.

He stood among his comrades,

As they quickly formed the line,
And when they raised their muskets
He watched the barrels shine.
When the volley rang, he started,
For war to him was new;
But still the little drummer beat
His *rat-tat-too*.

It was a sight to see them,
That early autumn day,
Our soldiers in their blue coats,
And the rebel ranks in gray;
The smoke that rolled between them,
The balls that whistled through,
And the little drummer as he beat
His *rat-tat-too!*

His comrades dropped around him,—
By fives and tens they fell,
Some pierced by minie bullets,
Some torn by shot and shell;
They played against our cannon,
And a caisson's splinters flew;
But still the little drummer beat
His *rat-tat-too!*

The right, the left, the center,—
The fight was everywhere;
They pushed us here,—we wavered,—
We drove and broke them there.
The graybacks fixed their bayonets,
And charged the coats of blue,
But still the little drummer beat
His *rat-tat-too!*

“Where is our little drummer?”
His nearest comrades say,
When the dreadful fight is over,
And the drums are all dead and dry,

And the smoke has cleared away.
As the rebel corps was scattering
He urged them to pursue,
So furiously he beat, and beat
The *rat-tat-too*!

He stood no more among them,
For a bullet, as it sped,
Had glanced and struck his ankle,
And stretched him with the dead!
He crawled behind a cannon,
And pale and paler grew;
But still the little drummer beat
His *rat-tat-too*!

They bore him to the surgeon,
A busy man was he:
“A drummer boy—what ails him?”
His comrades answered, “See!”
As they took him from the stretcher
A heavy breath he drew,
And his little fingers strove to beat
The *rat-tat-too*!

The ball had spent its fury:
“A scratch!” the surgeon said,
As he wound the snowy bandage
Which the lint was staining red.
“I must leave you now, old fellow!”
“Oh, take me back with you,
For I know the men are missing me
And the *rat-tat-too*!”

Upon his comrade’s shoulder
They lifted him so grand,
With his dusty drum before him,
And his drumsticks in his hand!
To the fiery front of battle,

That

That nearer, nearer drew,—
And evermore he beat, and beat
His *rat-tat-too*!

The wounded as he passed them
Looked up and gave a cheer;
And one in dying blessed him,
Between a smile and tear.
And the graybacks—they are flying
Before the coats of blue,
For whom the little drummer beats
His *rat-tat-too*.

When the west was red with sunset,
The last pursuit was o'er;
Brave Lyon rode the foremost,
And looked the name he bore.
And before him on his saddle,
As a weary child would do,
Sat the little drummer, fast asleep,
With his *rat-tat-too*.

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

(By special permission of the author.)

At anchor in Hampton Roads we lay,
On board of the *Cumberland*, sloop-of-war;
And at times from the fortress across the bay
The alarum of drums swept past,
Or a bugle blast
From the camp on the shore.

Then far away to the south uprose
A little feather of snow-white smoke,
And we knew that the iron ship of our foes
Was steadily steering its course
To try the force
Of our ribs of oak.

Down upon us heavily runs,
Silent and sullen, the floating fort;
Then comes a puff of smoke from her guns,
And leaps the terrible death,
With fiery breath,
From each open port.

We are not idle, but send her straight
Defiance back in a full broadside!
As hail rebounds from a roof of slate,
Rebounds our heavier hail
From each iron scale
Of the monster's hide.

"Strike your flag!" the rebel cries,
In his arrogant old plantation strain.
"Never!" our gallant Morris replies;
"It is better to sink than to yield!"
And the whole air pealed
With the cheers of our men.

Then, like a kraken huge and black,
She crushed our ribs in her iron grasp!

Down went the *Cumberland* all a wrack,
 With a sudden shudder of death,
 And the cannon's breath
For her dying gasp.

Next morn, as the sun rose over the bay,
 Still floated our flag at the mainmast head,
Lord, how beautiful was Thy day!
 Every waft of the air
 Was a whisper of prayer,
Or a dirge for the dead.

Ho, brave hearts that went down in the seas!
 Ye are at peace in the troubled stream;
Ho, brave land, with hearts like these,
 Thy flag, that is rent in twain,
 Shall be one again,
And without a seam!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

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JOHNSTON AT SHILOH

A CONFEDERATE SOLDIER'S STORY

'Mid dim and solemn forests, in the dawning chill and gray,
Over dank, unrustling leaves, or through stiff and sodden clay,
With never a fife or bugle, or mutter of rumbling drum,
With shivering forms and solemn souls the Southern soldiers come;
Their long lines vanishing in mist as onward they are sweeping,
With step as silent as the dawn's, to where the foe is sleeping.
A challenge!—"Halt!"—The expected shot,—and then a dozen more,
Like pebbles pattering down the steep the avalanche before;
And then a rush, and then a yell, and then a blinding glare,
And then a crash to lift the feet resounding everywhere!
Now vanish chill and solemn thoughts, now burns the frenzied blood;
The tottering tents toss to and fro upon the driving flood,
And the campfires flash and darken fast beneath the masses' tread—
Now smoke behind in scattered brands 'mid wounded men and dead.
And forward crowd the fugitives in panic-driven race;
In vain in bush, ravine, and brake they hunt a hiding-place;
For still that long line onward sweeps unbroken far and near,
As War himself, with pinions bowed, were screaming in their rear.

But far beyond the panic's reach the foe is forming fast,
And in our path stands rank on rank of long battalions massed.
Now, Southern soldiers, nerve your hearts and gather up your strength,
The time of trial waited for is come to you at length!
A hundred pieces open, and their shrieking missiles pour,
While full ten thousand muskets flash and mingle in the roar,
Till the cannon's boom is swallowed in the din of musketry,
As the booming of the ocean when the thunders crash on high.
But momentarily our laboring lines are charging o'er the field,
And forcing back the stubborn ranks that only inches yield;
For at every fence they rally and oppose our surging flood,
Till their dead lie heaped before us wherever they have stood.
A Southern regiment there is matched against a full brigade,
And not a hundred yards apart in open field arrayed;
A brook half way between them through a copse of willows glides,
There's not a rock, fence, log, or tree to shelter ours besides.
But stubbornly, undauntedly, with ne'er a cheer or shout,
With hands too busy for their lips they deal their volleys out.

Again the battle gathers strength on yonder wooded hill,
Behind whose awful batteries fresh ranks are forming still;
A reeking veil of undergrowth divides the hostile lines,
But lurid through its tangled web the vivid lightning shines!
And so affrighting Death appears behind that dreadful pall,
The stoutest spirit hesitates and flinches from his call.
Now who will pierce that curtain dire and meet the battle's brunt,
Before their armies gather there and burst upon our front?
Again the stern, portentous cry of "bayonets" is heard,
But not again the serried line springs forward at the word;
Behind the trees as skirmishers the cowering soldiers hide,
And from afar the harmless trade of musket balls is plied.
In vain, in vain their leaders shout, they cannot make them stir,
But perish singly in the lead with scarce a follower!

But hark, a sound of hoofs behind, a clang of sabres loud!
I see a squad of mighty men go by me like a cloud!
As the immortals rode to war when Hector fought for Troy,
These ride, as if immortals, too, inspired with awful joy.
Before them spurs their leader with a form that fills the air,
So does his bearing fill their eyes, as if a god were there!
Look how he goes to battle with a glory on his brow,
As if prophetic Victory held laurels o'er it now!
They are racing to the rescue: it is Johnston rides before;
God grant they be in time to turn the battle's tide once more!
I hear their shoutings in the din; I hear the cries to "form,"
I see a stiffening battle-line take shape within the swarm;
And again the rank advances with an impetus of wrath,
Their chieftain's rage in every heart impels them on their path.
A thousand rifles leveled low, but every rifle dumb,
The beating of a thousand feet upon a monster drum,
A surging of the war cloud as they disappear beneath,
A sickening of the spirit and a gasping of the breath;
Redoubled din—a lull—a cheer; I would the smoke would go!
Oh, see our swooping battle flags! Oh, see the fleeing foe!
Now glory to those gallant men! and Father, to Thy hand
To-morrow shall our praises ring throughout our stricken land!

to-morrow shall our praises ring throughout our sackerd land.

But where is he who rallied them? I miss his charger there;
I see him now 'midst yonder three whose saddles all are bare;
And two men staggering with a load this side of them I see;
Oh, who is it they carry in their arms so tenderly?
They lay him gently on the leaves. Ah, well I know him now!
I know that lordly figure and that grand imperial brow!
'Tis he; but oh, how prostrate is that form which filled the air!
And his the pallid face; but look, the glory still is there!

Oh, ye daughters of Kentucky, ere your pæans are begun,
Your lips shall falter when they tell how Shiloh's fight was won!
Your hands shall weave the victor crown of laurels, but in vain;
His marble brow shall never feel, nor pulse beat quick again.
Oh, South, be sure a heart so pure had never loved so well!
A country which had wronged him sore he pardoned ere he fell.

FLEMING JAMES.

THE RIVER FIGHT

WOULD you hear of the river fight?
It was two of a soft spring night;
God's stars looked down on all,
And all was clear and bright
But the low fog's chilling breath;—
Up the River of Death
Sailed the great Admiral.

On our high poop-deck he stood,
And round him ranged the men
Who have made their birthright good
Of manhood once and again,—
Lords of helm and of sail,
Tried in tempest and gale.

Who could fail with him?
Who reckon of life or limb?
Not a pulse but beat the higher!
There had you seen, by the starlight dim
Five hundred faces strong and grim;
The Flag is going under fire!
Right up by the fort
With her helm hard aport,
The *Hartford* is going under fire!

First, as we answered their flash,
'Twas lightning and black eclipse,
With a bellowing roll and crash.
But soon upon either bow,
What with forts and fire-rafts and ships,
(The whole fleet was hard at it now,
All pounding away!) and Porter
Still thundering with shell and mortar,—
'Twas the mighty sound and form
Of an equatorial storm.

But, as we worked along higher,

Just where the river enlarges,
Down came a pyramid of fire,—
It was one of your long coal barges.
(We had oft had the like before!)
'Twas coming down to larboard,
Well in with the eastern shore.
And our pilot, to let it pass round,
(You may guess we never stopped to sound,)
Giving us a rank sheer to starboard,
Ran the Flag hard and fast aground!

'Twas nigh abreast of the upper fort,
And straightway a rascal ram
(She was shaped like the devil's dam!)
Puffed away for us, with a snort,
And shoved it, with spiteful strength,
Right alongside of us, to port;—
It was all of our ship's length,
A huge crackling cradle of the pit,
Pitch-pine knots to the brim,
Belching flame red and grim;—
What a roar came up from it!

In a twinkling the flames had risen
Half way to the main-top and mizzen,
Darting up the shrouds like snakes!
Ah, how we clanked at the brakes!
And the deep steam-pumps throbbed under,
Sending a ceaseless flow;—
Our top-men, a dauntless crowd,
Swarmed in rigging and shroud;—
There, ('twas a wonder!)
The burning ratlins and strands
They quenched with their bare hard hands;
But the great guns below
Never silenced their thunder!

At last, by backing and sounding,

When we were clear of grounding,
And under headway once more,
The whole rebel fleet came rounding
The point;—if we had it hot before,
'Twas now, from shore to shore,
One long, loud thundering roar,—
Such crashing, splintering, and pounding,
And smashing as you never heard before!
For all above was battle,
Broadside, and blaze, and rattle,
Smoke and thunder alone!—
(But, down in the sick-bay,
Where our wounded and dying lay,
There was scarce a sob or a moan.)

And at last, when the dim day broke,
And the sullen sun awoke,
Drearly blinking
O'er the haze and the cannon-smoke,
That ever such morning dulls,
There were thirteen hulls
On fire and sinking!

And on the dolorous strand,
To greet the victor-brave,
One flag did welcome wave,
Raised, ah, me! by a wretched hand,
All outworn on our cruel land,
The withered hand of a slave!

'Tis well to do and dare,—
But ever may grateful prayer
Follow, as aye it ought,
When the good fight is fought,
When the true deed is done!
Aloft in heaven's pure light,
(Deep azure crossed on white)
Our fair church-pennant waves

O'er a thousand thankful braves,
Bareheaded in God's bright sun.

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

24

KEARNY AT SEVEN PINES

So that soldierly legend is still on its journey,—
That story of Kearny who knew not to yield!
'Twas the day when with Jameson, fierce Berry, and Birney,
Against twenty thousand he rallied the field.
Where the red volleys poured, where the clamor rose highest,
Where the dead lay in clumps through the dwarf oak and pine,
Where the aim from the thicket was surest and nighest,—
No charge like Phil Kearny's along the whole line.

When the battle went ill, and the bravest were solemn,
Near the dark Seven Pines, where we still held our ground,
He rode down the length of the withering column,
And his heart at our war-cry leapt up with a bound;
He snuffed, like his charger, the wind of the powder,—
His sword waved us on and we answered the sign:
Loud our cheer as we rushed, but his laugh rang the louder,
“There's the devil's own fun, boys, along the whole line!”

How he strode his brown steed! How we saw his blade brighten
In the one hand still left,—and the reins in his teeth!
He laughed like a boy when the holidays heighten,
But his soldier's glance shot from his visor beneath.
Up came the reserves to the mellay infernal,
Asking where to go in,—through the clearing or pine?
“Oh, anywhere! Forward! 'Tis all the same, Colonel:
You'll find lovely fighting along the whole line!”

Oh, evil the black shroud of night at Chantilly,
That hid him from sight of his brave men and tried!
Foul, foul sped the bullet that clipped the white lily,
The flower of our knighthood, the whole army's pride!
Yet we dream that he still,—in that shadowy region
Where the dead form their ranks at the wan drummer's sign,—
Rides on, as of old, down the length of his legion,
And the word still is “Forward!” along the whole line.

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

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Company.)

25

AN UNKNOWN HERO

SWEET Malvern Hill is wreathed in flame,
From serried ranks the steel is gleaming;
Our legions march to death and fame,
Their battle flags right wildly streaming.
Each hero bares his manly breast,
And gallant hearts are fiercely beating;
With steady tramp they line the crest
O'er which an iron hail is sleeting.

Up loom the bastions grim and large
Through battle smoke that's lowering near them;
The little drummers roll the charge,
And dying comrades raise to cheer them.
Twice forty guns with deadly aim
Strike down our lines in tones of thunder;
Yet still they press, with eyes aflame,
Till Valor's self looks on in wonder.

But now the human tide rolls back,
A ghastly remnant grim and gory;
And countless heroes mark the track
Which led them up to heights of glory.
But one still presses on amain
Where double-shotted guns are frowning,
Above, amidst the iron rain,
He nobly wins a hero's crowning.

Through all the battle smoke he'd seen
The saintly forms of angels bearing
The laurel crowns forever green
To wreath the foreheads of the daring.
And eager for his priceless crown,—
The bastions scarce a length before him,—
His stalwart form at length went down
With Death and Honor bending o'er him.

Brave soldier of the Southern clime,

No stately song nor brilliant story
Shall hand thy name to future time
As one who gained immortal glory.
But Freedom, with her mailed hand,
Has paused to brush a tear of sorrow,
And placed thee with that chosen band
Who freely pour their lifeblood for her.

And Valor, with her royal brow,
And Honor, with her stately bearing,
Have surely felt a prouder glow
When musing on thy peerless daring.
O gallant soldier, all unknown,
Though noisy Fame, we know, shall never
Proclaim thy deeds through every zone,
A hero's crown is thine forever!

WILLIAM GORDON McCABE.

BARBARA FRIETCHIE

Up from the meadows rich with corn,
Clear in the cool September morn,

The clustered spires of Frederick stand
Green-walled by the hills of Maryland.

Round about them orchards sweep,
Apple and peach tree fruited deep,

Fair as a garden of the Lord
To the eyes of the famished rebel horde,

On that pleasant morn of the early fall
When Lee marched over the mountain wall,—

Over the mountains, winding down,
Horse and foot, into Frederick town.

Forty flags with their silver stars,
Forty flags with their crimson bars,

Flapped in the morning wind; the sun
Of noon looked down, and saw not one.

Up rose old Barbara Frietchie then,
Bowed with her fourscore years and ten;

Bravest of all in Frederick town,
She took up the flag the men hauled down;

In her attic window the staff she set,
To show that one heart was loyal yet.

Up the street came the rebel tread,
“Stonewall” Jackson riding ahead.

Under his slouched hat left and right
He glanced: the old flag met his sight.

“Halt!”—the dust-brown ranks stood fast;
“Fire!”—out blazed the rifle-blast.

It shivered the window, pane and sash;
It rent the banner with seam and gash.

Quick, as it fell, from the broken staff
Dame Barbara snatched the silken scarf;

She leaned far out on the window-sill,
And shook it forth with a royal will.

“Shoot, if you must, this old gray head,
But spare your country’s flag,” she said.

A shade of sadness, a blush of shame,
Over the face of the leader came;

The nobler nature within him stirred
To life at the woman’s deed and word:

“Who touches a hair of yon gray head
Dies like a dog! March on!” he said.

All day long through Frederick street
Sounded the tread of marching feet;

All day long that free flag tossed
Over the heads of the rebel host.

Ever its torn folds rose and fell
On the loyal winds that loved it well;

And through the hill-gaps sunset light
Shone over it a warm good-night.

Barbara Frietchie’s work is o’er,
And the rebel rides on his raids no more.

Honor to her! and let a tear
Fall, for her sake, on “Stonewall’s” bier.

Over Barbara Frietchie’s grave,
Flag of freedom and union, wave!

Peace, and order, and beauty draw
Round thy symbol of light and law;

And ever the stars above look down
On thy stars below in Frederick town!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

(By special permission of Houghton, Mifflin and Company.)

DID you hear of the fight at Corinth,
How we whipped out Price and Van Dorn?

A long and terrible day!
And at last, when night grew gray,
By the hundreds, there they lay,
(Heavy sleepers, you'd say,)
That wouldn't wake on the morn.

Our staff was bare of a flag,
We didn't carry a rag
In those brave marching days;—
Ah, no, but a finer thing!
With never a cord or string,
An eagle of ruffled wing,
And an eye of awful gaze.

The grape it rattled like hail,
The minies were dropping like rain,
The first of a thunder shower;
The wads were blowing like chaff,
(There was pounding like floor and flail,
All the front of our line!)
So we stood it hour after hour;
But our eagle, he felt fine!
'Twould have made you cheer and laugh,
To see, through that iron gale,
How the old fellow'd swoop and sail
Above the racket and roar,—
To right and to left he'd soar,
But ever came back, without fail,
And perched on his standard-staff.

All that day, I tell you true,
They had pressed us steady and fair,
Till we fought in street and square,—
(The affair, you might think, looked blue)

But we knew we had them there!
Our batteries were few,
Every gun, they'd have sworn, they knew,
But, you see, there were one or two
We had fixed for them, unaware.

On they came in solid column,
For once no whooping nor yell—
(Ah, I dare say they felt solemn!)
Front and flank, grape and shell,
Our batteries pounded away!
And the minies hummed to remind 'em
They had started on no child's play!

Steady they kept a-going,
But a grim wake settled behind 'em
From the edge of the *abattis*,
(Where our dead and dying lay
Under fence and fallen tree,)
Up to Robinett, all the way
The dreadful swath kept growing!
'Twas butternut mixed with gray.

Ah, well—you know how it ended—
We did for them, there and then,
But their pluck throughout was splendid,
They stood to the last like men.
Red as blood, o'er the town,
The angry sun went down,
Firing flag-staff and vane;
And our eagle,—as for him,
There, all ruffled and grim,
He sat, o'erlooking the slain!

'Tis many a stormy day
Since, out of the cold bleak north,
Our great war-eagle sailed forth
To swoop o'er battle and fray.

Many and many a day
O'er charge and storm hath he wheeled,
Foray and foughten field,
Tramp, and volley, and rattle!—
Over crimson trench and turf,
Over climbing clouds of surf,
Through tempest and cannon-wrack,
Have his terrible pinions whirled;—
(A thousand fields of battle!
A million leagues of foam!)
But our bird shall yet come back,
He shall soar to his eyrie-home,
And his thunderous wings be furled,
In the gaze of a gladdened world,
On the nation's loftiest dome.

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

LOADED with gallant soldiers,
A boat shot in to the land,
And lay at the right of Rodman's Point,
With her keel upon the sand.

Lightly, gaily they came to shore,
And never a man afraid;
When suddenly the enemy opened fire
From his deadly ambushade.

Each man fell flat on the bottom
Of the boat; and the captain said,
"If we lie here we all are captured,
And the first who moves is dead!"

Then out spoke a negro sailor,—
No slavish soul had he,—
"Somebody's got to die, boys,
And it might as well be me!"

Firmly he rose, and fearlessly
Stepped out into the tide;
He pushed the vessel safely off,
Then fell across her side;—

Fell, pierced by a dozen bullets,
As the boat swung clear and free;
But there wasn't a man of them that day
Was fitter to die than he!

PHÆBE CARY.

(By special permission of Houghton, Mifflin and Company.)

Two hours, or more, beyond the prime of a blithe April day
The Northmen's mailed "Invincibles" steamed up fair Charleston Bay;
They came in sullen file, and slow, low-breasted on the wave,
Black as a midnight front of storm, and silent as the grave.

A thousand warrior-hearts beat high as these dread monsters drew
More closely to the game of death across the breezeless blue;
And twice ten thousand hearts of those who watch the scene afar
Thrill in the awful hush that bides the battle's broadening star.

Each gunner, moveless by his gun, with rigid aspect stands,
The ready linstocks firmly grasped in bold, untrembling hands;
So moveless in their marble calm, their stern, heroic guise,
They look like forms of statued stone with burning human eyes!

Our banners on the outmost walls, with stately rustling fold,
Flash back from arch and parapet the sunlight's ruddy gold;—
They mount to the deep roll of drums, and widely echoing cheers,
And then, once more, dark, breathless, hushed, wait the grim cannoneers.

Onward, in sullen file, and slow, low-glooming on the wave,
Near, nearer still, the haughty fleet glides silent as the grave,
When, shivering the portentous calm o'er startled flood and shore,
Broke from the sacred Island Fort the thunder wrath of yore!

The storm has burst! and, while we speak, more furious, wilder, higher,
Dart from the circling batteries a hundred tongues of fire;
The waves gleam red, the lurid vault of heaven seems rent above—
Fight on, O knightly gentlemen, for faith, and home, and love!

There's not, in all that line of flame, one soul that would not rise,
To seize the victor's wreath of blood, though Death must give the prize;
There's not, in all this anxious crowd that throngs the ancient town,
A maid who does not yearn for power to strike one foeman down!

The conflict deepens! Ship by ship the proud Armada sweeps
Where fierce from Sumter's raging breast the volleyed lightning leaps;
And ship by ship, raked, overborne, are burned the sunset light

And ship by ship, taken, overcome, etc banded the sunset light,
Crawls in the gloom of baffled hate beyond the field of fight!

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

(By special permission of William Hamilton Hayne, and of The
Lothrop Publishing Company.)

30

KEENAN'S CHARGE

THE sun had set;
The leaves with dew were wet,—
Down fell a bloody dusk
Where “Stonewall’s” corps, like a beast of prey,
Tore through with angry tusk.

“They’ve trapped us, boys!”
Rose from our flank a voice.
With rush of steel and smoke
On came the rebels straight,
Eager as love, and wild as hate;
And our line reeled and broke;

Broke and fled.
Not one stayed,—but the dead!
With curses, shrieks, and cries,
Horses, and wagons, and men
Tumbled back through the shuddering glen,
And above us the fading skies.

There’s some hope, still,—
Those batteries parked on the hill!
“Battery, wheel” (’mid the roar),
“Pass pieces; fix prolonge to fire
Retiring. Trot!” In the panic dire
A bugle rings “Trot!”—and no more.

The horses plunged,
The cannon lurched and lunged,
To join the hopeless rout.
But suddenly rose a form
Calmly in front of the human storm.
With a stern commanding shout:

“Align those guns!”
(We knew it was Pleasanton’s.)
The cannoneers bent to obey,

And worked with a will at his word,
And the black guns moved as if they had heard.
But, ah, the dread delay!

“To wait is crime;
O God, for ten minutes’ time!”
The general looked around.
There Keenan sat, like a stone,
With his three hundred horse alone,
Less shaken than the ground.

“Major, your men?”
“Are soldiers, general.” “Then,
Charge, major! Do your best;
Hold the enemy back, at all cost,
Till my guns are placed;—else the army is lost.
You die to save the rest!”

By the shrouded gleam of the western skies
Brave Keenan looked into Pleasanton’s eyes
For an instant,—clear, and cool, and still;
Then, with a smile, he said: “I will.”

“Cavalry, charge!” Not a man of them shrank.
Their sharp, full cheer, from rank on rank,
Rose joyously, with a willing breath,—
Rose like a greeting hail to death.

Then forward they sprang, and spurred, and clashed;
Shouted the officers, crimson-sashed;
Rode well the men, each brave as his fellow,
In their faded coats of the blue and yellow;
And above in the air, with an instinct true,
Like a bird of war their pennon flew.

With clank of scabbard, and thunder of steeds,
And blades that shine like sunlit reeds,
And strong brown faces bravely pale
For fear their proud attempt shall fail

For fear their proud attempt shall fail,
Three hundred Pennsylvanians close
On twice ten thousand gallant foes.

Line after line the troopers came
To the edge of the woods that was ringed with flame;
Rode in, and sabred, and shot,—and fell;
Nor came one back his wounds to tell.
And full in the midst rose Keenan, tall,
In the gloom like a martyr awaiting his fall,
While the circle-stroke of his sabre, swung
Round his head, like a halo there, luminous hung.

Line after line, aye, whole platoons,
Struck dead in their saddles, of brave dragoons,
By the maddened horses were onward borne,
And into the vortex flung, trampled and torn;
As Keenan fought with his men, side by side.
So they rode, till there were no more to ride.

And over them, lying there shattered and mute,
What deep echo rolls?—'Tis a death-salute
From the cannon in place; for, heroes, you braved
Your fate not in vain; the army was saved!

Over them now,—year following year,—
Over their graves the pine cones fall,
And the whippoorwill chants his spectre call;
But they stir not again, they raise no cheer;
They have ceased. But their glory shall never cease,
Nor their light be quenched in the light of peace.
The rush of their charge is resounding still
That saved the army at Chancellorsville.

GEORGE PARSONS LATHROP.

(From *Dreams and Days*; Copyright, 1892, Charles Scribner's Sons.
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THE captain galloped to the front,
The foam upon his rein;
And, as he urged his swerving steed
Across a pile of slain,

He hailed the gunner at his post:
“Ho, Fergus! pour your shell
Straight in the face of yon stout line
That holds the height so well,

“And never slack your raking fire—
No, not to cool your gun;
For if we break those stubborn ranks,
I think the day is won.”

The gunner wiped his smoke-dimmed face—
“I’ll do the best I can,
And down—brave fellows though they be—
We’ll bring them to a man!”

“I’ll trust you for it!”—Like a flash
The captain turned and wheeled,
And with his sword above his head
Dashed backward to the field.

Fierce belched the cannon’s ceaseless fire,
With deadly crash and din;
And, though the line still held the height,
Its ranks began to thin.

“Two rounds—and we will clear the hill!”
But, as the gunner spoke,
A sudden overwhelming storm
Of bullets o’er him broke.

And when the smoke had lifted, there
Still straining all his powers,
They heard him shout: “Two shots my boys

They heard him shout. Two shots, my boys,
And then the day is ours!

“No matter if one arm be gone,
I keep the other still;
I promised I would do my best,
And so you’ll see, I will!

“Let me make trial while my strength
Can do the duty set;
I tell you that this strong left hand
Is good for service yet!”

They primed the piece, and twice he sent,
With all too deadly aim,
The shells that mowed the broken line,
And swept the hill with flame.

“Where’s Fergus?”—and the captain’s horse
Came spurring into sight—
“Where’s Fergus? let him take my thanks,—
His fire has won the fight!”

The dying gunner raised his head,
His lips were faintly stirred—
“Captain, I said I’d do my best—
And—I have kept my word!”

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

(By special permission of Dr. George J. Preston.)

OUR new flag-bearer, pale and slim,
A beardless youth of quiet mien,
Much chaffed at by the soldiers grim
(Before in battle he had been),
Hid the heroic fire in him.

He sang old hymns, and prayed at night;
“A bad sign,” quoth the sergeant bold;
“Camp-meeting tunes before a fight
Loosen a soldier’s moral hold,
And pluck beats prayer a mighty sight.”

The boy blushed red, but tenderly
He to the sergeant turned, and said:
“That God should mind me what am I?
And yet by Him my soul is fed—
Send this to mother if I die.”

The sergeant, with a knowing look,
And winking at the rest, replied:
“Yes, son, I’ll give your Ma the book—”
Just then a volley rattled wide,
And one great gun the valley shook.

The pale flag-bearer disappeared.
“Gone to the rear,” the sergeant said;
“Praying would make a Turk afeared;
Those lonesome tunes have turned his head—”
And then the tide of battle neared.

We formed in haste and dashed away,
Across the field, our place to fill;
At first a skirmish, then a spray
Of cannon smoke upon a hill
Flanked by long lines in close array.

Down charged the foe; we rushed to meet,
We filled the valley like a sea.

we filled the valley like a sea,
The cannons flashed a level sheet
Of blinding flame, the musketry
Cut men as sickles cut the wheat!

Oh, then we shouted! More and more
The fervor of our courage rose,
As through our solid columns tore
The death hail's crashing, gusty blows,
And louder leaped the cannon roar!

But how could human courage meet
That icy flood? All, all in vain
Our counter-charge; in slow retreat
We crossed the tumbled heaps of slain,
With grave-pits yawning at our feet!

"Rally! For shame!" rang out a cry
Forth from the thundering vortex cast;
A voice so steady, clear, and high,
It sounded like a bugle-blast
Blown from the lips of Victory.

We paused, took hope, yelled loud, and so
Renewed the charge, all as one man,
Leaped where Death's waves had thickest flow,
And felt the breath of horror fan
Our naked souls as cold as snow!

The volleys quickened, coalesced,
Rolled deep, rocked earth, and jarred the sky,
When lo, our banner-bearer pressed
His standard forward, held it high
And rode upon the battle's crest!

We saw him wave it over all;
Caught in the battle trough and dashed
From side to side, it would not fall;
But like a meteor danced and flashed

And reveled in the sulphurous pall!

We swept the field and won the hill;
Our flag flared out upon the crest,
Where wavering, gasping, pale and chill,
A dozen bullets through his breast,
The slender hero held it still!

We leaped to lift his drooping head,
The sergeant clasped him to his breast;
“I bore the flag,” the low voice said,
“And God bore me, now let me rest;”
And so we laid him with the dead.

MAURICE THOMPSON.

(By special permission of the author, and of Houghton, Mifflin and
Company.)

DARK as the clouds of even,
Ranked in the western heaven,
Waiting the breath that lifts
All the dead mass, and drifts
Tempest and falling brand
Over a ruined land,—
So still and orderly,
Arm to arm, knee to knee,
Waiting the great event,
Stands the black regiment.

Down the long dusky line
Teeth gleam, and eyeballs shine;
And the bright bayonet,
Bristling and firmly set,
Flashed with a purpose grand,
Long ere the sharp command
Of the fierce rolling drum
Told them their time had come,
Told them what work was sent
For the black regiment.

“Now!” the flag-sergeant cried,
“Though death and hell betide,
Let the whole nation see
If we are fit to be
Free in this land; or bound
Down, like the whining hound,—
Bound with red stripes of pain
In our cold chains again!”
Oh, what a shout there went
From the black regiment!

“Charge!” trump and drum awoke;
Onward the bondsmen broke;
Bayonet and sabre-stroke
Vainly opposed their rush.

Through the wild battle's crush,
With but one thought aflush,
Driving their lords like chaff,
In the gun's mouth they laugh;
Or at the slippery brands,
Leaping with open hands,
Down they tear man and horse,
Down in their awful course;
Trampling with bloody heel
Over the crushing steel,—
All their eyes forward bent,
Rushed the black regiment.

“Freedom!” their battle-cry,—
“Freedom! or leave to die!”
Ah, and they meant the word!
Not as with us 'tis heard,—
Not a mere party shout;
They gave their spirits out,
Trusting the end to God,
And on the gory sod
Rolled in triumphant blood.
Glad to strike one free blow,
Whether for weal or woe;
Glad to breathe one free breath,
Though on the lips of death;
Praying—alas, in vain!—
That they might fall again,
So they could once more see
That burst to liberty!
This was what “freedom” lent
To the black regiment.

Hundreds on hundreds fell;
But they are resting well;
Scourges, and shackles strong,
Never shall do them wrong.
Oh, to the living few,

Soldiers, be just and true!
Hail them as comrades tried;
Fight with them side by side;
Never, in field or tent,
Scorn the black regiment!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

34

GREENCASTLE JENNY

OH, Greencastle streets were a stream of steel
With the slanted muskets the soldiers bore,
And the scared earth muttered and shook to feel
The tramp and the rumble of Longstreet's Corps;
The bands were blaring *The Bonny Blue Flag*,
And the banners borne were a motley many;
And watching the gray column wind and drag
Was a slip of a girl—we'll call her Jenny.

A slip of a girl—what needs her name?—
With her cheeks aflame and her lips aquiver,
As she leaned and looked with a loyal shame
On the steady flow of the steely river:
Till a storm grew black in her hazel eyes
Time had not tamed, nor a lover sighed for;
And she ran and she girded her, apron-wise,
With the flag she loved and her brothers died for.

Out of the doorway they saw her start
(Pickett's Virginians were marching through),
The hot little foolish hero-heart
Armored with stars and the sacred blue.
Clutching the folds of red and white
Stood she and bearded those ranks of theirs,
Shouting shrilly with all her might,
"Come and take it, the man that dares!"

Pickett's Virginians were passing through;
Supple as steel and brown as leather,
Rusty and dusty of hat and shoe,
Wonted to hunger and war and weather;
Peerless, fearless, an army's flower!
Sternier soldiers the world saw never,
Marching lightly, that summer hour,
To death and failure and fame forever.

Rose from the rippling ranks a cheer;

Pickett saluted, with bold eyes beaming,
Sweeping his hat like a cavalier,
With his tawny locks in the warm wind streaming.
Fierce little Jenny! her courage fell,
As the firm lines flickered with friendly laughter,
And Greencastle streets gave back the yell
That Gettysburg slopes gave back soon after.

So they cheered for the flag they fought
With the generous glow of the stubborn fighter,
Loving the brave as the brave men ought,
And never a finger was raised to fright her:
So they marched, though they knew it not,
Through the fresh green June to the shock infernal,
To the hell of the shell and the plunging shot,
And the charge that has won them a name eternal.

And she felt at last, as she hid her face,
There had lain at the root of her childish daring
A trust in the men of her own brave race,
And a secret faith in the foe's forbearing.
And she sobbed, till the roll of the rumbling gun
And the swinging tramp of the marching men
Were a memory only, and day was done,
And the stars in the fold of the blue again.

*(Thank God that the day of the sword is done,
And the stars in the fold of the blue again!)*

HELEN GRAY CONE.

(By special permission of the author.)

HAVE you heard the story that gossips tell
Of Burns of Gettysburg?—No? Ah, well,
Brief is the glory the hero earns,
Briefer the story of poor John Burns!
He was the fellow who won renown,—
The only man who didn't back down
When the rebels rode through his native town:
But held his own in the fight next day,
When all his townsfolk ran away.
That was in July, sixty-three,
The very day that General Lee,
Flower of Southern chivalry,
Baffled and beaten, backward reeled
From a stubborn Meade and a barren field.

I might tell how, but the day before,
John Burns stood at his cottage door,
Looking down the village street,
Where, in the shade of his peaceful vine,
He heard the low of his gathered kine,
And felt their breath with incense sweet;
Or I might say, when the sunset burned
The old farm gable, he thought it turned
The milk that fell in a babbling flood
Into the milk-pail, red as blood!
Or how he fancied the hum of bees
Were bullets buzzing among the trees.
But all such fanciful thoughts as these
Were strange to a practical man like Burns,
Who minded only his own concerns,
Troubled no more by fancies fine
Than one of his calm-eyed, long-tailed kine,—
Quite old-fashioned and matter-of-fact,
Slow to argue, but quick to act.
That was the reason, as some folks say,
He fought so well on that terrible day.

And it was terrible. On the right
Raged for hours the heady fight,
Thundered the battery's double bass,—
Difficult music for men to face;
While on the left—where now the graves
Undulate like the living waves
That all that day unceasing swept
Up to the pits the rebels kept—
Round shot plowed the upland glades,
Sown with bullets, reaped with blades;
Shattered fences here and there
Tossed their splinters in the air;
The very trees were stripped and bare;
The barns that once held yellow grain
Were heaped with harvests of the slain;
The cattle bellowed on the plain,
The turkeys screamed with might and main,
And brooding barn-fowl left their rest
With strange shells bursting in each nest.

Just where the tide of battle turns,
Erect and lonely stood old John Burns.
How do you think the man was dressed?
He wore an ancient long buff vest
Yellow as saffron,—but his best;
And, buttoned over his manly breast,
Was a bright blue coat, with a rolling collar,
And large gilt buttons,—size of a dollar,—
With tails that the country-folk called “swaller.”
He wore a broad-brimmed, bell-crowned hat,
White as the locks on which it sat.
Never had such a sight been seen
For forty years on the village green,
Since old John Burns was a country beau,
And went to the “quiltings” long ago.

Close at his elbows all that day,
Veterans of the Peninsula.

Sunburnt and bearded, charged away;
And striplings, downy of lip and chin,—
Clerks that the Home Guard mustered in,—
Glanced, as they passed, at the hat he wore,
Then at the rifle his right hand bore;
And hailed him, from out their youthful lore,
With scraps of a slangy *répertoire*:
“How are you, White Hat!” “Put her through!”
“Your head’s level,” and “Bully for you!”
Called him “Daddy,”—begged he’d disclose
The name of the tailor who made his clothes,
And what was the value he set on those;
While Burns, unmindful of jeer and scoff,
Stood there picking the rebels off,—
With his long brown rifle, and bell-crowned hat,
And swallow-tails they were laughing at.

’Twas but a moment, for that respect
Which clothes all courage their voices checked;
And something the wildest could understand
Spoke in the old man’s strong right hand;
And his corded throat, and the lurking frown
Of his eyebrows under his old bell-crown;
Until, as they gazed, there crept an awe
Through the ranks in whispers, and some men saw,
In the antique vestments and long white hair,
The Past of the Nation in battle there;
And some of the soldiers since declare
That the gleam of his old white hat afar,
Like the crested plume of the brave Navarre,
That day was their oriflamme of war.

So raged the battle. You know the rest:
How the rebels beaten and backward pressed,
Broke at the final charge, and ran.
At which John Burns—a practical man—
Shouldered his rifle, unbent his brows,
And then went back to his bees and cows

And then went back to his bees and cows.
That is the story of old John Burns;
This is the moral the reader learns:
In fighting the battle, the question's whether
You show a hat that's white, or a feather!

BRET HARTE.

(By special permission of Houghton, Mifflin and Company.)

HIGH TIDE AT GETTYSBURG

A CLOUD possessed the hollow field,
The gathering battle's smoky shield.
Athwart the gloom the lightning flashed,
And through the cloud some horsemen dashed,
And from the heights the thunder pealed.

Then at the brief command of Lee
Moved out that matchless infantry,
With Pickett leading grandly down,
To rush against the roaring crown
Of those dread heights of destiny.

Far heard above the angry guns
A cry across the tumult runs,—
The voice that rang through Shiloh's woods
And Chickamauga's solitudes,
The fierce South cheering on her sons!

Ah, how the withering tempest blew
Against the front of Pettigrew!
A Kamsin wind that scorched and singed
Like that infernal flame that fringed
The British squares at Waterloo!

A thousand fell where Kemper led;
A thousand died where Garnett bled:
In blinding flame and strangling smoke
The remnant through the batteries broke
And crossed the works with Armistead.

"Once more in Glory's van with me!"
Virginia cried to Tennessee:
"We two together, come what may,
Shall stand upon these works to-day!"
(The reddest day in history.)

Brave Tennessee! In reckless way
Virginia heard her comrade say:

Virginia heard her comrade say.
“Close round this rent and riddled rag!”
What time she set her battle-flag
Amid the guns of Doubleday.

But who shall break the guards that wait
Before the awful face of Fate?
The tattered standards of the South
Were shriveled at the cannon’s mouth,
And all her hopes were desolate.

In vain the Tennessean set
His breast against the bayonet!
In vain Virginia charged and raged,
A tigress in her wrath uncaged,
Till all the hill was red and wet!

Above the bayonets, mixed and crossed,
Men saw a gray, gigantic ghost
Receding through the battle-cloud,
And heard across the tempest loud
The death-cry of a nation lost!

The brave went down! Without disgrace
They leaped to Ruin’s red embrace.
They only heard Fame’s thunders wake,
And saw the dazzling sun-burst break
In smiles on Glory’s bloody face!

They fell, who lifted up a hand
And bade the sun in heaven to stand!
They smote and fell, who set the bars
Against the progress of the stars,
And stayed the march of Motherland!

They stood, who saw the future come
On through the fight’s delirium!
They smote and stood, who held the hope
Of nations on that slippery slope

Amid the cheers of Christendom!

God lives! He forged the iron will
That clutched and held that trembling hill.
God lives and reigns! He built and lent
The heights for Freedom's battlement
Where floats her flag in triumph still!

Fold up the banners! Smelt the guns!
Love rules. Her gentler purpose runs,
A mighty mother turns in tears
The pages of her battle years,
Lamenting all her fallen sons!

WILL HENRY THOMPSON.

(By special permission of the author, and of The Century Company.)

It was that fierce contested field when Chickamauga lay
Beneath the wild tornado that swept her pride away;
Her dimpling dales and circling hills dyed crimson with the flood
That had its sources in the springs that throb with human blood.

“Go say to General Hooker to reinforce his right!”
Said Thomas to his aide-de-camp, when wildly went the fight;
In front the battle thundered, it roared both right and left,
But like a rock “Pap” Thomas stood upon the crested cleft.

“Where will I find you, General, when I return?” The aide
Leaned on his bridle rein to wait the answer Thomas made;
The old chief like a lion turned, his pale lips set and sere,
And shook his mane, and stamped his foot, and fiercely answered, *“Here!”*

The floodtide of fraternal strife rolled upward to his feet,
And like the breakers on the shore the thunderous clamors beat;
The sad earth rocked and reeled with woe, the woodland shrieked in pain,
And hill and vale were groaning with the burden of the slain.

Who does not mind that sturdy form, that steady heart and hand,
That calm repose and gallant mien, that courage high and grand?—
O God, who givest nations men to meet their lofty needs,
Vouchsafe another Thomas when our country prostrate bleeds!

They fought with all the fortitude of earnest men and true—
The men who wore the rebel gray, the men who wore the blue;
And those, they fought most valiantly for petty state and clan,
And these, for truer Union and the brotherhood of man.

They come, those hurling legions, with banners crimson-splashed,
Against our stubborn columns their rushing ranks are dashed,
Till 'neath the blistering iron hail the shy and frightened deer
Go scurrying from their forest haunts to plunge in wilder fear.

Beyond, our lines are broken; and now in frenzied rout
The flower of the Cumberland has swiftly faced about;
And horse and foot and color-guard are reeling rear and van

And horse and foot and color-guard are reeling, rear and van,
And in the awful panic man forgets he is a man.

Now Bragg, with pride exultant above our broken wings,
The might of all his army against "Pap" Thomas brings;
They're massing to the right of him, they're massing to the left,
Ah, God be with our hero, who holds the crested cleft!

Blow, blow, ye echoing bugles! give answer, screaming shell!
Go, belch your murderous fury, ye batteries of hell!
Ring out, O impious musket! spin on, O shattering shot,—
Our smoke-encircled hero, he hears but heeds ye not!

Now steady, men! now steady! make one more valiant stand,
For gallant Steedman's coming, his forces well in hand!
Close up your shattered columns, take steady aim and true,
The chief who loves you as his life will live or die with you!

By solid columns, on they come; by columns they are hurled,
As down the eddying rapids the storm-swept booms are whirled;
And when the ammunition fails—O moment drear and dread—
The heroes load their blackened guns from rounds of soldiers dead.

God never set His signet on the hearts of braver men,
Or fixed the goal of victory on higher heights than then;
With bayonets and muskets clubbed, they close the rush and roar;
Their stepping-stones to glory are their comrades gone before.

O vanished majesty of days not all forgotten yet,
We consecrate unto thy praise one hour of deep regret;
One hour to them whose days were years of glory that shall flood
The Nation's sombre night of tears, of carnage, and of blood!

O vanished majesty of days! Rise, type and mold to-day,
And teach our sons to follow on where duty leads the way;
That whatsoever trial comes, defying doubt and fear,
They in the thickest fight shall stand and proudly answer, "*Here!*"

KATE BROWNLEE SHERWOOD.

(By special permission of the author.)

38

THE SMALLEST OF THE DRUMS

WHEN the opulence of summer unto wood and meadow comes,
And within the tangled graveyard riot old-time spice and bloom,
Then dear Nature brings her tribute to “the smallest of the drums,”
Spreads the sweetest of her blossoms on the little soldier’s tomb.

In the quiet country village, still they tell you how he died;
And the story moves you strangely, more than other tales of war.
Thrice heroic seems the hero, if he be a child beside,
And the wound that tears his bosom is more sad than others far.

In the ranks of Sherman’s army none so young and small as he,
With his face so soft and dimpled, and his innocent blue eyes.
Yet of all the Union drummers he could drum most skillfully,
With a spirit—said his colonel—fit to make the dead arise!

In the charge at Chickamauga (so, beside his little grave,
You may learn the hero’s story of some villager, perchance),
When his regiment sank, broken, from the rampart, like a wave,
Thrice the clangor of his drum-beat rallied to a fresh advance.

There he stood upon the hillside, capless, with his shining hair
Blown about his childish forehead like the bright silk of the corn;
And the men looked up, and saw him standing brave and scathless there,
As an angel on a hilltop, in the drifting mist of morn.

Thrice they rallied at his drum-beat,—then the tattered flag went down!
Some one caught it, waved it skyward for a moment, and then fell.
In the dust, and gore, and drabble, all the stars of freedom’s crown,
And the soldiers beaten backward from the emblem loved so well!

Then our drummer boy, our hero, from his neck the drum-cord flung,
And amid the hail of bullets to the fallen banner sped.
Quick he raised it from dishonor; quick before them all he sprung,
And in fearless, proud defiance, waved the old flag o’er his head!

For a minute’s space the cheering, louder than the singing balls,
And the soldiers pressing forward, closing up their broken line!
Then the child’s bright head, death-stricken, on his throbbing bosom falls

Then the child's bright head, death-sticken, on his throbbing bosom falls,
And the brave eyes that God lighted cease with life and soul to shine.

In the flag he saved they wrapped him; in that starry shroud he lies,
And the roses, and the lilacs, and the daisies seem to know;
For in all that peaceful acre, sleeping 'neath the summer skies,
There is neither mound nor tablet that is wreathed and guarded so!

JAMES BUCKHAM.

(By special permission of the author.)

Out of the focal and foremost fire,
Out of the hospital walls as dire;
Smitten of grape-shot and gangrene,
(Eighteenth battle, and *he* sixteen!)
Spectre, such as you seldom see!—
Little Giffen of Tennessee!

“Take him and welcome!” the surgeons said;
Little the doctor can help the dead!
So we took him; and brought him where
The balm was sweet in the summer air;
And we laid him down on a wholesome bed—
Utter Lazarus, heel to head!

And we watched the war with bated breath,—
Skeleton Boy against skeleton Death.
Months of torture, how many such?
Weary weeks of the stick and crutch;
And still a glint of the steel-blue eye
Told of a spirit that wouldn’t die,

And didn’t. Nay, more! in death’s despite
The crippled skeleton “learned to write.”
“*Dear Mother,*” at first, of course; and then
“*Dear Captain,*” inquiring about the men.
Captain’s answer: “Of eighty-and-five,
Giffen and I are left alive.”

Word of gloom from the war, one day;
Johnson pressed at the front, they say.
Little Giffen was up and away;
A tear—his first—as he bade good-by,
Dimmed the glint of his steel-blue eye.
“I’ll write, if spared!” There was news of the fight;
But none of Giffen.—He did not write.

I sometimes fancy that, were I king
Of the world, I’d make a Giffen of every

Of the princely Knights of the Golden Ring,
With the song of the minstrel in mine ear,
And the tender legend that trembles here,
I'd give the best on his bended knee,
The whitest soul of my chivalry,
For "Little Giffen" of Tennessee.

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

(By special permission of Mrs. Rosa N. Ticknor.)

40

ULRIC DAHLGREN

A FLASH of light across the night,
An eager face, an eye afire!
O lad so true, you yet may rue
The courage of your deep desire!

“Nay, tempt me not; the way is plain—
'Tis but the coward checks his rein;
For there they lie,
And there they cry,
For whose dear sake 'twere joy to die!”

He bends unto his saddlebow,
The steeds they follow two and two;
Their flanks are wet with foam and sweat,
Their rider's locks are damp with dew.

“O comrades, haste! the way is long,
The dirge it drowns the battle-song;
The hunger preys,
The famine slays,
An awful horror veils our ways!”

Beneath the pall of prison wall
The rush of hoofs they seem to hear;
From loathsome guise they lift their eyes,
And beat their bars and bend their ear.

“Ah, God be thanked! our friends are nigh;
He wills it not that thus we die;
O fiends accurst
Of Want and Thirst,
Our comrades gather,—do your worst!”

A sharp affright runs through the night,
An ambush stirred, a column reined;
The hurrying steed has checked his speed,
His smoking flanks are crimson stained.

O noble son of noble sire,
Thine ears are deaf to our desire!
 O knightly grace
 Of valiant race,
The grave is honor's trysting-place!

O life so pure! O faith so sure!
 O heart so brave, and true, and strong!
With tips of flame is writ your name,
 In annals of deed and storied song!

It flares across the solemn night,
It glitters in the radiant light;
 A jewel set,
 Unnumbered yet,
In our Republic's coronet!

KATE BROWNLEE SHERWOOD.

(By special permission of the author.)

FARRAGUT, Farragut,
Old Heart of Oak,
Daring Dave Farragut,
Thunderbolt stroke,
Watches the hoary mist
Lift from the bay,
Till his flag, glory-kissed,
Greets the young day.

Far, by gray Morgan's walls,
Looms the black fleet.
Hark, deck to rampart calls
With the drums' beat!
Buoy your chains overboard,
While the steam hums;
Men, to the battlement!
Farragut comes.

See, as the hurricane
Hurtles in wrath
Squadrons of clouds amain
Back from its path,
Back to the parapet,
To the guns' lips,
Thunderbolt Farragut
Hurls the black ships!

Now through the battle's roar
Clear the boy sings,
"By the mark fathoms four,"
While the lead swings.
Steady the wheelmen five
"Nor' by East keep her";
"Steady," but two alive:
How the shells sweep her!

Lashed to the mast that sways

Over red decks,
Over the flame that plays
Round the torn wrecks,
Over the dying lips
Framed for a cheer,
Farragut leads his ships,
Guides the line clear.

On by heights cannon-browed,
While the spars quiver;
Onward still flames the cloud
Where the hulks shiver.
See, yon fort's star is set,
Storm and fire past!
Cheer him, lads—Farragut
Lashed to the mast!

Oh, while Atlantic's breast
Bears a white sail,
While the Gulf's towering crest
Tops a green vale,
Men thy bold deeds shall tell,
Old Heart of Oak,
Daring Dave Farragut,
Thunderbolt stroke!

WILLIAM TUCKEY MEREDITH.

(By special permission of The Century Company.)

DAWN of a pleasant morning in May
Broke through the Wilderness cool and gray,
While, perched in the tallest treetops, the birds
Were caroling Mendelssohn's "Songs without Words."

Far from the haunts of men remote,
The brook brawled on with a liquid note,
And nature, all tranquil and lovely, wore
The smile of spring, as in Eden of yore.

Little by little as daylight increased,
And deepened the roseate flush in the east,—
Little by little did morning reveal
Two long glittering lines of steel;

Where two hundred thousand bayonets gleam,
Tipped with light of the earliest beam,
And the faces are sullen and grim to see,
In the hostile armies of Grant and Lee.

All of a sudden, ere rose the sun,
Pealed on the silence the opening gun;
A little white puff of smoke there came,
And anon the valley was wreathed in flame.

Down on the left of the rebel lines,
Where a breastwork stands in a copse of pines,
Before the rebels their ranks can form,
The Yankees have carried the place by storm.

Stars and Stripes o'er the salient wave,
Where many a hero has found a grave;
And the gallant Confederates strive in vain
The ground they have drenched with their blood to regain.

Yet louder the thunder of battle roared;
Yet a deadlier fire on their columns poured;
Slaughter infernal rode with Despair

Slaughter and carnage with Despair,
Furies twain, through the smoky air.

Not far off, in the saddle there sat
A gray-bearded man in a black slouch-hat;
Not much moved by the fire was he,
Calm and resolute Robert Lee.

Quick and watchful, he kept his eye
On two bold rebel brigades close by,—
Reserves, that were standing (and dying) at ease,
While the tempest of wrath toppled over the trees.

For still with their loud, deep, bulldog bay,
The Yankee batteries blazed away,
And with every murderous second that sped
A dozen brave fellows, alas, fell dead!

The grand old graybeard rode to the space
Where Death and his victims stood face to face,
And silently waved his old slouch-hat;
A world of meaning there was in that!

“Follow me! Steady! We’ll save the day!”
This was what he seemed to say;
And to the light of his glorious eye
The bold brigades thus made reply:—

“We’ll go forward, but you must go back!”
And they moved not an inch in the perilous track;
“Go to the rear, and we’ll send them to hell!”
And the sound of the battle was lost in their yell.

Turning his bridle, Robert Lee
Rode to the rear. Like the waves of the sea,
Bursting their dikes in their overflow,
Madly his veterans dashed on the foe.

And backward in terror that foe was driven,

Their banners rent and their columns riven,
Wherever the tide of battle rolled
Over the Wilderness, wood and wold.

Sunset out of a crimson sky
Streamed o'er a field of ruddier dye,
And the brook ran on with a purple stain
From the blood of ten thousand foemen slain.

Seasons have passed since that day and year;
Again o'er its pebbles the brook runs clear,
And the field in a richer green is dressed
Where the dead of the terrible conflict rest.

Hushed is the roll of the rebel drum,
The sabres are sheathed, and the cannon dumb;
And Fate, with pitiless hand, has furled
The flag that once challenged the gaze of the world.

But the fame of the Wilderness fight abides;
And down into history grandly rides,
Calm and unmoved as in battle he sat,
The gray-bearded man in the black slouch-hat.

JOHN RANDOLPH THOMPSON.

Over the turret, shut in his ironclad tower,
Craven was conning his ship through smoke and flame;
Gun to gun he had battered the fort for an hour,
Now was the time for a charge to end the game.

There lay the narrowing channel, smooth and grim,
A hundred deaths beneath it, and never a sign;
There lay the enemy's ships, and sink or swim
The flag was flying, and he was head of the line.

The fleet behind was jamming: the monitor hung
Beating the stream; the roar for a moment hushed;
Craven spoke to the pilot; slow she swung;
Again he spoke, and right for the foe she rushed

Into the narrowing channel, between the shore
And the sunk torpedoes lying in treacherous rank;
She turned but a yard too short; a muffled roar,
A mountainous wave, and she rolled, righted, and sank.

Over the manhole, up in the ironclad tower,
Pilot and captain met as they turned to fly:
The hundredth part of a moment seemed an hour,
For one could pass to be saved, and one must die.

They stood like men in a dream; Craven spoke,—
Spoke as he lived and fought, with a captain's pride:
"After you, Pilot." The pilot woke,
Down the ladder he went, and Craven died.

All men praise the deed and the manner; but we—
We set it apart from the pride that stoops to the proud,
The strength that is supple to serve the strong and free,
The grace of the empty hands and promises loud;

Sidney thirsting a humbler need to slake,
Nelson waiting his turn for the surgeon's hand,
Lucas crushed with chains for a comrade's sake

Lucas crashed with chains for a comrade's sake,
Outram coveting right before command,

These were paladins, these were Craven's peers,
These with him shall be crowned in story and song,
Crowned with the glitter of steel and the glimmer of tears,
Princes of courtesy, merciful, proud, and strong.

HENRY NEWBOLT.

(By special permission of Houghton, Mifflin and Company, and of
John Lane.)

44

GRACIE OF ALABAMA

ON, sons of mighty stature,
And souls that match the best!
When nations name their jewels
Let Alabama rest.

Gracie of Alabama!
'Twas on that dreadful day
When howling hounds were fiercest
With Petersburg at bay.

Gracie of Alabama
Walked down the lines with Lee,
Marking through mists of gunshot
The clouds of enemy.

Thrice Alabama's warning
Fell on a heedless ear,
While the relentless lead-storm,
Converging, hurtled near;

Till, straight before his chieftain,
Without a word or sign,
He stood, a shield the grandest,
Against the Union line.

And then the glass was lowered,
And voice that faltered not
Said, in its measured cadence,
"Why, Gracie, you'll be shot!"

And Alabama answered,—
"The South will pardon me
If the ball that goes through Gracie
Comes short of Robert Lee!"

Swept a swift flash of crimson
Athwart the chieftain's cheek,
And the eyes whose glance was knighthood

And the eyes whose glance was kinghood
Spake as no king could speak.

And side by side with Gracie
He turned from shot and flame,—
Side by side with Gracie
Up the grand aisle of Fame!

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

(By special permission of Mrs. Rosa N. Ticknor.)

I RODE a horse, a dappled bay,
Coal-black his mane and tail,—
A horse who never needed spur,
Nor curb, nor martingale.

And by my side three others rode,
Sun-tanned, long-haired, and grim,
Wild men led on by Edmondson,
Jim Polk, you've heard of him.

Behind us galloped, four by four,
A swarthy, mottled band
Of reckless fellows, chosen from
The bravest in the land.

Whither away on that fair day?
Oh, just a dash for fun.
To speed our horses, and keep up
With Jim Polk Edmondson.

Behind our backs we left the hills;
We crossed the Salliquoy;
My right-hand comrade smiled and said,
"I fished here when a boy."

Then from the rise at Hogan's house,
I saw, as in a dream,
Reed-fringed, and silver-blue, and deep,
The Coosawattee gleam.

A shot rang out! A bullet split
The air so close to me
I felt the keen hot puff; and then
A roar of musketry.

A wind of lead blew from the wood;
We took it at a run:
We sped so fast along the lane

we sped so fast along the lane
The worm-fence panels spun.

A horse went down, a dying face
Scowled darkly at the sky;
A bullet clipped my comrade's hat
And lopped the brim awry.

"Come, boys; come on!" our leader cried.
Pellmell we struck the line;
My comrade's pistol spat its balls,
And likewise so did mine.

A swirl of smoke, with rifts of fire,
Enveloped friend and foe;
Death, so embarrassed, hardly knew
Which way his strokes must go.

The fight closed in on every side,
And tore one spot of ground;
There was not room to swing an arm,
Or turn your horse around.

A moment thus, and then we broke
The circle of our foes.
Old Hogan, in his doorway, heard
The crunching of our blows,
The while we used our pistol-butts,
As swords, on many a head;
And yet, and yet, down in that wood
We left our leader,—dead.

So, now you know just how it was
We had our little fun,
Speeding our horses to keep up
With Jim Polk Edmondson.

MAURICE THOMPSON.

(By special permission of the author, and of The Century Company.)

46

SHERIDAN'S RIDE

Up from the south, at break of day,
Bringing to Winchester fresh dismay,
The affrighted air with a shudder bore,
Like a herald in haste to the chieftain's door,
The terrible grumble, and rumble, and roar,
Telling the battle was on once more,
And Sheridan twenty miles away.

And wider still those billows of war
Thundered along the horizon's bar;
And louder yet into Winchester rolled
The roar of that red sea uncontrolled,
Making the blood of the listener cold,
As he thought of the stake in that fiery fray,
With Sheridan twenty miles away.

But there is a road from Winchester town,
A good broad highway leading down:
And there, through the flush of the morning light,
A steed as black as the steeds of night
Was seen to pass, as with eagle flight;
As if he knew the terrible need,
He stretched away with his utmost speed;
Hills rose and fell; but his heart was gay,
With Sheridan fifteen miles away.

Still sprang from those swift hoofs, thundering south,
The dust like smoke from the cannon's mouth,
Or the trail of a comet, sweeping faster and faster,
Foreboding to traitors the doom of disaster.
The heart of the steed and the heart of the master
Were beating like prisoners assaulting their walls,
Impatient to be where the battle-field calls;
Every nerve of the charger was strained to full play,
With Sheridan only ten miles away.

Under his spurning feet, the road

THE words of a rebel old and battered,
Who will care to remember them?
Under the Lost Flag, battle-tattered,
I was a comrade of Allan Memm.

Who was Allan, that I should name him
Bravest of all the brave who bled?
Why should a soldier's song proclaim him
First of a hundred thousand dead?

An angel of battle, with fair hair curling
By brown cheeks shrunken and wan with want;
A living missile that Lee was hurling
Straight on the iron front of Grant;

A war-child born of the Old South's passion,
Trained in the camp of the cavaliers;
A spirit wrought in the antique fashion
Of Glory's martial morning years.

His young wife's laugh and his baby's prattle
He bore through the roar of the hungry guns—
Through the yell of shell in the rage of battle,
And the moan that under the thunder runs.

His was the voice that cried the warning
At the shattered gate of the slaughter-pen,
When Hancock rushed in the gray of morning
Over our doomed and desperate men.

His was the hand that held the standard—
A flaring torch on a crumbling shore—
'Mid the billows of blue by the storm blown landward,
And his call we heard through the ocean roar:

Ere the flag should shrink to a lost hope's token,
Ere the glow of its glory be low and dim,
Ere its stars should fade and its bars be broken

LET HIS STARS SHOULD FADE AND HIS BARS BE BROKEN,
Calling his comrades to come to him.

And these, at the order of Hill or Gordon,—
God keep their ashes! I knew them well,—
Would have smashed the ranks of the devil's cordon,
Or charged through the flames that roar in hell.

But none could stand where the storm was beating,
Never a comrade could reach his side;
In the spume of flame where the tides were meeting,
He, of a thousand, stood and died.

And the foe, in the old heroic manner,
Tenderly laid his form to rest,
The splintered staff and the riddled banner
Hiding the horror upon his breast.

Gone is the cot in the Georgia wildwood,
Gone is the blossom-strangled porch;
The roof that sheltered a soldier's childhood
Vainly pleaded with Sherman's torch.

Gone are the years, and far and feeble
Ever the old wild echoes die;
Hark to the voice of a great, glad people
Hailing the one flag under the sky!

And the monstrous heart of the storm receding
Fainter and farther throbs and jars;
And the new storm bursts, and the brave are bleeding
Under the cruel alien stars.

And Allan's wife in the grave is lying
Under the old scorched vine and pine,
While Allan's child in the isles is dying
Far on the foremost fighting line.

Cheer for the flag with the old stars spangled!

Shake out its folds to the wind's caress,
Over the hearts by the war-hounds mangled,
Down in the tangled Wilderness!

To wave o'er the grave of the brave forever;
For the Gray has sealed, in the bond of blood,
His faith to the Blue, and the brave shall never
Question the brave in the sight of God.

WILL HENRY THOMPSON.

(By special permission of the author, and of The Century Company.)

A BALLAD OF MANILA BAY

YOUR threats how vain, Corregidor;
Your rampired batteries, feared no more;
Your frowning guard at Manila gate,—
 When our Captain went before!

Lights out. Into the unknown gloom
From the windy, glimmering, wide sea-room,
Challenging fate in that dark strait
 We dared the hidden doom.

But the death in the deep awoke not then;
Mine and torpedo they spoke not then;
From the heights that loomed on our passing line
 The thunders broke not then.

Safe through the perilous dark we sped,
Quiet each ship as the quiet dead,
Till the guns of El Fraile roared—too late,
 And the steel prows forged ahead.

Mute each ship as the mute-mouth grave,
A ghost leviathan cleaving the wave;
But deep in its heart the great fires throb,
 The travailing engines rave.

The ponderous pistons urge like fate,
The red-throat furnaces roar elate,
And the sweating stokers stagger and swoon
 In a heat more fierce than hate.

So through the dark we stole our way
Past the grim warders and into the bay,
Past Kalibuyo, and past Salinas,—
 And came at the break of day

Where strong Cavité stood to oppose,—
Where, from a sheen of silver and rose,
A thronging of masts a soaring of towers

A thronging of masts, a soaring of towers,
The beautiful city arose.

How fine and fair! But the shining air
With a thousand shattered thunders there
Flapped and reeled. For the fighting foe—
We had caught him in his lair.

Surprised, unready, his proud ships lay
Idly at anchor in Bakor Bay:—
Unready, surprised, but proudly bold,
Which was ever the Spaniard's way.

Then soon on his pride the dread doom fell,
Red doom,—for the ruin of shot and shell
Lit every vomiting, bursting hulk
With a crimson reek of hell.

But to the brave though beaten, hail!
All hail to them that dare and fail!
To the dauntless boat that charged our fleet
And sank in the iron hail!

.
Manila Bay! Manila Bay!
How proud the song on our lips to-day!
A brave old song of the true and strong,
And the will that has its way;

Of the blood that told in the days of Drake
When the fight was good for the fighting's sake!
For the blood that fathered Farragut
Is the blood that fathered Blake;

And the pride of the blood will not be undone
While war's in the world and a fight to be won.
For the master now, as the master of old,
Is "the man behind the gun."

The dominant blood that daunts the foe,

That laughs at odds, and leaps to the blow,—
It is Dewey's glory to-day, as Nelson's
A hundred years ago!

CHARLES GEORGE DOUGLAS ROBERTS.

(By special permission of the author, and of Harper and Brothers.)

50

DEWEY AT MANILA

'Twas the very verge of May
When the bold *Olympia* led
Into Bocagrande gray
Dewey's squadron, dark and dread,—
Creeping past Corregidor,
Guardian of Manila's shore.

Do they sleep who wait the fray?
Is the moon so dazzling bright
That our cruisers' battle-gray
Melts into the misty light?...
Ah! the rockets flash and soar!
Wakes at last Corregidor!

All too late their screaming shell
Tears the silence with its track;
This is but the *gate* of hell,
We've no leisure to turn back.
Answer, *Boston*—then once more
Slumber on, Corregidor!

And as, like a slowing tide,
Onward still the vessels creep,
Dewey, watching, falcon-eyed,
Orders—"Let the gunners sleep;
For we meet a foe at four
Fiercer than Corregidor."

Well they slept, for well they knew
What the morrow taught us all—
He was wise (as well as true)
Thus upon the foe to fall.
Long shall Spain the day deplore
Dewey ran Corregidor.

May is dancing into light
As the Spanish Admiral

From a dream or phantom fight
 Wakens at his sentry's call.
Shall he leave Cavité's lee,
Hunt the Yankee fleet at sea?

O Montojo, to thy deck,
 That to-day shall float its last!
Quick! To quarters! Yonder speck
 Grows a hull of portent vast.
Hither, toward Cavité's lee
Comes the Yankee hunting thee!

Not for fear of hidden mine
 Halts our doughty Commodore.
He, of old heroic line,
 Follows Farragut once more,
Hazards all on victory,
Here within Cavité's lee.

If he loses, all is gone;
 He will win because he must.
And the shafts of yonder dawn
 Are not quicker than his thrust.
Soon, Montojo, he shall be
With thee in Cavité's lee.

Now, Manila, to the fray!
 Show the hated Yankee host
This is not a holiday—
 Spanish blood is more than boast.
Fleet and mine and battery,
Crush him in Cavité's lee!

Lo, hell's geysers at our fore
 Pierce the plotted path—in vain,
Nerving every man the more
 With the memory of the *Maine*!
Now at last our guns are free
Here within Cavité's lee

THE WINDMILL CAVITÉ'S LEE.

“Gridley,” says the Commodore,
“You may fire when ready.” Then
Long and loud, like lions’ roar
When a rival dares the den,
Breaks the awful cannonry
Full across Cavité’s lee.

Who shall tell the daring tale
Of Our Thunderbolt’s attack,
Finding, when the chart should fail,
By the lead his dubious track,
Five ships following faithfully
Five times o’er Cavité’s lee;

Of our gunners’ deadly aim;
Of the gallant foe and brave
Who, unconquered, faced with flame,
Seek the mercy of the wave—
Choosing honor in the sea
Underneath Cavité’s lee!

Let the meed the victors gain
Be the measure of their task.
Less of flinching, stouter strain,
Fiercer combat—who could ask?
And “surrender”—’twas a word
That Cavité ne’er had heard.

Noon—the woful work is done!
Not a Spanish ship remains;
But, of their eleven, none
Ever was so truly Spain’s!
Which is prouder, they or we,
Thinking of Cavité’s lee?

ENVOY

BUT remember, when we've ceased
Giving praise and reckoning odds,
Man shares courage with the beast,
Wisdom cometh from the gods.
Who would win, on land or wave,
Must be wise as well as brave.

ROBERT UNDERWOOD JOHNSON.

(By special permission of the author.)

51

THE MEN OF THE "MERRIMAC"

*HAIL to Hobson! hail to Hobson! hail to all the valiant set!
Clausen, Kelly, Deignan, Phillips, Murphy, Montagu, Charette!
Howsoe'er we laud and laurel we shall be their debtors yet!
Shame upon us, shame upon us, should the nation e'er forget!*

Though the tale be worn with telling, let the daring deed be sung!
Surely never brighter valor, since this wheeling world was young,
Thrilled men's souls to more than wonder, till praise leaped from every
tongue!

Trapped at last the Spanish sea-fox in the hill-locked harbor lay;
Spake the Admiral from his flagship, rocking off the hidden bay,
"We must close yon open portal lest he slip by night away!"

"Volunteers!" the signal lifted; rippling through the fleet it ran;
Was there ever deadlier venture? was there ever bolder plan?
Yet the gallant sailors answered, answered wellnigh to a man!

Ere the dawn's first rose-flush kindled, swiftly sped the chosen eight
Toward the batteries grimly frowning o'er the harbor's narrow gate;
Sooth, he holds his life but lightly who thus gives the dare to Fate!

They had passed the outer portal where the guns grinned, tier o'er tier,
When portentous Morro thundered, and Socapa echoed clear,
And Estrella joined a chorus pandemoniac to hear.

Heroes without hands to waver, heroes without hearts to quail,
There they sank the bulky collier 'mid the hurtling Spanish hail;
Long shall float our starry banner if such lads beneath it sail!

*Hail to Hobson! hail to Hobson! hail to all the valiant set!
Clausen, Kelly, Deignan, Phillips, Murphy, Montagu, Charette!
Howsoe'er we laud and laurel we shall be their debtors yet!
Shame upon us, shame upon us, should the nation e'er forget!*

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

THE CHARGE AT SANTIAGO

WITH shot and shell, like a loosened hell,
 Smiting them left and right,
 They rise or fall on the sloping wall
 Of beetling bush and height!
 They do not shrink at the awful brink
 Of the rifle's hurtling breath,
 But onward press, as their ranks grow less,
 To the open arms of death!

Through a storm of lead, o'er maimed and dead,
 Onward and up they go,
 Till hand to hand the unflinching band
 Grapple the stubborn foe.
 O'er men that reel, 'mid glint of steel,
 Bellow or boom of gun,
 They leap and shout over each redoubt
 Till the final trench is won!

O charge sublime! Over dust and grime
 Each hero hurls his name
 In shot or shell, like a molten hell,
 To the topmost heights of fame!
 And prone or stiff, under bush and cliff,
 Wounded or dead men lie,
 While the tropic sun on a grand deed done
 Looks with his piercing eye!

WILLIAM HAMILTON HAYNE.

(By special permission of the author.)

SPAIN'S LAST ARMADA

THEY fling their flags upon the morn,
Their safety's held a thing for scorn,
As to the fray the Spaniards on the wings of war are borne;
Their sullen smoke-clouds writhe and reel,
And sullen are their ships of steel,
All ready, cannon, lanyards, from the fighting-tops to keel.

They cast upon the golden air
One glancing, helpless, hopeless prayer,
To ask that swift and thorough be the victory falling there;
Then giants with a cheer and sigh
Burst forth to battle and to die
Beneath the walls of Morro on that morning in July.

The *Teresa* heads the haughty train,
To bear the Admiral of Spain,
She rushes, hurtling, whitening, like the summer hurricane;
El Morro glowers in his might;
Socapa crimsons with the fight;
The *Oquendo's* lunging lightning blazes through her somber night.

In desperate and eager dash
The *Vizcaya* hurls her vivid flash,
As wild upon the waters her enormous batteries crash;
Like spindrift scuds the fleet *Colon*,
And, on her bubbling wake bestrown,
Lurch, hungry for the slaughter, *El Furor* and *El Pluton*.

Round Santiago's armored crest,
Serene, in their gray valor dressed,
Our behemoths lie quiet, watching well from south and west;
Their keen eyes spy the harbor-reek;
The signals dance, the signals speak;
Then breaks the blasting riot as our broadsides storm and shriek!

Quick, poising on her eagle-wings,
The *Brooklyn* into battle swings;

The wide sea falls and wonders as the titan *Ilexas* springs;
The *Iowa* in monster-leaps
Goes bellowing above the deeps;
The *Indiana* thunders as her terror onward sweeps.

And, hovering near and hovering low
Until the moment strikes to go,
In gallantry the *Gloucester* swoops down on her double foe;
She volleys—the *Furor* falls lame;
Again—and the *Pluton*'s aflame;
Hurrah, on high she's tossed her! Gone the grim destroyers' fame!

And louder yet and louder roar
The *Oregon*'s black cannon o'er
The clangor and the booming all along the Cuban shore.
She's swift down her valkyr-path,
Her sword sharp for the aftermath,
With levin in her glooming, like Jehovah in His wrath.

Great ensigns snap and shine in air
Above the furious onslaught where
Our sailors cheer the battle, danger but a thing to dare;
Our gunners speed, as oft they've sped,
Their hail of shrilling, shattering lead,
Swift-sure our rifles rattle, and the foeman's decks are red.

Like baying bloodhounds lope our ships,
Adrip with fire their cannons' lips;
We scourge the fleeing Spanish, whistling weals from scorpion-whips;
Till, livid in the ghastly glare,
They tremble on in dread despair,
And thoughts of victory vanish in the carnage they must bear.

Where Cuban coasts in beauty bloom,
Where Cuban breakers swirl and boom,
The *Teresa*'s onset slackens in a scarlet spray of doom;
Near Nimanima's greening hill
The streaming flames cry down her will,
Her vast hull blows and blackens, prey to every mortal ill

Her vast hull bows and blackens, prey to every mortal ill.

On Juan Gonzales' foaming strand
The *Oquendo* plunges 'neath our hand,
Her armaments all strangled, and her hope a showering brand;
She strikes and grinds upon the reef,
And, shuddering there in utter grief,
In misery and mangled, wastes away beside her chief.

The *Vizcaya* nevermore shall ride
From out Aserradero's tide,
With hate upon her forehead ne'er again she'll pass in pride;
Beneath our fearful battle-spell
She moaned and struggled, flared and fell,
To lie a gleam and horrid, while the piling fires swell.

Thence from the wreck of Spain alone
Tears on the terrified *Colon*,
In bitter anguish crying, like a storm-bird forth she's flown;
Her throbbing engines creak and thrum;
She sees abeam the *Brooklyn* come,
For life she's gasping, flying; for the combat is she dumb.

Till then the man behind the gun
Had wrought whatever must be done—
Here, now, beside our boilers is the fight fought out and won;
Where great machines pulse on and beat,
A-swelter in the humming heat
The Nation's nameless toilers make her mastery complete.

The Cape o' the Cross casts out a stone
Against the course of the *Colon*,
Despairing and inglorious on the wind her white flag's thrown;
Spain's last Armada, lost and wan,
Lies where Tarquino's stream rolls on,
As round the world, victorious, looms the dreadnought *Oregon*.

The sparkling daybeams softly flow
To glint the twilight afterglow,

The banner sinks in splendor that in battle ne'er was low;
The music of our country's hymn
Rings out like song of seraphim,
Fond memories and tender fill the evening fair and dim;

Our huge ships ride in majesty
Unchallenged o'er the glittering sea,
Above them white stars cluster, mighty emblem of the free;
And all adown the long sea-lane
The fitful bale-fires wax and wane
To shed their lurid lustre on the empire that was Spain.

WALLACE RICE.

(By special permission of the author.)

IN Paco town and in Paco tower,
At the height of the tropic noonday hour,
Some Tagal riflemen, half a score,
Watched the length of the highway o'er,
And when to the front the troopers spurred,
Whiz-z! whiz-z! how the Mausers whirred!

From the opposite walls, through crevice and crack,
Volley on volley went ringing back
Where a band of regulars tried to drive
The stinging rebels out of their hive;
“Wait till our cannon come, and then,”
Cried a captain, striding among his men,
“We’ll settle that bothersome buzz and drone
With a merry little tune of our own!”

The sweltering breezes seemed to swoon,
And down the *calle* the thickening flames
Licked the roofs in the tropic noon.
Then through the crackle and glare and heat,
And the smoke and the answering acclaims
Of the rifles, far up the village street
Was heard the clatter of horses’ feet,
And a band of signal-men swung in sight,
Hasting back from the ebbing fight
That had swept away to the left and right.

“Ride!” yelled the regulars, all aghast,
And over the heads of the signal-men,
As they whirled in desperate gallop past,
The bullets a vicious music made,
Like the whistle and whine of the midnight blast
On the weltering wastes of the ocean when
The breast of the deep is scourged and flayed.

It chanced in the line of the fiercest fire
A rebel bullet had clipped the wire

That led, from the front and the fighting, down
To those that stayed in Manila town;
This gap arrested the watchful eye
Of one of the signal-men galloping by,
And straightway, out of the plunge and press,
He reined his horse with a swift caress
And a word in the ear of the rushing steed;
Then back with never a halt nor heed
Of the swarming bullets he rode, his goal
The parted wire and the slender pole
That stood where the deadly tower looked down
On the rack and ruin of Paco town.

Out of his saddle he sprang as gay
As a schoolboy taking a holiday;
Wire in hand up the pole he went
With never a glance at the tower, intent
Only on that which he saw appear
As the line of his duty plain and clear.
To the very crest he climbed, and there,
While the bullets buzzed in the scorching air,
Clipped his clothing, and scored and stung
The slender pole-top to which he clung,
Made the wire that was severed sound,
Slipped in his careless way to the ground,
Sprang to the back of his horse, and then
Was off, this bravest of signal-men.
Cheers for the hero! While such as he,
Heedless alike of wounds and scars,
Fight for the dear old Stripes and Stars,
Down through the years to us shall be
Ever and ever the victory!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

IN TIME OF PEACE

55

PEACE HATH HER VICTORIES

ALL sobbing, shrieking, swirls the gale,
December in its sweep,
Till ocean's hoary face is pale
With foam, abysses deep;
Then see within the furious spray
A ship against the gray!

The sirens sing by George's shoal
And lure their victim in,
So the *Lord Gough*, through surge and roll,
The dismal drift and din,
Comes round to where the breakers comb
Into sheer, wind-swept foam.

They see, half-way the shattered mast,
The Stars and Stripes stand out;
They hear, above the howling blast,
Old Hughes, with mighty shout,
"Now, boys, three hearty English cheers!
Come forward, volunteers!"

They man their boat, these gallant tars,
Though skies beat down the sea—
When falls the flag with all its stars,
Then to the masthead free
Runs up, the blue above, to swear,
"For us Fate still is fair!"

In frosty blasts that seek to blow
Their valor from the helm,
They row as they would have you row
When billows overwhelm:
The baffled storm its witness bears—
The *Cleopatra*'s theirs!

He thaws the winter from his bone,
He mourns the ship so gone,

And Pendleton tells great gales blown,
Despair since drifting dawn;
Water-logged, with his boats stove in,
What hope was his to win?

He saw the sailors on the *Gough*—
Death stood before his eyes,
He knew they would be putting off
Where seas beat back the skies;
His flag free on the tempest flew
Lest they should perish too....

While Englishmen in mercy go
Cheering, to war with Death,
While the Americans can throw
Off hope, for others' breath,
A tyrant Fate need slink afraid,
From clear eyes, undismayed.

And oh, ye folk of English speech,
When such a brood ye've borne,
What favor need ye e'er beseech
From Fate so ripe for scorn?
'Tis yours, ye freemen, by your birth,
All that ye will on earth!

WALLACE RICE.

(By special permission of the author.)

DIDN'T know Flynn,—
Flynn of Virginia,—
Long as he's been 'yar?
Look'ee here, stranger,
Whar *hev* you been?

Here in this tunnel
He was my pardner,
That same Tom Flynn,—
Working together,
In wind and weather,
Day out and in.

Didn't know Flynn!
Well, that *is* queer;
Why, it's a sin
To think of Tom Flynn,—
Tom with his cheer,
Tom without fear,—
Stranger, look 'yar!

Thar in the drift,
Back to the wall,
He held the timbers
Ready to fall;
Then in the darkness
I heard him call:
“Run for your life, Jake!
Run for your wife's sake!
Don't wait for me.”
And that was all
Heard in the din,
Heard of Tom Flynn,—
Flynn of Virginia.

That's all about
Flynn of Virginia.

That lets me out.
Here in the damp,—
Out of the sun,—
That 'ar derned lamp
Makes my eyes run.
Well, there,—I'm done!

But, sir, when you'll
Hear the next fool
Asking of Flynn,—
Flynn of Virginia,—
Just you chip in,
Say you knew Flynn;
Say that you've been 'yar.

BRET HARTE.

(By special permission of Houghton, Mifflin and Company.)

WHEN you hear the fire-gongs beat fierce along the startled street,
See the great-limbed horses bound, and the gleaming engine sway,
And the driver in his place, with his fixed, heroic face,
Say a prayer for Calnan's sake—he that died on Christmas day!

Cling! Cling! Each to his station!
Clang! Clang! Quick to clear the way!
(Christ keep the soldiers of salvation,
Fighting nameless battles in the war of every day!)

In the morning, blue and mild, of the Mother and the Child,
While the blessed bells were calling, thrilled the summons through the
wire;
In the morning, blue and mild, for a woman and a child
Died a man of gentle will, plunging on to fight the fire.

Ring, swing, bells in the steeple!
Ring the Child and ring the Star, as sweetly as ye may!
Ring, swing, bells, to tell the people
God's good will to earthly men, the men of every day!

"Thirty-four" swung out a gleam, with her mighty, bounding team;
Horses' honor pricked them on, and they leaped as at a goad;
Jimmy Calnan in his place, with his clean-cut Irish face,
Iron hands upon the reins, eyes a-strain upon the road.

Clang! Clang! Quick to clear the way!
(Sweetly rang, above the clang, the bells of Christmas day.)

Tearing, plunging through the din, scarce a man could hold them in;
None on earth could pull them short: Mary Mother, guide from harm
Yonder woman straight ahead, stony still with sudden dread,
And the little woman-child, with her waxen child in arm!

Oh, God's calls, how swift they are! Oh, the Cross that hides the Star!
Oh, the fire-gong beating fierce through the bells of Christmas day!
Just a second there to choose, and a life to keep or lose—
To the curb he swung the horses and he flung his life away!

to the curb he swung the horses, and he hung his life away.

Ring, swing, bells in the steeple!
Ring the Star and ring the Cross, for Star and Cross are one!
Ring, swing, bells, to tell the people
God is pleased with manly men, and the deeds that they have done!

HELEN GRAY CONE.

(By special permission of the author, and of The Century Company.)

HOW HE SAVED ST. MICHAEL'S

It was long ago it happened, ere ever the signal gun
That blazed above Fort Sumter had wakened the North as one;
Long ere the wondrous pillar of battle-cloud and fire
Had marked where the unchained millions marched on to their hearts'
 desire.

On the roofs and the glittering turrets, that night, as the sun went down,
The mellow glow of the twilight shone like a jewelled crown,
And, bathed in the living glory, as the people lifted their eyes,
They saw the pride of the city, the spire of St. Michael's, rise

High over the lesser steeples, tipped with a golden ball,
That hung like a radiant planet caught in its earthward fall;
First glimpse of home to the sailor who made the harbor round,
The last slow-fading vision dear to the outward bound.

The gently gathering shadows shut out the waning light;
The children prayed at their bedsides, as you will pray to-night;
The noise of buyer and seller from the busy mart was gone,
And in dreams of a peaceful morrow the city slumbered on.

But another light than sunrise aroused the sleeping street,
For a cry was heard at midnight, and the rush of trampling feet;
Men stared in each other's faces through mingled fire and smoke,
While the frantic bells went clashing clamorous stroke on stroke!

By the glare of her blazing roof-tree the houseless mother fled,
With the babe she pressed to her bosom shrieking in nameless dread,
While the fire-king's wild battalions scaled wall and capstone high,
And planted their flaring banners against an inky sky.

From the death that raged behind them and the crash of ruin loud,
To the great square of the city, were driven the surging crowd,
Where yet firm in all the tumult, unscathed by the fiery flood,
With its heavenward-pointing finger the church of St. Michael stood.

But e'en as they gazed upon it there rose a sudden wail,
A cry of horror blended with the roaring of the gale

A cry of horror blended with the roaring of the gale,
On whose scorching wings updriven a single flaming brand
Aloft on the towering steeple clung like a bloody hand.

“Will it fade?” The whisper trembled from a thousand whitening lips;
Far out on the lurid harbor they watched it from the ships—
A baleful gleam that brighter and ever brighter shone,
Like a flickering, trembling will-o’-the-wisp to a steady beacon grown.

“Uncounted gold shall be given to the man whose brave right hand,
For the love of the periled city, plucks down yon burning brand!”
So cried the Mayor of Charleston, that all the people heard,
But they looked each one at his fellow, and no man spoke a word.

Who is it leans from the belfry, with face upturned to the sky?
Clings to a column and measures the dizzy spire with his eye?
Will he dare it, the hero undaunted, that terrible, sickening height?
Or will the hot blood of his courage freeze in his veins at the sight?

But see! he has stepped on the railing, he climbs with his feet and his hands,
And firm on a narrow projection with the belfry beneath him he stands!
Now once, and once only, they cheer him—a single, tempestuous breath—
And there falls on the multitude gazing a hush like the stillness of death.

Slow, steadily mounting, unheeding aught save the goal of the fire,
Still higher and higher, an atom, he moves on the face of the spire;
He stops! Will he fall? Lo, for answer, a gleam like a meteor’s track!
And, hurled on the stones of the pavement, the red brand lies shattered and
black!

Once more the shouts of the people have rent the quivering air,
At the church-door Mayor and Council wait with their feet on the stair,
And the eager throng behind them press for a touch of his hand—
The unknown savior whose daring could compass a deed so grand.

But why does a sudden tremor seize on them while they gaze?
And what means the stifled murmur of wonder and amaze?
He stood in the gate of the temple he had periled his life to save,
And the face of the hero undaunted was the sable face of a slave!

With folded arms he was speaking, in tones that were clear, not loud,
And his eyes, ablaze in their sockets, burnt into the eyes of the crowd:
“You may keep your gold,—I scorn it!—but answer me, ye who can,
If the deed I have done before you be not the deed of a *man*?”

He stepped but a short space backward, and from all the women and men
There were only sobs for answer, and the Mayor called for a pen
And the great seal of the city, that he might read who ran;
And the slave who saved St. Michael’s went out from the door, a man.

MARY ANNA PHINNEY STANSBURY.

(By special permission of the author.)

No song of a soldier riding down
To the raging fight of Winchester town;
No song of a time that shook the earth
With the nation's throe at a nation's birth;
But the song of a brave man free from fear
As Sheridan's self or Paul Revere;
Who risked what they risked,—free from strife
And its promise of glorious pay,—his life.

The peaceful valley has waked and stirred,
And the answering echoes of life are heard;
The dew still clings to the trees and grass,
And the early toilers smiling pass,
As they glance aside at the white-walled homes,
Or up the valley where merrily comes
The brook that sparkles in diamond rills
As the sun comes over the Hampshire hills.

What was it passed like an ominous breath?
Like a shiver of fear, or a touch of death?
What was it? The valley is peaceful still,
And the leaves are afire on the top of the hill;
It was not a sound, nor a thing of sense,—
But a pain, like a pang in the short suspense
That wraps the being of those who see
At their feet the gulf of eternity.

The air of the valley has felt the chill;
The workers pause at the door of the mill;
The housewife, keen to the shivering air,
Arrests her foot on the cottage stair,
Instinctive taught by the mother-love,
And thinks of the sleeping ones above.

Why start the listeners? Why does the course
Of the mill-stream widen? Is it a horse—
“Hark to the sound of the hoofs!” they say—

That gallops so wildly Williamsburg way?
God! what was that like a human shriek
From the winding valley? Will nobody speak?
Will nobody answer those women who cry
As the awful warnings thunder by?

Whence come they? Listen! and now they hear
The sound of the galloping horse-hoofs near;
They watch the trend of the vale, and see
The rider who thunders so menacingly,
With waving arms and warning scream
To the home-filled banks of the valley stream.
He draws no rein, but he shakes the street
With a shout and the ring of the galloping feet,
And this the cry that he flings to the wind,—
“To the hills for your lives! The flood is behind!”

He cries and is gone, but they know the worst,—
The treacherous Williamsburg dam has burst!
The basin that nourished their happy homes
Is changed to a demon. It comes! it comes!
A monster in aspect, with shaggy front
Of shattered dwellings to take the brunt
Of the dwellings they shatter;—white-maned and hoarse
The merciless terror fills the course
Of the narrow valley, and rushing raves
With death on the first of its hissing waves,
Till cottage and street and crowded mill
Are crumbled and crushed. But onward still,
In front of the roaring flood, is heard
The galloping horse and the warning word.

Thank God that the brave man's life is spared!
From Williamsburg town he nobly dared
To race with the flood, and to take the road
In front of the terrible swath it mowed.
For miles it thundered and crashed behind,
But he looked ahead with a steadfast mind:

“They must be warned!” was all he said,
As away on his terrible ride he sped.

When heroes are called for, bring the crown
To this Yankee rider; send him down
On the stream of time with the Curtius old;
His deed, as the Roman’s, was brave and bold;
And the tale can as noble a thrill awake,
For he offered his life for the people’s sake!

JOHN BOYLE O’REILLY.

(By special permission of Miss Mary Boyle O’Reilly.)

WALL, no! I can't tell whar he lives,
 Becase he don't live, you see;
Leastways, he's got out of the habit
 Of livin' like you and me.
Whar have you been for the last three year
 That you haven't heard folks tell
How Jimmy Bludso passed in his checks
 The night of the *Prairie Belle*?

He wer'n't no saint,—them engineers
 Is all pretty much alike,—
One wife in Natchez-under-the-Hill
 And another one here, in Pike;
A keerless man in his talk was Jim,
 And an awkward hand in a row,
But he never flunked, and he never lied,—
 I reckon he never knowed how.

And this was all the religion he had,—
 To treat his engine well;
Never be passed on the river;
 To mind the pilot's bell;
And if ever the *Prairie Belle* took fire,—
 A thousand times he swore,
He'd hold her nozzle agin the bank
 Till the last soul got ashore.

All boats has their day on the Mississip,
 And her day come at last,—
The *Movastar* was a better boat,
 But the *Belle* she *wouldn't* be passed.
And so she come tearin' along that night—
 The oldest craft on the line—
With a nigger squat on her safety-valve,
 And her furnace crammed, rosin and pine.

The fire bust out as she dared the bar,

And burnt a hole in the night,
And quick as a flash she turned, and made
For that willer-bank on the right.
There was runnin' and cursin', but Jim yelled out,
Over all the infernal roar,
"I'll hold her nozzle agin the bank
Till the last galoot's ashore."

Through the hot, black breath of the burnin' boat
Jim Bludso's voice was heard,
And they all had trust in his cussedness,
And knowed he would keep his word.
And sure's you're born, they all got off
Afore the smokestacks fell,—
And Bludso's ghost went up alone
In the smoke of the *Prairie Belle*.

He wer'n't no saint,—but at jedgment
I'd run my chance with Jim,
'Longside of some pious gentlemen
That wouldn't shook hands with him.
He seen his duty, a dead-sure thing,—
And went for it thar and then;
And Christ ain't a-going to be too hard
On a man that died for men.

JOHN HAY.

(By special permission of the author, and of Houghton, Mifflin and
Company.)

MEN have done brave deeds,
And bards have sung them well;
I of good George Nidiver
Now the tale will tell.

In Californian mountains
A hunter bold was he;
Keen his eye and sure his aim
As any you should see.

A little Indian boy
Followed him everywhere,
Eager to share the hunter's joy,
The hunter's meal to share.

And when the bird or deer
Fell by the hunter's skill,
The boy was always near
To help with right good will.

One day as through the cleft
Between two mountains steep,
Shut in both right and left,
Their questing way they keep,

They see two grizzly bears,
With hunger fierce and fell,
Rush at them unawares
Right down the narrow dell.

The boy turned round with screams,
And ran with terror wild;
One of the pair of savage beasts
Pursued the shrieking child.

The hunter raised his gun,
He knew one charge was all,
And through the boy's nursing foe

And through the boy's pursuing too
He sent his only ball.

The other on George Nidiver
Came on with dreadful pace;
The hunter stood unarmed,
And met him face to face.

I say *unarmed* he stood;
Against those frightful paws,
The rifle butt, or club of wood,
Could stand no more than straws.

George Nidiver stood still,
And looked him in the face;
The wild beast stopped amazed,
Then came with slackened pace.

Still firm the hunter stood,
Although his heart beat high;
Again the creature stopped,
And gazed with wondering eye.

The hunter met his gaze,
Nor yet an inch gave way;
The bear turned slowly round,
And slowly moved away.

What thoughts were in his mind
It would be hard to spell;
What thoughts were in George Nidiver's
I rather guess than tell.

But sure that rifle's aim,
Swift choice of generous part,
Showed in its passing gleam
The depths of a brave heart.

ANONYMOUS.

A MAN'S NAME

THROUGH the packed horror of the night
It rose up like a star,
And sailed into the infinite,
Where the immortals are.

“Down brakes!” One splendid hard-held breath,
And lo, an unknown name
Strode into sovereignty from death
Trailing a path of flame!

“Jump!”—“I remain.”—No needless word,
No vagueness in his breast;
Along his blood the swift test stirred—
He answered to the test,

Gripped his black peril like a vise,
And, as he grappled, saw
That life is one with sacrifice,
And duty one with law.

Home:—but his feet grew granite fast;
Wife:—yet he did not reel;
Babes:—ah, they tugged! but to the last
He stood as true as steel.

Above his own heart’s lovingness,
Above another’s crime,
Above the immitigable stress,
Above himself and time,

Smote loving Comfort on the cheek,
Gave quibbling Fear the lie,
Taught ambling Fluence how to speak,
And brave men how to die.

Who said the time of kings was gone?
Who said our Alps were low,
And not by God’s airs blown upon?

And not by God's arms blown upon.

Behold, it is not so!

Out from the palace and the hut,
Dwarf-fronted, lame of will,
Limp our marred Joves and giants—but
Sceptered for mastery still,

And clothed with puissance to quell
Whatever mobs of shame
Are leagued within us, with such spell
As David Simmons' name.

RICHARD REALF.

(From *Poems*, by Richard Realf. Copyright, Funk and Wagnalls
Company, 1898. By special permission.)

THE MAN WHO RODE TO CONEMAUGH

INTO the town of Conemaugh,
Striking the people's souls with awe,
Dashed a rider, aflame and pale,
Never alighting to tell his tale,
Sitting his big bay horse astride.
"Run for your lives to the hills!" he cried;
"Run to the hills!" was what he said,
As he waved his hand and dashed ahead.

"Run for your lives to the hills!" he cried,
Spurring his horse, whose reeking side
Was flecked with foam as red as flame.
Whither he goes and whence he came
Nobody knows. They see his horse
Plunging on in his frantic course,
Veins distended and nostrils wide,
Fired and frenzied at such a ride.
Nobody knows the rider's name—
Dead forever to earthly fame.
"Run to the hills! to the hills!" he cried;
"Run for your lives to the mountain side!"

"Stop him! he's mad! just look at him go!
'T ain't safe," they said, "to let him ride so."
"He thinks he can scare us," said one, with a laugh,
"But Conemaugh folks don't swallow no chaff;
'T ain't nothing, I'll bet, but the same old leak
In the dam above the South Fork Creek."
Blind to their danger, callous of dread,
They laughed as he left them and dashed ahead.
"Run for your lives to the hills!" he cried,
Lashing his horse in his desperate ride.

Down through the valley the rider passed,
Shouting, and spurring his horse on fast;
But not so fast did the rider go
As the raging, roaring, mighty flow

Of the million feet and the millions more
Of water whose fury he fled before.
On he went, and on it came,
The flood itself a very flame
Of surging, swirling, seething tide,
Mountain high and torrents wide.
God alone might measure the force
Of the Conemaugh flood in its V-shaped course.
Behind him were buried under the flood
Conemaugh town and all who stood
Jeering there at the man who cried,
“Run for your lives to the mountain side!”

On he sped in his fierce, wild ride.
“Run to the hills! to the hills!” he cried.
Nearer, nearer raged the roar
Horse and rider fled before.
Dashing along the valley ridge,
They came at last to the railroad bridge.
The big horse stood, the rider cried,
“Run for your lives to the mountain side!”
Then plunged across, but not before
The mighty, merciless mountain roar
Struck the bridge and swept it away
Like a bit of straw or a wisp of hay.
But over and under and through that tide
The voice of the unknown rider cried,
“Run to the hills! to the hills!” it cried,—
“Run for your lives to the mountain side!”

JOHN ELIOT BOWEN.

(By special permission of Edward A. Bowen, Esq., and of Harper and
Brothers.)

JOHNNY BARTHOLOMEW

THE journals this morning are full of a tale
Of a terrible ride through a tunnel by rail;
And people are called on to note and admire
How a hundred or more, through the smoke-cloud and fire,
Were borne from all peril to limbs and to lives—
Mothers saved to their children, and husbands to wives.
But of him who performed such a notable deed
Quite little the journalists give us to read.
In truth, of this hero so plucky and bold
There is nothing except, in few syllables told,
His name, which is Johnny Bartholomew.

Away in Nevada—they don't tell us where,
Nor does it much matter—a railway is there
Which winds in and out through the cloven ravines,
With glimpses at times of the wildest of scenes:
Now passing a bridge seeming fine as a thread,
Now shooting past cliffs that impend o'er the head,
Now plunging some black-throated tunnel within,
Whose darkness is roused at the clatter and din;
And ran every day with its train o'er the road
An engine that steadily dragged on its load,
And was driven by Johnny Bartholomew.

With throttle-valve down, he was slowing the train,
While the sparks fell around and behind him like rain.
As he came to a spot where a curve to the right
Brought the black, yawning mouth of a tunnel in sight,
And, peering ahead with a far-seeing ken,
Felt a quick sense of danger come over him then.
Was a train on the track? No! A peril as dire—
The farther extreme of the tunnel on fire!
And the volume of smoke, as it gathered and rolled,
Shook fearful dismay from each dun-colored fold,
But daunted not Johnny Bartholomew.

Beat faster his heart, though its current stood still,

And his nerves felt a jar, but no tremulous thrill;
And his eyes keenly gleamed through their partly closed lashes,
And his lips—not with fear—took the color of ashes.
“If we falter, these people behind us are dead!
So close the doors, fireman; we’ll send her ahead!
Crowd on the steam till she rattles and swings!
Open the throttle-valve! give her her wings!”
Shouted he from his post in the engineer’s room,
Driving onward perchance to a terrible doom,
 This man they call Johnny Bartholomew.

Firm grasping the bell-rope and holding his breath,
On, on through the Vale of the Shadow of Death;
On, on through the horrible cavern of hell,
Through flames that arose and through timbers that fell,
Through the eddying smoke and the serpents of fire
That writhed and that hissed in their anguish and ire.
With a rush and a roar like the wild tempest’s blast,
To the free air beyond them in safety they passed;
While the clang of the bell and the steam-pipe’s shrill yell
Told the joy of escape from that underground hell
 Of the man they called Johnny Bartholomew.

Did the passengers get up a service of plate?
Did some oily-tongued orator at the man prate?
Women kiss him? Young children cling fast to his knees?
Stout men in their rapture his brown fingers squeeze?
And where was he born? Is he handsome? Has he
A wife for his bosom, a child for his knee?
Is he young? Is he old? Is he tall? Is he short?
Well, ladies, the journals tell naught of the sort.
And all that they give us about him to-day,
After telling the tale in a commonplace way,
 Is—the man’s name is Johnny Bartholomew.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

(By special permission of the author, and of Harper and Brothers.)

HIS NAME

O, the billows of fire!
With maelstrom-like swirl,
Their surges they hurl
Over roof, over spire,
Mad, masterless, higher,
Till rumble—crack—crash—
Down boom with a flash,
Whole columns of granite and marble: see! see!
Sucked in as a weed on the ocean might be,
Or engulfed as a sail
In the hurricane-riot and wreak of the gale!

Ha! yonder they rush where the death-dealing steam,
Over-pent, waits their gleam
To shudder the city with earthquake! Who, *who*
Will adventure mid-flame, and unfasten the screw,
Set the fiend loose, and save us so? Firemen, you—
You willing? Would God you might hazard it! Nay,
The red tongues are licking the faucets now! Stay!
Too late!—’tis too late!
If ruin, explosion, must come, let us wait
Its coming: to go is to perish.—Hold! hold!
You are young—I am old—
You’ve a wife too—and children?... O God, he is gone
Straight into destruction! The pipes, men! On—on!
Play the water-stream on him—full—faster—the whole!
And now ... Christ save his soul!

I stifle—I choke—
And *he*—Heaven grant that he smother in smoke
Ere the dread detonation! Hark!—hark! What’s the shout?
Is he saved? Is he out?
Did he compass his purpose?... The hero! *One* name
This pencil of fire on the records of Fame
Shall blazon, if justice is meted. Why here
On my cheek is a tear,
Which not a whole city in ashes could claim!

His name, now,—*can nobody tell me his name?*
—MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

(By special permission of Dr. George J. Preston.)

66

OLD BRADDOCK

FIRE! fire in Allentown!

The Women's Building—it must go.
Mothers wild rush up and down,
Despairing men push to and fro;
Two stories caught—one story more—
See—see—old Braddock's to the fore,
Braddock, full three-score.

Like a high granite rock

His good gray head looms huge and bare;
Firm as rock in tempest shock
He towers above the tallest there.
“Conrad!” 'Tis Braddock to his son,
The prop he thinks to lean upon
When his work is done.

Conrad, the young and brave,

Unflinching meets his father's eye:
“Who would now the children save,
That they die not himself must die.”
The boy, in that white face no fear—
But, oh, it is so sweet, so dear—
Life at twenty year!

“Father—Father!” A quick

Embrace, and he has set his feet
On the ladder. Rolling thick,
The flame-shot smoke chokes all the street,
So blinds one only has descried
Her form, that, through its dreadful tide,
Springs to Conrad's side.

Strong she is, now, as he,

Throbbing with love's own lion might;
Strong as beautiful is she,
And Conrad's arms are pinioned tight.
“Far through the fire, sits God above—”

In vain he pleads; full does it prove,
Her full strength of love.

Too late she sets him free—
 High overhead his father's call:
From a height no eye can see
 Calls hoary Braddock down the wall,—
“Old men are Death's, let him destroy.
Young men are Life's, Conrad, my boy—
Life's and Love's, my boy!”

Wilder the women's cries,
 Hoarser the shouts of men below;
Sheets of fire against the skies,
 Set all the stricken town aglow.
With sweep and shriek, with rush and roar,
The flames shut round old Braddock hoar—
Braddock, full three-score.

“Save, save my children, save!”
 “Aye, aye!” all answer, speak as one,
“If man's arm can from the grave
 Bring back your babes, it will be done;
Know Braddock still is worth us all—
Hark—hark! It is his own brave call,—
‘Back—back from the wall!’ ”

God, God, that it should be!
 As savagely the lashed wind veers,
Fiercer than the fiery sea
 The frantic crowd waves hands, and cheers;
An old man high in whirl of hell!
The children—how, no soul can tell—
Braddock holds them well.

Shorn all that good gray head
 With snows of sixty winters sown;
Griped around the children's bed,
 One arm is shriveled to the bone.

One arm is shivered to the bone:
“Old men are Death’s, let him destroy,
Young men are Life’s, Conrad, my boy,
Life’s and Love’s, my boy!”...

Fire! fire in Allentown!

Though ’twas a hundred years ago,
How the babes were carried down,
To-day the village children know.
They know of Braddock’s good gray head,
They know the last, great words he said,
Know how he fell—dead.

JOHN VANCE CHENEY.

(By special permission of the author.)

67

IN APIA BAY

(Morituri vos salutamus)

RUIN and death held sway
That night in Apia Bay,
And smote amid the loud and dreadful gloom.
But, Hearts, no longer weep
The salt unresting sleep
Of the great dead, victorious in their doom.

Vain, vain the strait retreat
That held the fated fleet,
Trapped in the two-fold threat of sea and shore!
Fell reefs on either hand,
And the devouring strand!
Above, below, the tempest's deafening roar!

What mortal hand shall write
The horror of that night,
The desperate struggle in that deadly close,
The yelling of the blast,
The wild surf, white, aghast,
The whelming seas, the thunder and the throes!

How the great cables surged,
The giant engines urged,
As the brave ships the unequal strife waged on!
Not hope, not courage flagged;
But the vain anchors dragged.
Down on the reefs they shattered, and were gone!

And now were wrought the deeds
Whereof each soul that reads
Grows manlier, and burns with prouder breath,—
Heroic brotherhood,
The loving bonds of blood,
Proclaimed from high hearts face to face with death.

At length, the English ship
Her cables had let slip,
On the reef she shattered, and was gone!

Crowded all steam, and steered for the open sea,
Resolved to challenge Fate,
To pass the perilous strait,
And wrench from jaws of ruin Victory.

With well-tried metals strained,
In the storm's teeth she gained,
Foot by slow foot made head, and crept toward life.
Across her dubious way
The good ship *Trenton* lay,
Helpless, but thrilled to watch the splendid strife.

Helmless she lay, her bulk
A blind and wallowing hulk,
By her strained hawsers only held from wreck,
But dauntless each brave heart
Played his immortal part
In strong endurance on the reeling deck.

They fought Fate inch by inch,—
Could die, but could not flinch;
And, biding the inevitable doom,
They marked the English ship,
Baffling the tempest's grip,
Forge hardly forth from the expected tomb.

Then, with exultant breath,
These heroes waiting death,
Thundered across the storm a peal of cheers,—
To the triumphant brave
A greeting from the grave,
Whose echo shall go ringing down the years.

“To you, who well have won,
From us, whose course is run,
Glad greeting, as we face the undreaded end!”
The memory of those cheers
Shall thrill in English ears
Where'er this English blood and speech extend

where of this English blood and speech extend.

No manlier deed comes down,
Blazoned in broad renown,
From men of old who lived to dare and die!
The old fire yet survives,
Here in our modern lives,
Of splendid chivalry and valor high!

CHARLES GEORGE DOUGLAS ROBERTS.

(By special permission of the author, and of *The Youth's Companion*.)

NOTES

[For information incorporated in the notes the Editor is indebted to many of the authors represented in the volume. He has also, in several instances, received valuable suggestions from Mr. Francis F. Browne's "Bugle Echoes." The notes are intended to be suggestive rather than in any sense exhaustive.]

In Time of Strife

1. PAUL REVERE'S RIDE. By Henry Wadsworth Longfellow.

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow, the most widely read and most beloved American poet, was born in Portland, Maine, February 27, 1807, and died in Cambridge, Massachusetts, where he had long resided, March 24, 1882.

Paul Revere, who was a self-taught engraver upon copperplate, and who at the time of the Revolution was one of the four engravers in America, rendered his first important service as a messenger in connection with the throwing overboard of the tea in Boston harbor. Before he took his most famous ride he had traveled several thousand miles in the interest of the "patriot" cause, and after

"the eighteenth of April, in Seventy-Five,"

continued to act as a bearer of dispatches. He was one of the committee of upwards of thirty formed in Boston to watch the movements of the British soldiers. On the memorable evening of April 18th, troops were observed marching toward the bottom of the Common. About ten o'clock Revere was apprised of this fact, whereupon he at once repaired to the house of Dr. Joseph Warren (afterward General Warren), one of the committee. There he discovered that an "express," one William Dawes, had already been sent by land to Lexington. Hurriedly seeking his friend, Robert Newman, the sexton of the "Old North Church" (Christ Church, Salem Street), and arranging for

the display of the signal previously agreed upon, Revere set out. He succeeded in reaching Lexington before Dawes, who joined him about half an hour after his arrival. The two, together with Dr. Prescott, “a high Son of Liberty,” started in company for Concord, but were intercepted at Lincoln by a party of British. Revere and Dawes were captured, but Prescott managed to escape by jumping his horse over a stone wall. It was he who rode on to Concord, alarming the countryside as he went.

Of Dawes’s part in the enterprise of the night, Helen F. More wrote thus humorously in the *Century Magazine* for February, 1896:

WHAT’S IN A NAME?

I AM a wandering, bitter shade;
Never of me was a hero made;
Poets have never sung my praise,
Nobody crowned my brows with bays;
And if you ask me the fatal cause,
I answer only, "My name was Dawes."

'Tis all very well for children to hear
Of the midnight ride of Paul Revere;
But why should my name be quite forgot,
Who rode so boldly and well, God wot?
Why should I ask? The reason is clear—
My name is Dawes and his Revere.

When the lights from the Old North Church flashed out,
Paul Revere was waiting about,
But I was already on my way.
The shadows of night fell cold and gray
As I rode, with never a break or pause;
But what was the use, when my name was Dawes?

History rings with his silvery name;
Closed to me are the portals of fame.
Had he been Dawes and I Revere,
No one had heard of him, I fear.
No one has heard of me because
He was Revere and I was Dawes.

Paul Revere was born within sight of the "Old North Church," and almost under its shadow he lived and died (1735-1818). It is fitting, then, that to-day the passer should see, imbedded in the solid masonry of the tower, a tablet bearing this inscription:

THE SIGNAL LANTERNS OF
PAUL REVERE
DISPLAYED IN THE STEEPLE OF THIS CHURCH
APRIL 18, 1775,

WARNED THE COUNTRY OF THE MARCH
OF THE BRITISH TROOPS TO
LEXINGTON AND CONCORD.

2. MARY BUTLER'S RIDE. By Benjamin Franklin Taylor.

Benjamin Franklin Taylor was born in Lowville, New York, July 19, 1819. He was best known as a lecturer. He died in Cleveland, Ohio, February 24, 1887.

Of the poem the author says: "The story of 'Mary Butler's Ride' is unembellished truth. To one of her grandsons, J. M. Taylor, Esq., of New York, I am indebted for the incident. To hear men say,—those far-away boys of hers, and yet busy in life's affairs,—'many a time I have heard her tell the story!' brings the gray-eyed Mary Butler strangely near. It is like raising a dead century to instant resurrection."

1. **39. Stark** (John, 1728-1822), a Continental brigadier-general who distinguished himself at Bunker Hill and Bennington.

1. **84. Putnam** (Israel, 1718-1790), a Continental major-general, active at Bunker Hill and in various other engagements until stricken by paralysis in 1779. His daring escape from the British soldiers by riding down a flight of stone steps in the town of Greenwich, Connecticut, occurred in March, 1779.

3. THE SURPRISE AT TICONDEROGA. By Mary Anna Phinney Stansbury.

Mary Anna Phinney Stansbury, a magazine writer who resides in Appleton, Wisconsin, was born in Vernon, New York, October 5, 1842.

Ethan Allen, the hero of Ticonderoga, though born in Litchfield, Connecticut (January 10, 1737), early removed to Vermont. He participated in the invasion of Canada under General Schuyler, and was there captured and sent a prisoner to England, where he suffered many privations. It was largely through his instrumentality that Vermont was recognized as an independent State. He died in Burlington, February 13, 1789.

The fortress of Ticonderoga (a corruption of the Iroquois "Cheonderoga," meaning "rushing waters") was erected by the French, in 1755, on the western shore of Lake Champlain, near the outlet of Lake George. It was originally called Fort Carillon (chime of bells) from the neighboring waterfall (see stanza 6). It was here that the French under

Montcalm (stanza 13) repulsed the English under Abercrombie, on the 8th of July, 1758.

Allen's bold capture was effected on the morning of May 10, 1775.

At the time of the taking of Ticonderoga by Allen, the garrison consisted of but forty-eight men under the command of Captain Delaplace. The Continental Congress, which Allen invoked at the time of the surrender, had not yet organized. It held its first session six hours later on that very day.

Stanza 11. King David. See 2 Samuel v., 23, 24.

The Vermont "Green Mountain Boys," mentioned so prominently in a number of engagements in the Revolution, were first organized in 1772 to resist the civil power of New York.

In connection with Mrs. Stansbury's poem it may be interesting to read Robert Louis Stevenson's ballad, "Ticonderoga."

4. MONTGOMERY AT QUEBEC. By Clinton Scollard.

Clinton Scollard, born in Clinton, New York, September 18, 1860.

Richard Montgomery was a native of the North of Ireland. He entered the British army at the age of twenty, and served with distinction under Wolfe, and later in the campaign against the Spanish West Indies. Marrying a daughter of Robert R. Livingston, and settling upon the Hudson, at Rhinebeck, he espoused the cause of the colonists at the opening of the war. In the expedition against Canada he was second in command under Schuyler, with the rank of brigadier-general. The attack upon Quebec was made early in the morning of the 31st of December, 1775. Montgomery's death was regarded as a great public calamity. Congress passed resolutions of regret and condolence, and Chatham and Burke eulogized the dead leader on the floor of the British Parliament. At the time of his death he was thirty-eight years of age.

Stanza 6. Wolfe (James), the "hero of Louisburg" and the conqueror of Quebec, fell upon the Plains of Abraham in his thirty-second year. He is to this day regarded as one of the half dozen most noted generals that England has produced. Quebec was taken on the 13th of September, 1759.

5. THE MARYLAND BATTALION. By John Williamson Palmer.

John Williamson Palmer, a Baltimore physician, the author of the famous lyric, "Stonewall Jackson's Way," and Bret Harte's forerunner in

“breaking the virgin soil of California in the field of American letters,” was born in the city of Baltimore, April 4, 1825.

This ballad celebrates the heroism of the “Maryland Battalion” at the battle of Long Island, August 27, 1776, where they checked the advance of Cornwallis, and saved a portion of Stirling’s command from capture. Two hundred and fifty-nine were left dead on the field.

Stanza 2. It was in the Flatbush district, on the American left, that General Sullivan was driven back by the Hessians and flanked by Clinton’s light infantry and dragoons.

Martense’s lane was a “pass,” or road, on the southern border of Greenwood Cemetery. Freeke’s Mill (stanza 4) stood upon Freeke’s mill-pond at the head of Gowanus Creek.

Stanza 4. Grant, the British general who commanded the left wing in the battle of Long Island. It was he who declared in the House of Commons that the Americans could not fight, and said he would undertake to march from one end of the continent to the other with five thousand men.

Stanza 5. Stirling (William Alexander), commonly called Lord Stirling, was the eldest son of James Alexander Stirling, heir presumptive to the earldom of Stirling, who fled to America in 1716 after having been actively involved in the Jacobite conspiracy of the previous year. Lord Stirling was born in New York City in 1726. He was aide-de-camp and secretary to General Shirley in the French and Indian War, and received a commission as brigadier-general in the Continental army in 1776. After the battle of Long Island, Congress made him a major-general. He died at Albany in January, 1783.

Mordecai Gist was a major in the “Maryland Battalion” who subsequently rose to the rank of brigadier-general. He was a native of Baltimore.

6. ARNOLD AT STILLWATER. By Thomas Dunn English.

Thomas Dunn English, a physician of Newark, New Jersey, was born in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, June 29, 1819. Since early life Dr. English has been a contributor to the periodicals of the day. His popular ballad, “Ben Bolt,” appeared in 1842.

Benedict Arnold was born in Norwich, Connecticut, January 3, 1740. He was in command of a volunteer company at the outbreak of the Revolution, and marched at once to Cambridge. He served with great bravery on Lake Champlain, in Canada, and at Stillwater. After his treason he received a brigadier-general's commission in the British army. At the close of the war he went to England, where he resided most of the time until his death, June 14, 1801. The second battle of Stillwater (sometimes called Bemis's Heights and sometimes Saratoga) was fought October 7, 1777. Of Arnold's part in this battle George William Curtis says, in his Centennial Oration: "The British, dismayed, bewildered, overwhelmed, were scarcely within their redoubts, when Benedict Arnold, to whom the jealous Gates, who did not come upon the field during the day, had refused a command, outriding an aide whom Gates had sent to recall him, came spurring up: Benedict Arnold—whose name America does not love,—whose ruthless will had dragged the doomed Canadian expedition through the starving wilderness of Maine, who, volunteering to relieve Fort Stanwix, had, by the mere terror of his coming, blown St. Leger away, and who on the 19th of September had saved the American left. Benedict Arnold, whom battle stung to fury, now whirled from end to end of the American line, hurled it against the great redoubt, driving the enemy at the point of the bayonet; then flinging himself to the extreme right, and finding there the Massachusetts brigade, swept it with him to the assault, and streaming over the breastworks, scattered the Brunswickers who defended them, killed their colonel, gained and held the point which commanded the entire British position, while at the same moment his horse was shot under him, and he sank to the ground wounded in the leg that had been wounded at Quebec. Here, upon the Hudson, where he tried to betray his country; here, upon the spot where, in the crucial hour of the Revolution, he illustrated and led the American valor that made us free and great, knowing well that no earlier service can condone for a later crime, let us recall for one brief instant of infinite pity the name that has been justly execrated for a century."

Horatio Gates, who commanded the American forces at the battle of Stillwater, was an Englishman by birth, and had served under Braddock. He was made adjutant-general at the opening of the Revolution, and accompanied Washington to Cambridge when "the great Virginian" went thither to take charge of the army. Just before the battle of Stillwater Gates superseded General Schuyler in the command of the army of the north. He

suffered a disastrous defeat at Camden, when at the head of the southern forces. His patriotism was undoubted, but he lacked the judgment of a great commander.

Burgoyne (John, 1723-1792), who commanded the British forces at the battle of Stillwater, had distinguished himself in Portugal, and had also been a member of the British Parliament before coming to America. Much was expected of his expedition. It was intended to cut the colonies in twain, and thus crush the rebellion. Burgoyne was at one time commander-in-chief in Ireland. During the closing years of his life he devoted himself to literature.

Stanza 5. Poor (Enoch), a New Hampshire brigadier-general who served with distinction in the Continental army until 1780, when he died at Hackensack, New Jersey.

Learned (Ebenezer), a Massachusetts brigadier-general who had served in the French and Indian War.

Stanza 6. Cilley (Joseph), a New Hampshire colonel who was later in the commands of General Wayne and General Sullivan.

Stanza 7. Major Ackland, of the Grenadier corps, a most gallant British officer, was shot through both legs in this battle. He recovered, but after his return to England he was slain in a duel into which he was drawn through his defence of the bravery of the Americans.

Stanza 12. Armstrong (John), a Pennsylvania major, at first attached to the staff of General Hugh Mercer, and later to that of General Gates, with whom he remained until the close of the war.

Stanza 16. Brooks (John), a Massachusetts colonel who afterward became adjutant-general.

Wesson (James), a Massachusetts colonel who commanded a regiment in Learned's brigade.

Livingston (James), a New York colonel who commanded a regiment in Learned's brigade.

Morgan (Daniel), a native of New Jersey whose family removed to Virginia while he was yet young. He served with much distinction throughout the Revolution, and rose to the rank of major-general.

7. THE YANKEE MAN-OF-WAR. Anonymous.

Of this spirited ballad Alfred M. Williams, in his "Studies in Folk Song and Popular Poetry," says: "To this period, however [the Revolution],

belongs what is perhaps the very best of American sea-songs. We do not know whether its authorship was of that time or not, although it probably was, and from internal evidence it would seem to have been composed by one of the very crew of the *Ranger*, Paul Jones's ship, which escaped from a British squadron in the Irish Channel in 1778. It was first published, in 1883, by Commodore Luce, in his collection of 'Naval Songs,' with the statement that it was taken down from the recitation of a sailor." To this fact is doubtless due the very evident break in the form of the fifth stanza. Most of the places mentioned in the poem (save Dunmore, a promontory on the southwestern coast) are situated on the southeastern coast of Ireland.

The spirit of the piece, the frequent recurrence of technical expressions, together with the swinging measure, remind one (albeit somewhat remotely) of the work of the foremost balladist of our day,—Rudyard Kipling.

8. THE RIDE OF JENNIE M'NEAL. By Will Carleton.

Will Carleton was born in Hudson, Michigan, October 21, 1845. He is best known by his domestic ballads, "Over the Hill to the Poorhouse" and "Betsey and I Are Out."

The "Neutral Ground" of the poem—Westchester County, New York—was so called because it was held neither by the British nor the American armies during the Revolutionary War. This locality is the scene of some of the most stirring passages in Cooper's *Spy*.

Last stanza. Putnam. See "Mary Butler's Ride."

9. THE SONG OF MARION'S MEN. By William Cullen Bryant.

William Cullen Bryant, "the father of American song," was born in Cummington, Massachusetts, November 3, 1794. For fifty years he was the editor of the New York *Evening Post*. He died in New York City, June 12, 1878. In "Thanatopsis" and "To a Waterfowl" his genius finds its highest expression.

Francis Marion, one of the most noted partisan leaders of the Revolution, was born near Georgetown, South Carolina, in 1732. He was of Huguenot ancestry. He took part in the Cherokee war of 1761, and rendered conspicuous service throughout the struggle of the colonies for independence, particularly during the last two years. It is said that the

brilliant British cavalry leader, Colonel Tarleton, first gave him the name of “swamp-fox.” He died at his plantation near Eutaw, South Carolina, in February, 1795.

10. HOW WE BURNED THE “PHILADELPHIA.” By Barrett Eastman.

Barrett Eastman, a Chicago journalist, was born in Chicago, January 25, 1869.

“The destruction of the *Philadelphia*, which Lord Nelson, then commanding the British blockading fleet off Toulon, called ‘the most bold and daring act of the age,’ was effected on the night of February 9, 1804. In the party, numbering but seventy-five officers and men all told, were Stephen Decatur, Jr., James Lawrence, Joseph Bainbridge, Thomas Macdonough, and many others who rose to distinction.”—B. E.

Stephen Decatur, who commanded the expedition against the *Philadelphia*, was of French descent, and was born in Sinnepuxent, Maryland, January 5, 1779. He first saw service against the French, was active in the war of 1812, and chastised the Algerines in 1815. He was killed in a duel by Commodore James Barron on March 22, 1820.

11. THE “SHANNON” AND THE “CHESAPEAKE.” By Thomas Tracy Bouvé.

Thomas Tracy Bouvé was born in Hingham, Massachusetts, June 23, 1875. He is the author of several other stirring ballads.

Lawrence (James), was born in Burlington, New Jersey, October 1, 1781. He was prominent in Decatur’s expedition to destroy the *Philadelphia*. He commanded the *Hornet*, which sank the brig-of-war *Peacock*, a victory which led to his being appointed to the *Chesapeake*. It was from Boston harbor that he sailed to meet the *Shannon*, June 1, 1813. He died at sea five days later.

Stanza 5. Hingham, a town of Plymouth County, Massachusetts, fourteen miles southeast of Boston, on Massachusetts Bay.

Stanza 10. Broke (Philip Bowes Vere), the captain of the *Shannon*, who was knighted for his victory over the *Chesapeake*, and became a popular hero in England.

12. THE FIGHT OF THE “ARMSTRONG” PRIVATEER. By James Jeffrey Roche.

James Jeffrey Roche, a journalist and ballad writer of much vigor, was born in Queens County, Ireland, May 31, 1847. His early life was spent on Prince Edward Island. He removed to Boston in 1866, and on the death of John Boyle O'Reilly succeeded him as editor of the *Pilot*.

The memorable "Fight of the *Armstrong Privateer*" took place September 26 and 27, 1814. The British lost one hundred and twenty men killed and one hundred and eighty wounded, while the Americans had but two killed and seven wounded.

Samuel Chester Reid, who commanded the *Armstrong*, was the son of a lieutenant in the British navy. He was at one time harbor-master and warden of the port of New York, and was the designer of the present form of the United States flag, proposing to retain the original thirteen stripes and add a new star whenever a new State was admitted to the Union.

I. 10. Nelson (Horatio), England's most noted naval commander, the hero of Copenhagen, Aboukir Bay, Egypt, where he destroyed the French fleet, and of Trafalgar, where he was victorious over the combined fleets of France and Spain, and where he met his death, October 21, 1805.

I. 12. Dundonald (Thomas Cochrane, Earl of Dundonald, 1749-1831), a distinguished Scottish seaman.

I. 31. Dartmoor, an English prison in Devonshire. It was built in 1806, during the Napoleonic wars, for the retention of prisoners. Seven Americans were killed here, and sixty wounded, on April 16, 1815, a brutal and unprovoked act.

I. 40. Pico, one of the middle group of the Azores.

I. 42. Lloyd (Captain Robert), of the *Plantagenet*, the commander of the English fleet.

13. THE MEN OF THE ALAMO. By James Jeffrey Roche.

James Jeffrey Roche. See note on "The Fight of the *Armstrong Privateer*."

The Alamo was a Spanish Mission at San Antonio, founded early in the 18th century. Later it was transformed into a fortress. In addition to the church, with adjacent buildings used as quarters for the soldiers and for the magazine, there was a rectangular space about one hundred and fifty yards long and fifty yards wide protected by a stone wall from six to eight feet in

height and nearly three feet in thickness. This enclosure was defended by fourteen or more cannon. The storming of the Alamo took place on the morning of the 6th of March, 1836. There were 188 Texans defending the place, while the Mexican force numbered from 2500 to 5000. Three women, a child, and a negro servant survived the fight. The statement in the last line of the poem refers to the defenders.

I. 1. Houston (Samuel, 1793-1863), a Virginian by birth, the commander-in-chief of the army of the Texas republic. He was the second president (first by regular election) of the Republic of Texas, and afterward United States senator and the governor of the State.

I. 4. Nueces, a river of southern Texas emptying into Corpus Christi Bay.

I. 5. Castrillon, a Mexican general (a Spaniard by birth) who was killed at San Jacinto, where he had command of the artillery. It was he who had charge of the assault on the Alamo.

Cos (Martin Perfecto de), a Mexican general, and brother-in-law of Santa Anna. He was in command at San Antonio when the place was surrendered to the Texans in December, 1835. He was released upon parole under the promise that he would not oppose the re-establishment of the Federal Constitution of 1824. He returned with Santa Anna the following year, and participated in the attack upon the Alamo, hence the epithet "perjured."

Sesma (Ramirez y), a Mexican general.

Almonte (Juan Nepomuceno), the son of a Mexican priest and patriot. He was a colonel in the Mexican army, and Santa Anna's secretary. He at one time served as the Mexican minister to the United States. He was an upholder of Maximilian and served in his cabinet. When that ill-fated prince fell, Almonte escaped to France, where he died two or three years later.

I. 6. Santa Anna (Antonio Lopez de, 1795-1876), several times president of Mexico, and when not in power usually a conspirator against the head of the government. He was in command of the Mexican army in the war against the Texans, and again in the war with the United States. He served under Maximilian, and against him. No less than six times he was exiled, or fled the country.

I. 13. Travis (William Barrett, 1811-1836), the colonel who commanded at the defence of the Alamo, by birth an Alabamian. He practiced law in his native State in his early manhood, but emigrated to Texas in 1832, and there

became interested in the cause of independence. He was of fine stature, and noted for his intrepidity.

I. 16. Bowie (James, 1790-1836), a Georgian who gained notoriety on account of his part in a bloody mêlée which followed a duel fought opposite Natchez, on the Mississippi, in August, 1827. It is said that it was in this encounter that the famous knife which afterward bore Bowie's name was first used. The original weapon was made from a blacksmith's broken rasp or file. Bowie emigrated from Louisiana, where he was living at the time of the duel, to Texas, and was active in the Texan struggle till his death.

I. 17. Evans (Robert), a Texan major of artillery who was shot when on the point of firing a train to blow up the magazine of the Alamo at Travis's order.

I. 29. Crockett (David, familiarly known as "Davy," 1786-1836). This noted frontiersman was a Tennessean. He was prominent in the Creek war, and after a wild life as a scout and hunter became a member of the State legislature, and then of Congress. His waning influence with his constituents, owing to the fact that he opposed Jackson, caused him to join the Texans in their struggle for liberty.

I. 54. San Jacinto. See note on following poem.

I. 57. Thermopylæ, the pass from Thessaly into Locris where Leonidas and his three hundred Spartans fell, B.C. 480.

[14.](#) THE FIGHT AT THE SAN JACINTO. By John Williamson Palmer.

John Williamson Palmer. See note on "The Maryland Battalion."

The San Jacinto is a river in southern Texas which joins Buffalo Bayou very near where that stream empties into Galveston Bay. The battle by which the Texans gained their independence took place on the 21st of April, 1836. The Texan army numbered exactly seven hundred and eighty-three men, while the Mexicans had more than double that force.

Stanza 1. Harman (Clark M.), a member of the Texan artillery corps.

Stanza 2. For **Santa Anna**, **Castrillon**, **Almontê** and **Cos**, see "The Men of the Alamo."

Portilla (J. N. de la), the Mexican colonel, a native of Yucatan, in command at Goliad, who carried out Santa Anna's infamous order, and executed Colonel Fannin and his men. See Fannin, p. 205.

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow. See note on “Paul Revere.”

The battle of Hampton Roads, Virginia, during which the *Cumberland* was sunk by the Confederate ram *Merrimac*, was fought March 9, 1862. Morris (George Upham, 1830-1875), who was temporarily commanding the *Cumberland*, entered the navy early in life as a midshipman, and served until the year before his death. He took part in a number of engagements during the Rebellion, and was wounded at Fort Darling. An incident of the *Cumberland-Merrimac* battle is described by George H. Boker (see “The Black Regiment”) in a poem entitled

THE SWORD-BEARER

Brave Morris saw the day was lost:
For nothing now remained
Of the wrecked and sinking *Cumberland*
But to save the flag unstained.

So he swore an oath in the sight of heaven—
(If he kept it the world can tell!)
“Before I strike to a rebel flag,
I’ll sink to the gates of hell!

“Here, take my sword; ’tis in my way;
I shall trip o’er the useless steel;
For I’ll meet the lot that falls to all,
With my shoulder at the wheel,”

So the little negro took the sword,
And oh, with what reverent care!
Following his master step by step,
He bore it here and there.

A thought had crept through his sluggish brain,
And shone in his dusky face,
That somehow—he could not tell just how—
’Twas the sword of his trampled race.

And as Morris, great with his lion heart,
Rushed onward from gun to gun,
The little negro slid after him
Like a shadow in the sun.

But something of pomp and of curious pride
The sable creature wore,
Which at any time but a time like that
Would have made the ship’s crew roar.

Over the wounded, dying, and dead,
Like an usher of the rod,
The black nagg full of his mighty trust

The black page, full of his mighty trust,
With dainty caution trod.

No heed he gave to the flying ball,
No heed to the bursting shell;
His duty was something more than life,
And he strove to do it well.

Down with our starry flag apeak,
In the whirling sea we sank;
And captain and crew and the sword-bearer
Were washed from the bloody plank.

They picked us up from the hungry waves—
Alas, not all! And where,
Where is the faithful negro lad?
“Back oars! avast! look there!”

We looked, and as heaven may save my soul,
I pledge you a sailor’s word,
There, fathoms deep in the sea he lay,
Still grasping his master’s sword.

We drew him out; and many an hour
We wrought with his rigid form
Ere the almost smothered spark of life
By slow degrees grew warm.

The first dull glance that his eyeballs rolled
Was down toward his shrunken hand;
And he smiled, and closed his eyes again,
As they fell on the rescued brand.

And no one touched the sacred sword,
Till at length, when Morris came,
The little negro stretched it out
With his eager eyes aflame.

And if Morris wrung the poor boy’s hand,

And his words seemed hard to speak,
And tears ran down his manly cheeks,
What tongue shall call him weak?

22. JOHNSTON AT SHILOH. By Fleming James.

Albert Sydney Johnston, who commanded the Confederate forces at the battle of Shiloh, was a Kentuckian by birth (1803), and was one of the most able of the Southern leaders. He had had a wide experience in military affairs, being a West Point graduate, and having served in Mexico and upon the plains. The battle of Shiloh was fought on the 6th of April, 1862.

23. THE RIVER FIGHT. By Henry Howard Brownell.

Henry Howard Brownell, called “the laureate of the Civil War,” was born in Providence, Rhode Island, February 6, 1820. His early manhood was devoted to literary work. He served on the *Hartford* under Farragut during a part of the Rebellion, and at the close of the war accompanied that officer upon a cruise to various European ports. He died in Hartford, Connecticut, October 31, 1872. Thomas Bailey Aldrich has paid a beautiful tribute to his memory in a sonnet beginning—

“They never crowned him, never knew his worth,
But let him go unlaureled to the grave.”

The conflict commemorated in this poem, resulting in the opening of the lower Mississippi, took place on the 24th of April, 1862. The introductory portion of the poem is omitted, and a few additional stanzas that retard, rather than accelerate, the forward movement.

Stanza 1. “Up the River of Death
Sailed the great Admiral.”

David Glasgow Farragut, generally conceded to be the greatest American seaman, was born near Knoxville, Tennessee, July 5, 1801. His most famous victories were those of the “River Fight” and of Mobile Bay, which Brownell celebrated in a poem entitled “The Bay Fight,” perhaps his best-known effort, the length of which precludes its use in this volume. (See

poem, "Farragut," by William T. Meredith). He died in Portsmouth, New Hampshire, August 14, 1870.

Stanza 4. Porter (David Dixon, 1813-1891), the naval officer who succeeded Farragut as vice-admiral and admiral. He had command of the mortar flotilla in the "River Fight."

Last Stanza. The church-pennant is made of white bunting in the form of an isosceles triangle, on each side of which is sewed blue bunting in shape of a cross resting horizontally on the white. This pennant is used only when religious service is being held, and is then hoisted above the national ensign.

24. KEARNY AT SEVEN PINES. By Edmund Clarence Stedman.

Edmund Clarence Stedman, our most distinguished critic, and one of the three most distinguished of our living poets (the others being Richard Henry Stoddard and Thomas Bailey Aldrich), was born in Hartford, Connecticut, October 8, 1833. He entered journalism after leaving college, and was a war correspondent during the early years of the Civil War. Later he purchased a seat in the New York stock exchange, and became a broker, devoting his leisure to literature. He has for many years been one of the most prominent figures in literary New York.

The battle of Seven Pines was fought on the 31st of May, 1862.

Philip Kearny was born in New York City, June 2, 1815. Entering the army in 1837, he was sent to Europe two years later to observe the tactics of the French cavalry. Enlisting in the French service, he performed many daring exploits in Algiers. He was in the Mexican War, and was the first American to enter the city of Mexico. He won the cross of the Legion of Honor in the Franco-Austrian war of 1859, and his service to the Union cause in the Rebellion before his death was conspicuous. General Scott once referred to him as the bravest and most perfect soldier he ever knew. The battle of Chantilly, where General Kearny lost his life, took place September 1, 1862. The general became separated from his men in the dusk and driving rain, and rode by mistake into the Confederate line. Encountering some skirmishers, he perceived his blunder, wheeled his horse, and endeavored to escape, but a volley rang out and he fell. It was in Kearny's memory that George H. Boker wrote his most tender lyric:

DIRGE FOR A SOLDIER

Close his eyes; his work is done!
What to him is friend or foeman,
Rise of moon, or set of sun,
Hand of man, or kiss of woman?
Lay him low, lay him low,
In the clover or the snow!
What cares he? he cannot know:
Lay him low!

As man may, he fought his fight,
Proved his truth by his endeavor;
Let him sleep in solemn night,
Sleep forever and forever.
Lay him low, lay him low
In the clover or the snow!
What cares he? he cannot know:
Lay him low!

Fold him in his country's stars,
Roll the drum and fire the volley;
What to him are all our wars,
What but Death bemocking Folly?
Lay him low, lay him low,
In the clover or the snow!
What cares he? he cannot know:
Lay him low!

Leave him to God's watching eye,
Trust him to the hand that made him.
Mortal love weeps idly by:
God alone has power to aid him.
Lay him low, lay him low,
In the clover or the snow!
What cares he? he cannot know:
Lay him low!

Stanza 1. Jameson (Charles Davis), a brigadier-general of volunteers who died in the service.

Berry (Hiram George), a major-general of volunteers, killed in the battle of Chancellorsville. See “Keenan’s Charge.”

Birney (David Bell), a major-general of volunteers, who succeeded General Berry after the fall of the latter at Chancellorsville. He died in the service.

25. AN UNKNOWN HERO. By William Gordon McCabe.

William Gordon McCabe was born in Richmond, Virginia, August 4, 1841. He served in various capacities in the Confederate army throughout the Civil War, since the close of which he has been active as an educator and as a writer upon educational and general topics.

“After the battle of Malvern Hill, Virginia (July 1, 1862), a soldier was found dead fifty yards in advance of any officer or man, his musket firmly grasped in his rigid fingers,—name unknown,—simply ‘2 La.’ (Second Louisiana) on his cap.” Malvern Hill lies near the James River, about fifteen miles southeast of Richmond.

26. BARBARA FRIETCHIE. By John Greenleaf Whittier.

John Greenleaf Whittier, “the Quaker laureate of Puritan New England,” and by some considered the most distinctively American poet, was born in Haverhill, Massachusetts, December 17, 1807. Whittier was prominent among the anti-slavery agitators, and during his early manhood gave much of his time and strength to the interests of the cause. He took up his permanent residence at Amesbury, Massachusetts, in 1840, and lived there, and at “Oak Knoll,” in Danvers, during the remainder of his life. “Of all our poets,” says Mr. Stedman, “he is the most natural balladist.” He is seen at his best in such ballads as “Cassandra Southwick,” “Mary Garvin,” and “The Wreck of Rivermouth,” and in the New England pastoral, “Snowbound.” He died at Hampton Falls, New Hampshire, September 7, 1892.

It was during the march of “Stonewall” Jackson’s command through Frederick City, Maryland, just before the battle of South Mountain, in September, 1862, that the incidents which inspired this poem are said to have occurred. Their truth having been questioned, Mr. Francis F. Browne

appealed to Mr. Whittier, and in November, 1885, received from the poet the subjoined statement:—"Of the substantial truth of the heroism of Barbara Frietchie I can have no doubt. Mrs. E. D. E. N. Southworth, the novelist, of Washington, sent me a slip from a newspaper stating the circumstance as it is given in the poem, and assured me of its substantial correctness. Dorothea L. Dix, the philanthropic worker in Union hospitals, confirmed it. From half a dozen other sources I had the account, and all agree in the main facts. Barbara Frietchie was the boldest and most outspoken Unionist in Frederick, and manifested it to the rebel army in an unmistakable manner." In spite of Mr. Whittier's belief in the truth of the incident, its authenticity has been seriously questioned in later years.

"Stonewall" Jackson (Thomas Jonathan), one of the most brilliant generals on either side in the Civil War, was born in Clarksburg, West Virginia, January 21, 1824. He graduated at West Point, and was twice breveted in the war with Mexico. At the beginning of the Rebellion he took command of the Confederate troops at Harper's Ferry. He commanded a brigade at the battle of Bull Run, where he gained the sobriquet "Stonewall" on account of the firm stand he made. After a series of brilliant victories, he was mortally wounded by some of his own men when returning from a reconnaissance after the battle of Chancellorsville. He died on the 10th of May, 1863.

Line 10. Lee, Robert Edward, the Commander-in-chief of the Confederate forces during the Civil War, was born at Stratford House in Virginia, the home of the Lees, on January 19, 1807. Like Jackson he was a West Point graduate, and like him served with distinguished bravery in the war with Mexico. At the close of the Rebellion, he was chosen president of Washington College, at Lexington, Virginia. His death occurred on October 12, 1870.

[27.](#) THE EAGLE OF CORINTH. By Henry Howard Brownell.

Henry Howard Brownell. See note on "The River Fight."

The battle of Corinth was fought October 3d and 4th, 1862. The famous war-eagle of the poem was taken from a nest in Chippeway County, Wisconsin, by a Chippeway Indian, in July, 1861, and given by him to a farmer living near. A citizen of Eau Claire purchased the bird, and presented him to Company C, of the Eighth Wisconsin, with which he remained until

the regiment was mustered out of active service. He was present at all of the battles in which the troops were engaged, and would fly over the enemy during the hottest of the fight, returning after a time to his perch upon a pole borne by one especially appointed for that duty. Whenever there was any cheering his wings were instantly outspread. At the battle of Corinth, the rebel general Price gave orders to capture or kill the eagle, saying that he was worth more than the whole brigade. The name by which the bird was universally known, "Old Abe," was given him by Captain Wolf, of Company C, of the Eighth Wisconsin.

Stanza 1. Price (Stirling, 1809-1867), a Virginian who served the Confederate cause in the West and Southwest throughout the Civil War.

Van Dorn (Earl, 1820-1863), a Mississippian who rose to the rank of major-general in the Confederate service. He was shot and killed by a physician named Peters on account of some private grievance.

Stanza 5. Robinett, a fort erected by the Federal forces at Corinth.

28. **READY.** By Phœbe Cary.

Phœbe Cary, the younger of the Cary sisters, was born near Cincinnati, Ohio, September 4, 1824, and died in Newport, Rhode Island, July 31, 1873. Her best-known lyric is entitled "Nearer Home."

The incident described in this poem probably occurred some time during the first week in April, 1863, when there were several actions at Rodman's Point. This point is a strip of land projecting into the Pimlico River about a mile and a half below Washington, North Carolina.

29. **THE BATTLE OF CHARLESTON HARBOR.** By Paul Hamilton Hayne.

Paul Hamilton Hayne, a nephew of the noted Senator Hayne, of South Carolina, was born in Charleston, January 1, 1830. Most of his life was devoted to literature, his best work being lyrics descriptive of Southern scenery. He died at Copse Hill, Georgia, July 6, 1886.

The attack by the Union fleet upon the defenses of Charleston harbor occurred April 7, 1863.

The fort referred to in the fifth stanza is Moultrie.

30. **KEENAN'S CHARGE.** By George Parsons Lathrop.

George Parsons Lathrop, perhaps best known as a novelist, was born in Honolulu, Sandwich Islands, August 25, 1851, and died in New York City, April 19, 1898.

During the second day of the battle of Chancellorsville, May 2, 1863, General Pleasanton was endeavoring to get twenty-two guns into a vital position as “Stonewall” Jackson made a sudden advance. Every instant’s delay was precious, at whatever cost it was purchased, so Pleasanton ordered Major Keenan, commanding the Eighth Pennsylvania Cavalry (four hundred strong), to charge the advancing ten thousand of the enemy.

General Alfred Pleasanton was born in Washington, D. C., June 7, 1824. He was a West Point graduate, and served in the Mexican War and in several Indian wars. He was the commander of the Union cavalry at the battle of Gettysburg.

Major Peter Keenan was born in York, New York, November 9, 1834. He was a resident of Philadelphia when the Civil War broke out, and assisted in recruiting the Eighth Pennsylvania Cavalry, in which he was made a captain. Having attained the rank of major, he was in command of his regiment at the battle of Chancellorsville, as above stated.

Stanza 1. “ ‘Stonewall’s’ Corps.” See “Barbara Frietchie.”

[31.](#) THE HERO OF THE GUN. By Margaret Junkin Preston.

Margaret Junkin Preston, a poet and prose writer who, though a native of the North (born in Philadelphia, in 1825), has always been identified with the South. She wrote many fine ballads. She died in Baltimore, Maryland, March 28, 1897.

An incident of the Civil War which, though probably true, the son of the author is not able to identify.

[32.](#) AN INCIDENT OF WAR. By Maurice Thompson.

Maurice Thompson, poet, novelist, and journalist (brother of Will Henry Thompson,—see “High Tide at Gettysburg” and “The Bond of Blood”), was born in Fairfield, Indiana, September 9, 1844. His boyhood was passed in Kentucky and Georgia, and he served in the Confederate army throughout the Civil War, later engaging in the practice of law at Crawfordsville, Indiana, his present home. He was at one time the state

geologist of Indiana. Mr. Thompson is a nature-intimate, and his lyrics of “wild life” have a rare freshness and charm.

Of “An Incident of War” the author says: “The poem has no exact model of fact; I got it out of my composite impression of war as I experienced it.”

33. THE BLACK REGIMENT. By George Henry Boker.

George Henry Boker, poet and diplomat, and perhaps best known as the author of the play, “Francesca da Rimini,” was born in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, October 6, 1823. He was successively United States Minister to Russia and Turkey. He died in Philadelphia, January 2, 1890.

“The Black Regiment” commemorates the charge of the First and Third Louisiana Native Guards at Port Hudson, May 27, 1863. Of the bearing of the negro soldiers in that action General Banks spoke in the highest terms in reporting to General Halleck. “Their conduct,” he wrote, “was heroic. No troops could be more determined or more daring. They made, during the day, three charges upon the batteries of the enemy, suffering very heavy losses, and holding their position at nightfall with the other troops on the right of our line. The highest commendation is bestowed upon them by all the officers in command on the right.”

In her “Camp-Fire and Memorial Poems,” Mrs. Kate Brownlee Sherwood (see note on “Thomas at Chickamauga”) has paid an eloquent tribute to the valor of the “Black Regiment.”

34. GREENCASTLE JENNY. By Helen Gray Cone.

Helen Gray Cone, one of the most gifted of our women poets of to-day, was born in New York City, March 8, 1859. She is a member of the faculty of the Normal College of New York City.

The story of “Greencastle Jenny” was told by Colonel William R. Aylett, who succeeded General Armistead (see “High Tide at Gettysburg”) as commander of his brigade, at a reunion of the Blue and Grey at Gettysburg, in 1887. Miss Cone believes that the girl’s name is not known.

Greencastle is a small town in Franklin county, Pennsylvania, not far from the Maryland line.

Stanza 1. Longstreet (James, 1821-), a prominent Confederate general, by some considered the hardest fighter in the rebel service. He served in

Mexico, and was active all through the Rebellion. At Gettysburg it is said he endeavored to dissuade Lee from ordering Pickett's famous charge.

Stanza 3. Pickett (George Edward, 1825-1875), one of the most gallant Confederate generals. His charge at Gettysburg is historic, and was "the most brilliant feat of arms performed by the Confederates on any field."

35. JOHN BURNS OF GETTYSBURG. By (Francis) Bret Harte.

(Francis) Bret Harte was born in Albany, New York, August 25, 1839. The years of his early manhood were passed in California. It was in San Francisco, while he was the editor of the *Overland Monthly* that the publication of "The Luck of Roaring Camp" and "The Heathen Chine" established his reputation. He has been United States Consul at Crefeld, Germany, and at Glasgow, Scotland. He resigned the latter post in 1885, since when he has resided in and near London.

The following statement, made by a Union officer who served in the Eleventh Corps at the battle of Gettysburg, is taken from Mr. Francis F. Browne's "Bugle Echoes":—"During the first day's fight an old man, in a swallow-tailed coat and battered cylinder hat, came stalking across the fields from the town, and made his appearance at Colonel Stone's position. With a musket in his hand, and ammunition in his pocket, this venerable citizen asked Colonel Wister's permission to fight. Wister directed him to go over to the Iron Brigade, where he would be sheltered by the woods; but the old man insisted on going forward to the skirmish line. He was allowed to do so, and continued firing until the skirmishers retired, when he was the last man to leave. He afterward fought with the Iron Brigade, where he was three times wounded. This patriotic and heroic citizen was Constable John Burns, of Gettysburg."

The battle of Gettysburg was fought July 1, 2, and 3, 1863.

Line 11. Lee. See "Barbara Frietchie."

l. 14. Meade (George Gordon, 1815-1872), the commander of the Union army at Gettysburg. He served in the Mexican and Seminole Wars, and distinguished himself at Antietam and Fredericksburg. He was at the head of various military departments after the war.

l. 100. Navarre. See Macaulay's ballad, "Ivry."

36. HIGH TIDE AT GETTYSBURG. By Will Henry Thompson.

Will Henry Thompson (brother of Maurice Thompson; see “An Incident of War,” and “The Ballad of a Little Fun”), a lawyer and poet residing in Seattle, Washington, was born in Calhoun county, Georgia, March 10, 1848. Mr. Thompson was a Confederate soldier, and his “High Tide at Gettysburg” is one of the finest poems inspired by the Civil War.

“High Tide at Gettysburg,” the day of Pickett’s charge, was the last day of that memorable battle, July 3, 1863.

Stanza 2. Lee. See “Barbara Frietchie.”

Pickett. See “Greencastle Jenny.”

Stanza 3. Shiloh. See “Johnston at Shiloh.”

Chickamauga. See “Thomas at Chickamauga.”

Stanza 4. Pettigrew, (James Johnson) a Confederate brigadier-general who was mortally wounded in Pickett’s charge. He was a native of North Carolina (1828-1863).

Waterloo. June 18, 1815.

Stanza 5. Kemper (James Lamson, 1823-), a Confederate brigadier-general, severely wounded and captured at Gettysburg. He has been governor of Virginia.

Garnett (Richard Brooke, 1819-1863), a Confederate brigadier-general who fell at Gettysburg.

Armistead (Lewis Addison, 1817-1863), a Confederate brigadier-general in Pickett’s division, who was mortally wounded in the famous charge.

Stanza 7. Doubleday (Abner, 1819-1893), a Federal major-general of volunteers, whose division was active in repulsing Pickett’s charge. It was he who fired the first gun in defense of Fort Sumter.

For another rendering of this battle in verse see Edmund Clarence Stedman’s “Gettysburg” (Complete Poems.).

[37.](#) THOMAS AT CHICKAMAUGA. By Kate Brownlee Sherwood.

Kate Brownlee Sherwood, a poet and journalist of Toledo, Ohio, who has written a number of successful war lyrics and memorial poems, was born in Bedford Springs, Pennsylvania, September 14, 1841.

The battle of Chickamauga (Tennessee) was fought on the 19th and 20th of September, 1863. General George Henry Thomas, “the rock of Chickamauga,” who saved the day for the Federal forces, and made the Confederate victory a barren one, was a Virginian by birth (1816). He served in Florida and Mexico. It was he who was in command at Mission Ridge, and who overthrew the last Confederate army in the southwest. He was also in the Atlanta campaign. It has been said of him that he was the beau-ideal of a soldier and a gentleman. Among Federal generals he ranks after Grant, Sherman, and Sheridan. He was in command of the military division of the Pacific when he died at San Francisco, March 28, 1870. The sobriquet “Pap” was spontaneously given Thomas by the soldiers of his command on account of the fatherly interest he took in them.

I. 5. Hooker (Joseph, 1814-1879), a distinguished Union general, who was nicknamed “Fighting Joe” by the soldiers for his courage under fire. He participated in some of the most important battles of the Rebellion, and was at one time in command of the Army of the Potomac.

I. 33. Bragg (Braxton, 1817-1876), a well-known rebel general who was in command of the Confederate forces at Murfreesboro, Chickamauga, and Chattanooga.

I. 42. Steedman (James Barrett, 1818-1883), a Pennsylvanian who was public printer at Washington during Buchanan’s administration. He was in command of the first division of the reserve corps of the Army of the Cumberland at Chickamauga, and reinforced Thomas at the most critical moment in the battle.

38. THE SMALLEST OF THE DRUMS. By James Buckham.

James Buckham, a well-known contributor to the periodicals of the day, was born in Burlington, Vermont, November 25, 1858.

The author states that this poem was suggested by a newspaper paragraph.

Stanza 3. Sherman (William Tecumseh), the eighteenth general-in-chief of the United States army, famous for his “march to the sea,” was born in Lancaster, Ohio, February 8, 1820. He was Grant’s most efficient assistant at Shiloh, Vicksburg, and Chattanooga. He visited Europe in 1872, and was everywhere received with distinguished honor. In 1874 he retired from the command of the army to make room for Sheridan. He died in New York

City, February 14, 1891. See “Sherman, an Horatian Ode,” by Louise Imogen Guiney (“A Roadside Harp”), and “General Sherman,” by H. C. Bunner (Complete Poems).

Stanza 4. Chickamauga. See “Thomas at Chickamauga.”

[39.](#) LITTLE GIFFEN. By Francis Orrery Ticknor.

Francis Orrery Ticknor, a physician, and the author of several lyrics of the Civil War very popular in the South, was a native of Georgia, and died near Columbus, in that State, in 1874. A posthumous volume of his poems was issued in 1879, with an introduction by Paul H. Hayne.

The hero of this poem was Isaac Giffen, a native of the mountainous region of East Tennessee. He had been terribly wounded at Murfreesboro, and was taken by Dr. Ticknor and his wife into their own home. He fell in one of the battles before Atlanta.

Stanza 5. “Johnson pressed at the front, they say.” Probably General Joseph Eggleston Johnston, is meant.

[40.](#) ULRIC DAHLGREN. By Kate Brownlee Sherwood.

Kate Brownlee Sherwood. See note on “Thomas at Chickamauga.”

Colonel Ulric Dahlgren, the son of Admiral Dahlgren, distinguished himself while serving upon the staffs of General Hooker, General Sigel, and General Meade, lost a leg at Gettysburg, and while on crutches led an expedition to free the Union prisoners in Libby prison at Richmond, during which he was ambushed and slain, on the night of March 2, 1864. He was twenty-two years of age.

[41.](#) FARRAGUT. By William Tuckey Meredith.

William Tuckey Meredith was born in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, June 16, 1839. He served with Farragut at the battle of Mobile Bay, and was afterward the admiral’s secretary. He subsequently became a banker in New York City.

The battle of Mobile Bay was fought August 5, 1864. See “Craven,” below.

Farragut. See note on “The River Fight.”

Stanza 2. Morgan, a Confederate fort.

42. LEE TO THE REAR. By John Randolph Thompson.

John Randolph Thompson, journalist and poet, was born in Richmond, Virginia, October 23, 1823. He abandoned the law to devote himself to literature, and for a dozen years successfully edited the *Southern Literary Messenger*. After the Civil War he was for a time literary editor of the *New York Evening Post*. He died in New York City, April 30, 1873.

The incident described in the poem is authentic. For LEE, See “Barbara Frietchie.”

Stanza 1. THE WILDERNESS is a region a few miles south of the Rapidan river, in Virginia, memorable for the dreadful battle fought there between the Federal army under Grant and the Confederate forces under Lee on the 5th and 6th of May, 1864.

Mendelssohn, the famous German composer, 1809-1847.

Stanza 4. Grant (Ulysses Simpson, 1822-1885), the eighteenth president of the United States, and the most distinguished Federal general in the War of the Rebellion. Grant’s most celebrated battles were Fort Donelson, Shiloh, Vicksburg, Chattanooga, and the conflicts in the Wilderness and before Richmond, which culminated in the surrender of Lee. See “Grant,” by H. C. Bunner (Complete Poems); “On the Death of an Invincible Soldier,” by E. C. Stedman (“Poems Now First Collected”); and “Great Captain, Glorious in Our Wars,” by Thomas Bailey Aldrich (Complete Poems).

43. CRAVEN. By Henry Newbolt.

Henry Newbolt, an English lawyer and poet, was born in Bilston, England, June 6, 1862. His best work is to be found in the volume entitled “Admirals All.”

Craven (Tunis Augustus Macdonough), the “Sidney of the American navy,” was born in Portsmouth, New Hampshire, in January, 1813. He entered the navy at sixteen, and was a commander at the opening of the Civil War. As captain of the monitor *Tecumseh*, which had been given the post of honor, and was leading the fleet, he met his death in Mobile Bay, August 5, 1864.

Stanza 8. Sidney (Sir Philip, poet, soldier, and statesman. 1554-1586.) The reference is to the well-known story of Sidney’s refusing a cup of

water, when lying mortally wounded on the battle-field of Zutphen, in order to give it to a wounded soldier.

Nelson. See “Fight of the *Armstrong* Privateer.” The reference here is to the battle of the Nile, where Nelson was severely wounded.

Lucas, a young English captain, who was captured and imprisoned by an Indian despot (Hyder Ali,) during the campaign of 1780. To relieve Captain Baird, a severely wounded comrade, he assumed two sets of chains, so that the wounded man might be left free.

Outram. (Sir James, 1803-1863.) The reference is to his action at Cawnpore, in 1857, when, though superior in command, in admiration for the brilliant deeds of General Havelock, he conceded to that soldier the glory of relieving Lucknow, waiving his own rank, and tendering his services as a volunteer.

44. GRACIE OF ALABAMA. By Francis Orrery Ticknor.

Francis Orrery Ticknor. See “Little Giffen.”

Petersburg, the scene of this incident, a city which witnessed some of the fiercest fighting of the Civil War, is situated upon the southern bank of the Appomattox River, about twenty miles south of Richmond.

The Gracie of the poem (Archibald,) was a Confederate brigadier-general who served with distinction at Knoxville and Chickamauga.

Stanza 3. LEE. See “Barbara Frietchie.”

45. THE BALLAD OF A LITTLE FUN. By Maurice Thompson.

Maurice Thompson. See note on “An Incident of War.”

Stanza 5. Salliquoy. A tributary of the Coosawattee. (See below.)

Stanza 6. Coosawattee. A stream that rises in Gilmer county, northern Georgia, and flows southwesterly through Gordon county, where it unites with the Canasauga to form the Oostanaula.

This poem relates an adventure that befell a Confederate scouting party near Hogan’s Ford, on the Coosawattee, while out upon a reconnoitering expedition late in 1864, or early in 1865.

46. SHERIDAN’S RIDE. By Thomas Buchanan Read.

Thomas Buchanan Read, poet and artist, was born in Chester county, Pennsylvania, March 12, 1822. After a roving youth, he settled in

Philadelphia, in which town and various Italian cities most of his life was spent. He died in New York City, May 11, 1872. The lyrics “Drifting” and “The Closing Scene “ show Read at his best as a poet.

Sheridan (Philip, generally known to army men as “Little Phil,” 1831-1888), was the most distinguished Federal cavalry leader in the Civil War. Serving in the early part of the war with the Army of the Cumberland, during the latter portion of the conflict he was with the Army of the Potomac, and rendered Grant important aid in crushing Lee. His own version of his famous ride (October 19, 1864,) may be read in his memoirs. It has been said of Sheridan that he was never defeated, but often plucked victory from the jaws of defeat.

Line 2. Winchester. The capital of Frederick county, Virginia, and the key to the Shenandoah valley.

[47.](#) DOWN THE LITTLE BIG HORN. By Francis Brooks.

Francis Brooks, a Chicago poet, who was born in Memphis, Tennessee, March 7, 1867, and died near Geneva, Wisconsin, April 12, 1898. A memorial edition of his poems, edited by Wallace Rice, was issued in the autumn of 1898.

Custer (George Armstrong) was born in New Rumley, Ohio, December 5, 1839. He entered the army directly after his graduation from West Point in June, 1861, and participated in all but one of the battles of the Army of the Potomac, attaining the rank of major-general at twenty-five. He had eleven horses shot under him in battle. After the Civil War he served in several Indian campaigns. His last fight, on the banks of the Little Big Horn river in Montana, took place June 26, 1876. See “Custer,” by Edmund Clarence Stedman (Complete Poems).

Stanza 2. Sitting Bull, who commanded the Indians in the Custer fight, was a Sioux chief, born about 1837. He was killed while resisting arrest in the Sioux outbreak of December, 1890.

Stanza 3. Rain-in-the-Face, a Sioux chief, who had been imprisoned for murdering a sutler and veterinary surgeon, but had subsequently escaped. See Longfellow’s poem, “The Revenge of Rain-in-the-Face.”

Stanza 7. Comanche. See “Miles Keogh’s Horse,” by John Hay (Poems).

48. THE BOND OF BLOOD. By Will Henry Thompson.

Will Henry Thompson. See note on "High Tide at Gettysburg."

Stanza 3. Lee. See "Barbara Frietchie."

Stanza 6. Hancock (Winfield Scott, 1824-1886), a distinguished Union general, and the Democratic candidate for President in 1880. He was conspicuous for his gallantry at Gettysburg, where he was wounded. The reference in this stanza is probably to the battle of Spottsylvania, where he captured and held a salient of field-works on the Confederate center, afterward known as "the bloody angle."

Stanza 9. Hill, either A. P. or D. H., both noted Confederate generals.

Gordon (George Washington), a brilliant Confederate leader, well known after the war as a lawyer and public speaker.

Stanza 12. Sherman. See "The Smallest of the Drums."

Stanza 16. Wilderness. See "Lee to the Rear."

49. A BALLAD OF MANILA BAY. By Charles George Douglas Roberts.

Charles George Douglas Roberts, poet and novelist, was born near Frederickton, New Brunswick, January 10, 1860. He was at one time Professor of English Literature in King's College, Windsor, Nova Scotia. Of recent years he has resided in the United States and devoted himself entirely to writing. He is commonly spoken of as the leader of the Canadian School of poets.

George Dewey, who by his victory over the Spanish in Manila Bay has come to be looked upon as the greatest naval commander of modern times, was born in Montpelier, Vermont, December 26, 1837. He was with Farragut at the opening of the Mississippi (see "The River Fight"), and took part in the severe engagements at Fort Fisher. He became a commodore in 1896, and in recognition of his Manila victory (May 1, 1898), and his subsequent services, he was promoted, first to the rank of rear-admiral, and later to that of admiral.

Stanza 1. Corregidor, an island at the entrance to Manila Bay.

Stanza 4. El Fraile (the Friar), an outcrop of rock, tunnelled to serve as a battery, lying in the main channel almost due south of the westerly tip of Corregidor.

Stanza 7. Kalibuyo and Salinas, towns in the province of Cavité, on the southern shore of Manila Bay.

Stanza 8. Cavité, a former Spanish fortress and naval station situated upon a point of land seven miles south of Manila.

Stanza 10. Bakor Bay, the bay formed by the projection upon which Cavité is situated.

Stanza 14. Drake (Sir Francis, 1540-1596), the greatest of the Elizabethan seaman, whose strategy and skill and audacious courage were largely instrumental in destroying the Spanish Armada.

Farragut. See “The River Fight.”

Blake (Robert, 1599-1657), called, next to Nelson, the greatest of the English admirals, and noted for his victories over the Dutch and Spanish.

Stanza 16. Nelson. See “The Fight of the *Armstrong* Privateer.”

[50.](#) DEWEY AT MANILA. By Robert Underwood Johnson.

Robert Underwood Johnson, associate-editor of the *Century Magazine*, was born in Washington, D. C., January 12, 1853. As secretary of the Authors’ and Publishers’ Copyright Leagues, Mr. Johnson rendered valuable services to the cause of international copyright.

Dewey. See note on “A Ballad of Manila Bay,” by Charles George Douglas Roberts.

Stanza 1. Bocagrande (large mouth), the main channel into Manila Bay south of Corregidor Island. The northerly channel is called Bocachica (small mouth).

Corregidor. See “A Ballad of Manila Bay.”

Stanza 6. Cavité. See “A Ballad of Manila Bay.”

Stanza 7. Montojo (Admiral Patricio Montojo y Pasaron), the commander of the Spanish naval forces in the Philippines.

Stanza 8. Farragut. See “The River Fight.”

Stanza 12. Gridley (Charles Vernon, 1845-1898), the captain of Admiral Dewey’s flagship, the *Olympia*.

[51.](#) THE MEN OF THE “MERRIMAC.” By Clinton Scollard.

Clinton Scollard. See note on “Montgomery at Quebec.”

The *Merrimac* was sunk on the morning of June 3, 1898, in order to block the narrow channel into Santiago Bay where the Spanish fleet was at anchor. The men who engaged in the perilous venture were:

Lieutenant Richard Pearson Hobson, naval constructor (born in Greensboro, Alabama, August 17, 1870; graduated from Annapolis at the head of his class in 1889; studied in France, and at the opening of the Spanish war was conducting the post-graduate course in construction at the Naval Academy at Annapolis).

Osborn Deignan, a coxswain of the *Merrimac*.

George F. Phillips, a machinist of the *Merrimac*.

John Kelly, a water-tender of the *Merrimac*.

George Charette, a gunner's mate of the *New York*.

Daniel Montagu, a seaman of the *Brooklyn*.

J. C. Murphy, a coxswain of the *Iowa*.

Randolph Clausen, a coxswain of the *New York*.

Stanza 6. Morro, the ancient Spanish fortress commanding Santiago Bay.

Socapa and **Estrella**, batteries at the entrance to the bay.

[52.](#) THE CHARGE AT SANTIAGO. By William Hamilton Hayne.

William Hamilton Hayne, son of Paul Hamilton Hayne (see "The Battle of Charleston Harbor"), was born in Charleston, South Carolina, March 11, 1856. He has the true lyrical instinct, and is the author of many quatrains and much finished "nature" verse.

Mr. Hayne's poem commemorates the valor of the American troops in their charge on San Juan Hill, near Santiago de Cuba, July 1, 1898.

[53.](#) SPAIN'S LAST ARMADA. By Wallace Rice.

Wallace Rice. See note on "Blood is Thicker than Water."

"Spain's Last Armada" celebrates the great naval victory of July 3, 1898.

Stanza 3. El Morro and Socapa. See note on "The Men of the *Merrimac*."

Stanza 11. Nimanima, the cove, six and a half miles from the entrance to Santiago harbor, where the *Infanta Maria Teresa* was beached.

Stanza 12. Juan Gonzales, about seven miles from the port of Santiago.

Stanza 13. Aserradero, fifteen miles from Santiago.

Stanza 16. The Cape o' the Cross, Cape Cruz, at the southwestern extremity of Cuba.

Tarquino, the mouth of the Rio Tarquino, where the ill-fated *Virginus* expedition landed.

54. BALLAD OF PACO TOWN. By Clinton Scollard.

Clinton Scollard. See note on "Montgomery at Quebec."

The incident described in this ballad occurred during the battle of Santa Ana, fought on the 5th of February, 1899, and resulting in the total rout of General Ricarti's division of the Filipino army. The signal-man who performed the daring deed was Lieutenant Charles E. Kilbourne, Jr.

Paco is a small town south, and slightly east, of Manila.

In Time of Peace.

55. PEACE HATH HER VICTORIES. By Wallace Rice.

Wallace Rice. See note on "Blood is Thicker than Water."

"This thrilling international episode earned the thanks and rewards of the American Congress, Captain Hughes, of the Liverpool steamer *Lord Gough*, obtaining a gold medal, and all his gallant men being remembered."—W. R.

The incident took place in December, 1889.

56. IN THE TUNNEL. By Bret Harte.

Bret Harte. See note on "John Burns of Gettysburg."

57. BALLAD OF CALNAN'S CHRISTMAS. By Helen Gray Cone.

Helen Gray Cone. See note on "Greencastle Jenny."

James F. Calnan, driver for Engine Company No. 34, in New York City, gave up his life on Christmas Day, 1897.

58. HOW HE SAVED ST. MICHAEL'S. By Mary Anna Phinney Stansbury.

Mary Anna Phinney Stansbury. See note on “The Surprise of Ticonderoga.”

The story, as related in the poem, is in the main true. The church, however, was St. Philip’s (Charleston, South Carolina), an earlier edifice that stood upon the same site as St. Michael’s. The slave, moreover, received his freedom, not from the city authorities, but from the vestrymen of the church. The fire occurred in the year 1796.

59. THE RIDE OF COLLIN GRAVES. By John Boyle O’Reilly.

John Boyle O’Reilly was born in Dowth Castle, County Meath, Ireland, June 28, 1844. Entering the British army at the age of eighteen, he was detected in a Fenian plot, and sentenced to twenty years penal servitude in Australia. He escaped in an open boat, was picked up by an American whaler, and brought to this country. Settling in Boston, his ability won for him speedy recognition, and he was made editor of the *Pilot*, a position which he held at the time of his death, which occurred on the 10th of August, 1890. His most notable contribution to poetry was his “Songs of the Southern Seas.”

The disaster at Williamsburg, Hampshire County, Massachusetts, took place on the 16th of May, 1874. The Mill River dam, which burst, covered one hundred and twenty-four acres to the average depth of twenty-four feet. Nearly two hundred lives were lost in the villages of Williamsburg, Skinnerville, Haydenville and Leeds.

I. 73. Curtius (Mettus, or Mettius), a young Roman who sacrificed his life for his country’s welfare, B.C. 362. A chasm had opened in the forum, and the soothsayers declared that it could only be filled by casting into it that which was most precious in Rome. Curtius appeared on horseback, clad in full armor, and leaped into the abyss, crying as he did so, “Rome has no greater riches than courage and arms!” According to tradition, the chasm at once closed over him.

60. JIM BLUDSO. By John Hay.

John Hay, our present (1900) Secretary of State, and recently United States Ambassador to Great Britain, was born in Salem, Indiana, October 8, 1838. He has long been connected with the diplomatic service. During the Civil War he was a private secretary to President Lincoln, and in

conjunction with John G. Nicolay is the author of the most complete biography of Lincoln published.

Jim Bludso was Oliver Fairchild, the engineer of the steamer *Fashion*. Mr. Hay is unable to fix the date of the disaster to the *Fashion*.

61. GEORGE NIDIVER. Anonymous.

62. A MAN'S NAME. By Richard Realf.

Richard Realf. See note on "The Defense of Lawrence."

David Simmons, railroad engineer, was killed in the disaster near New Hamburg, New York, on the Hudson River, February 6, 1871.

63. THE MAN WHO RODE TO CONEMAUGH. By John Eliot Bowen.

John Eliot Bowen, a journalist and the translator of Carmen Sylva's "Songs of Toil," who was for a number of years connected with *The Independent*, was born in Brooklyn, New York, June 8, 1858, and died in the same city, January 3, 1890.

The bursting of the dam upon the south fork of the Conemaugh River took place on the afternoon of May 31, 1889. It is stated that sixteen million tons of water were precipitated down the Conemaugh valley upon Johnston, Conemaugh, and various smaller towns. A conservative estimate of the loss of life gives it as three thousand, though some reports place it as high as five thousand.

The name of the hero who rode in front of the flood, giving the alarm, was Daniel Peyton, or Periton. The following poem, by an anonymous hand, pays tribute to the rider's bravery and self-sacrifice.

DANIEL PERITON

(May 31, 1889.)

Now that the land lies stricken
By a deluge dire and dread,
And the bravest spirits sicken
At thought of the doomed and dead,
Let a chord of praise be smitten
For the hero-hearted one,
And a requiem song be written
For Daniel Periton!

Go not to your olden story
For one with a deathless name!—
With never a dream of glory,
With never a heed of fame,
He dashed through the fated city
And called to the folk to fly;
O God of infinite pity,
Would all might have heard his cry!

Too late, too late the warning!
For the wave that bore despair
Rushed down with a ruthless scorning
Of mortal strength and prayer.
It smote in its mad derision,
It gulfed with its choking breath,
And set on a people's vision
The blinding seal of death.

And what of him who had striven
To save in that awful hour
When the stoutest walls were riven
By the flood's remorseless power?
Dead by the bridge they found him,—
Him and his gallant steed;
But ever will shine around him
The light of his noble deed!

A germ of divine creating

Abides in the human race,
And a man is always waiting
To spring to the hero's place.
And so let the lyre be smitten
In praise of the fearless one,
And a requiem song be written
For Daniel Periton!

64. JOHNNY BARTHOLOMEW. By Thomas Dunn English.

Thomas Dunn English. See note on "Arnold at Stillwater."

Though this poem has a newspaper paragraph for its basis, the author states that he has every reason to believe that the story is a true one.

65. HIS NAME. By Margaret Junkin Preston.

Margaret Junkin Preston. See note on "The Hero of the Gun."

An incident of the great Boston fire, November 9, 1872.

66. OLD BRADDOCK. By John Vance Cheney.

John Vance Cheney, poet and essayist, was born in Groveland, New York, December 29, 1848. He at one time practised law in New York City. He has been in charge of the San Francisco Public Library, and is now head librarian at the Newberry Library, in Chicago.

This poem has no foundation in fact.

67. IN APIA BAY. By Charles George Douglas Roberts.

Charles George Douglas Roberts. See "A Ballad of Manila Bay."

The destructive hurricane at Apia (island of Upolu, Samoa), occurred on the 15th of March, 1889. Three German and three American warships were either driven ashore, or crushed upon the coral reefs, and nearly one hundred and fifty lives were lost. The British ship which breasted the terrific force of the storm, and succeeded in escaping from the harbor, was the corvette *Calliope*. The American flag-ship was the *Trenton* (see poem), carrying the flag of Rear-Admiral Kimberley.

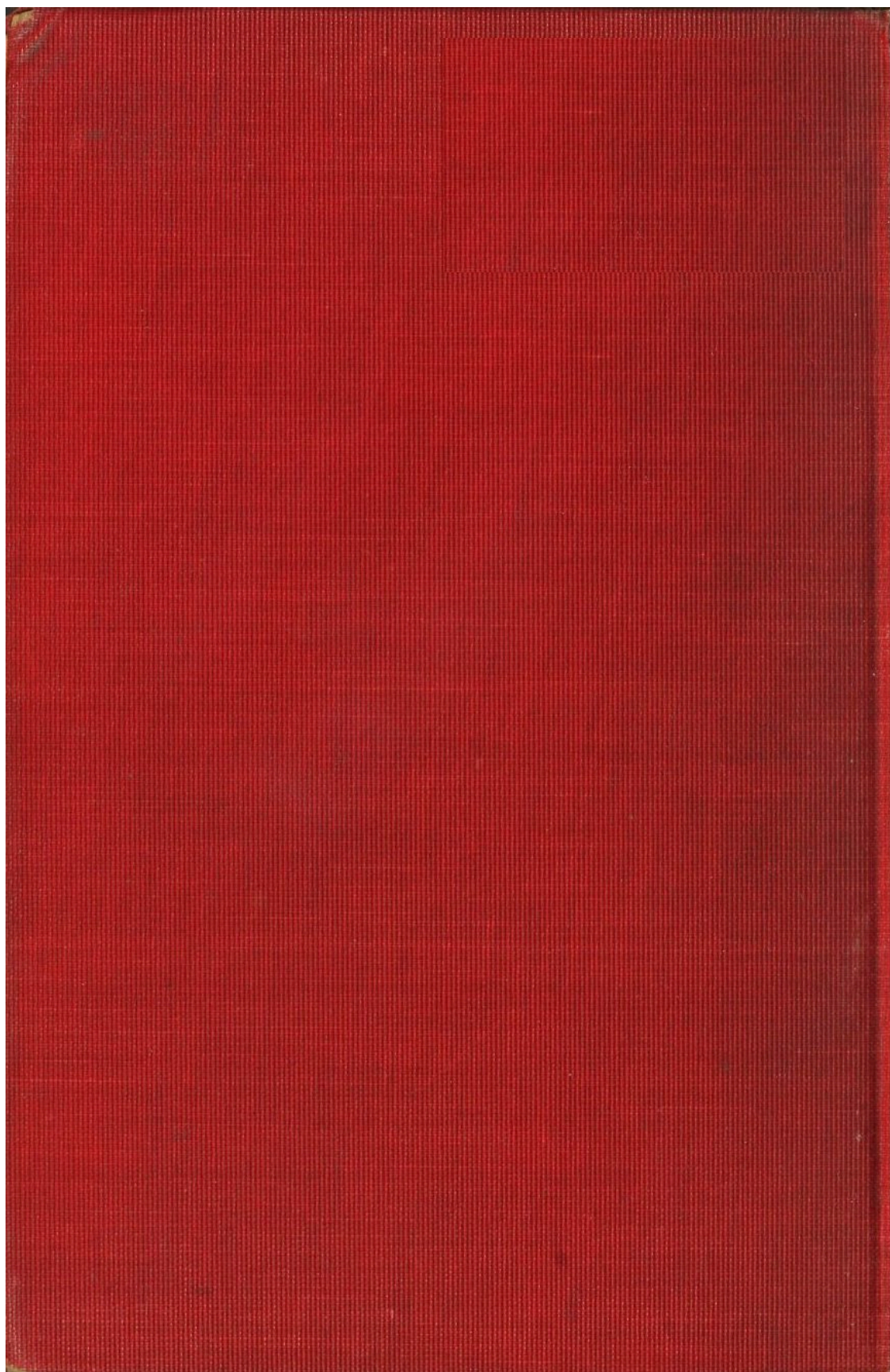
Typographical errors corrected by the etext transcriber:

Lighty, gaily=> Lightly, gaily {pg 90}

brigadier from Massachussetts=> brigadier from
Massachusetts {pg 207}

John Burns, of Gettyburg=> John Burns, of Gettysburg
{pg 218}

Confederate brigadier-genrral=> Confederate brigadier-
general {pg 219}



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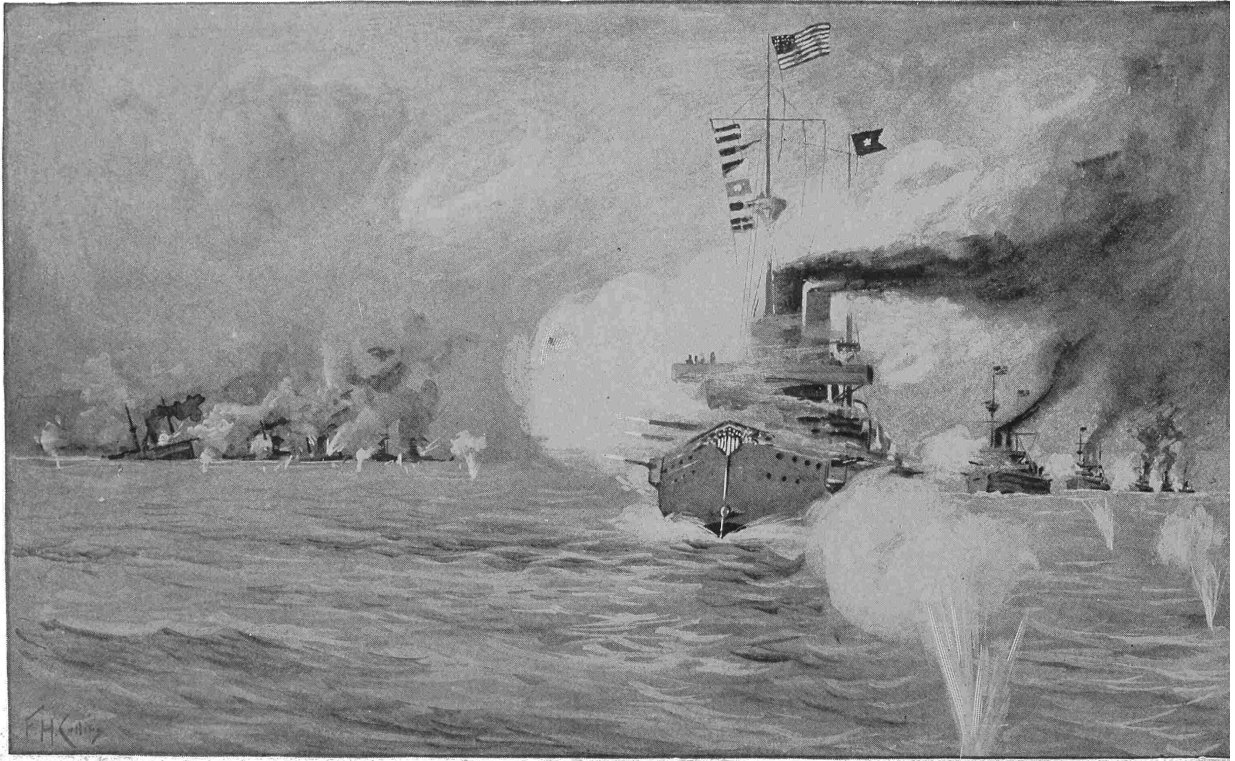
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